

FREEDOM IGNORED

Freed from the Adamic Nature, Yet Living in Chains



*Delivered but Still in Prison:
Why Many Remain Bound After the Cross*

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First edition

DEDICATION

To all those who are silently struggling with personal battles and seeking freedom, may this book be a source of hope, deliverance, and restoration.

To those who have found the strength to overcome and those still on the journey, you are not alone, and God's grace is sufficient.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

I would like to extend my deepest gratitude to all those who have been part of this journey.

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Most importantly, I give thanks to GOD, whose love and grace have been the ultimate source of inspiration in this endeavour

preface

The message of the cross is the greatest message ever given to humanity.

Through the sacrifice of Jesus Christ, God accomplished what no human effort, religion, or philosophy could ever achieve—complete redemption from sin and reconciliation with Himself.

Yet one of the greatest tragedies in the Church today is that many believers who have been redeemed still live as if they are prisoners. They have confessed Christ, they believe the gospel, yet they walk in fear, guilt, and spiritual uncertainty.

Some measure their spiritual freedom by material possessions—houses, marriages, cars, or financial prosperity. When these things delay, they begin to question whether they are truly free or whether they are still under curses and bondage.

This book addresses that confusion.

The gospel is not primarily about acquiring earthly possessions; it is about being delivered from the deepest prison of all—the prison of sin and separation from God.

When Christ died on the cross, He dealt with the root of humanity's bondage: the fallen nature inherited from Adam. The power of sin was broken, the record of guilt was canceled, and the door to a new life was opened.

However, many believers fail to walk in the freedom that Christ has already secured. Instead of fixing their eyes on the finished work of the cross, they allow their focus to shift toward external circumstances.

When life's situations do not change immediately, doubt and discouragement enter the heart. Slowly, some begin to believe the enemy's accusations and drift back toward the very bondages from which Christ delivered them.

This book seeks to bring clarity to that tension. It explores the difference between redemption and the believer's experience of freedom.

It explains why someone can be delivered from the Adamic nature yet still struggle with patterns, fears, and misunderstandings. Most importantly, it reveals how believers can move from merely knowing about freedom to actually walking in it.

The message is simple but powerful: the cross settled the matter. The believer's task is not to complete Christ's work, but to understand it, believe it, and live in the light of it.

My prayer is that as you read these pages, your eyes will be lifted again to the cross. May you see the depth of what Christ accomplished and discover the confidence to walk boldly in the freedom He purchased.

Freedom has already been given. The question is whether we will live in it.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

01

We Must Take the Gospel Seriously

**Why the Cross Must Always Be the
Center of Evangelism**

02

03

**The True Gospel for Evangelists —
The Gospel the Apostles Preached**

**What Is Salvation Based on What the
Apostles Preached**

04

05

**The Entrance of Sin — The Story of
the First Adam**

**The Bondage of Creation — How Sin
Affects the World**

06

The Last Adam — Christ, the Life-Giver

07

08

**Why the Blood of Christ Was Necessary
for Salvation**

The Finished Work of the Cross

09

10

**The Finished Atonement — Why the
Cross Left No Debt**

**Why the Resurrection Is the Heart of the
Gospel**

11

12

The Power of Redemption

13

The Mystery of Remission of Sins

**Redemption, Remission, and Justification
—The Three Pillars of Salvation**

14

15

**The Difference Between Salvation,
Redemption, and Being Born Again**

**You Are Saved, You Are Being Saved,
and You Will Be Saved**

16

17

**Was Salvation Finished at the Cross or
Is It Still Future?**

**Repentance — The Doorway to
Salvation**

18

**Repentance, Salvation and the Power
of the Cross**

19

20

What It Truly Means to Be Born Again

**Why Many People Hear the Gospel
but Are Not Truly Born Again**

21

22

Freedom from Sin and Condemnation

Forgiven Once, Transformed Forever

24

**The Gospel of Power — Victory Over
Sin and Death**

25

Living Forward — Newness of Life in the Last Adam

**Conviction vs Condemnation —
Walking in Assurance**

26

27

Walking in Holiness — Freedom Without Fear

The Transforming Power of Faith in the Cross

28

29

The Marks of a Truly Born Again Person

The Difference Between Religion and Being Born Again

30

The Difference Between Church Membership and True Salvation

31

32

The Difference Between Being Born Again and Being Born Into Religion

Why Moral Teaching Without the Cross Cannot Save

33

34

Why Many Religious People Must Still Be Born Again

The Gospel Many Preach Today vs The Gospel the Apostles Preached

35

36

Why Returning to Past Sins Undermines Faith

**Why Believers Still Experience
Sickness and Physical Death**

37

38

Open Doors

**Why Some Christians Still Experience
Generational Problems After Salvation**

39

40

**The Difference Between a Demon, the
Flesh, and the Unrenewed Mind**

Deliverance vs Discipleship

41

42

**Deliverance Beyond Possession —
The True Freedom in Christ**

43

The Open Prison — Why Many Christians Remain Bound After the Cross

The Three Angels' Message — God's Final Warning to the World

44

45

The Legacy of Redemption — From Adam to the Church Today

The Final Call: Come to the Cross

47

**Walking in Permanent Freedom
Living the Life Christ Purchased**

**Possible Questions From the Class
and Biblical Answers**

48

TERMS USED

1. Redemption — The Price Paid to Set Us Free

Meaning

Redemption refers to the price Jesus paid to purchase our freedom from sin and bondage. The word comes from the idea of buying back a slave from the market.

Christ paid the price with **His blood**.

First Epistle of Peter **1 Peter 1:18–19 NKJV** *"Knowing that you were not redeemed with corruptible things, like silver or gold... but with the precious blood of Christ."*

Epistle to the Colossians **Colossians 1:14 NKJV** *"In whom we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of sins."* Redemption answers the question: **"What was the price paid for our freedom?"**

The answer: the blood of Christ. "Redemption is the ransom paid to unlock the prison door."

3. Justification — Being Declared Righteous

Meaning

Justification is the legal declaration by God that a sinner is righteous because of faith in Jesus Christ. It is a **courtroom term**.

The believer is declared innocent because Christ took the penalty. Epistle to the Romans **Romans 5:1 NKJV** *"Therefore, having been justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ."*

Epistle to the Romans **Romans 3:24 NKJV** *"Being justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus."*

Justification does not mean the believer **never sinned**. It means Christ's righteousness is credited to him.

"Justification is the judge striking the gavel and declaring, 'Not guilty.'"

4. Remission — The Removal of Sin

Meaning

Remission means **the forgiveness and removal of sins through the blood of Jesus**. The guilt and debt of sin are **canceled**. Gospel of Matthew **Matthew 26:28 NKJV**

“For this is My blood of the new covenant, which is shed for many for the remission of sins.”

Acts of the Apostles **Acts 2:38 NKJV** *“Repent, and let every one of you be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins.”*

Remission answers the question: **“What happens to our sins when we believe?”** They are **forgiven and removed**.

“Remission is the erasing of a debt from the record book.”

5. Sanctification — The Process of Becoming Holy

Meaning

Sanctification is the ongoing process where the believer is set apart and gradually transformed into Christ's character.

Unlike justification, which happens instantly, sanctification is **a lifelong process**.

First Epistle to the Thessalonians **1 Thessalonians 4:3 NKJV** *“For this is the will of God, your sanctification.”* Epistle to the Hebrews **Hebrews 12:14 NKJV**

“Pursue peace with all people, and holiness, without which no one will see the Lord.” Sanctification deals with **transformation of character and lifestyle**.

It is the work of the Holy Spirit shaping the believer. “Sanctification is the sculptor slowly shaping the stone into a masterpiece.”

6. Glorification — The Final Perfection of the Believer

Meaning

Glorification is the final stage of salvation when believers receive their perfected bodies and eternal glory with Christ. This happens **at the resurrection**. Epistle to the Romans **Romans 8:30 NKJV**

“Whom He justified, these He also glorified.” First Epistle to the Corinthians **1 Corinthians 15:52 NKJV** *“The dead will be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed.”*

Glorification answers the question: **“What will believers become in eternity?”** They will share in **the glory of Christ**.

“Glorification is the moment the seed finally becomes the full-grown tree.”

Salvation — The Whole Work of God in Saving Man

Meaning

Salvation is the complete work of God that rescues a sinner from sin, death, and eternal separation from God and restores him into relationship with God through Christ.

It is the **umbrella term** that includes **redemption, justification, remission, sanctification, and glorification**.

Epistle to the Ephesians Ephesians 2:8 NKJV *“For by grace you have been saved through faith, and that not of yourselves; it is the gift of God.”*

Epistle to the Hebrews **Hebrews 5:9 NKJV** *“And having been perfected, He became the author of eternal salvation to all who obey Him.”*

Salvation includes:

- Deliverance from sin's penalty
- Transformation of the believer
- Final eternal glory

“Salvation is the whole journey from the prison cell to the palace.”

Introduction

Freed but Not Walking Free

The gospel of Jesus Christ is the greatest announcement ever given to humanity. It declares that through the cross, God dealt with the deepest problem of mankind—sin, separation from God, and the fallen nature inherited from Adam.

Through Christ's sacrifice, humanity was offered redemption, forgiveness, and a new life.

Yet a strange contradiction exists in the lives of many believers today. Many people have confessed Christ and believe the gospel, yet they still live as though they are prisoners.

They struggle with fear, guilt, condemnation, and the constant suspicion that something is still wrong with their salvation.

Some even believe that if certain material things are missing in their lives—such as wealth, a house, marriage, or success—then they must still be under a curse or spiritual bondage.

This thinking has led many believers into confusion.

Instead of measuring the power of salvation by what Christ accomplished on the cross, some measure it by external circumstances.

When life does not change as quickly as expected, discouragement begins to grow.

The enemy then uses these moments to whisper lies such as: "If you were truly delivered, your life would already look different."

These accusations slowly shift the believer's focus away from the cross and toward circumstances.

However, the Bible reveals a deeper truth: the greatest bondage humanity faced was not poverty, sickness, or lack of success.

The greatest bondage was the bondage of sin and the fallen nature that entered the world through Adam. That was the prison Christ came to break.

When Christ died and rose again, He opened the door of that prison. The power of sin was broken, the record of guilt was canceled, and the path to reconciliation with God was established.

But opening the prison door and walking out of the prison are not the same thing.

Many believers have been legally set free through Christ, yet they still live as though they are imprisoned because they do not fully understand what the cross accomplished.

They have been delivered from the Adamic nature, yet they continue to think and live as if the old chains are still around them.

This book addresses that tension.

It explores why some believers who are genuinely saved still struggle with feelings of bondage. It examines the difference between redemption and the believer's experience of freedom.

Most importantly, it reveals how the finished work of Christ provides the foundation for a life of true spiritual liberty.

The message of this book is simple but life-changing: Christ did not partially redeem humanity. The cross was a complete victory.

The believer's journey is not about trying to earn freedom but about learning to walk in the freedom that Christ has already secured.

The prison door has been opened.

The question now is whether we will step out and live as those who are truly free.

The Prison Door Is Open — Why Many Christians Still Live Inside

One of the greatest tragedies in the Christian life is not that Christ failed to bring freedom, but that many believers live as though they are still prisoners even after the prison door has been opened.

The gospel declares a powerful truth: **Jesus Christ came to set** humanity free from the bondage of sin, darkness, and spiritual captivity.

Yet despite this glorious promise, countless believers continue to struggle with fear, addiction, destructive patterns, and spiritual oppression.

This creates an important question: **If Christ has already provided freedom, why do so many Christians still feel bound?**

The answer is not found in the weakness of Christ's sacrifice but in the misunderstanding of how spiritual freedom works.

As an old saying goes, **"A man may hold the key** in his hand yet remain locked inside if he does not know how to use it."

Christ Came to Break the Prison Doors

The mission of Jesus was clearly announced long before His earthly ministry began.

The prophet Isaiah spoke of the coming Messiah with these words: **Isaiah 61:1 (NKJV)** "The Spirit of the Lord God is upon Me... He has sent Me to heal the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to those who are bound."

When Jesus began His ministry, He confirmed that this prophecy was fulfilled through Him.

His mission included:

- Setting captives free
 - Healing broken lives
 - Destroying the works of the devil
- The apostle John later confirmed this purpose.

1 John 3:8 (NKJV) “For this purpose the Son of God was manifested, that He might destroy the works of the devil.”

The cross was not only a symbol of forgiveness; it was a **decisive victory over the kingdom of darkness**.

Through Christ, the prison doors of sin, fear, and spiritual bondage were opened.

Freedom Must Be Understood and Applied

Although the prison doors have been opened, many believers still live as though they are confined.

Why?

Because **freedom must be understood and applied**.

A prisoner who has lived in darkness for many years may hesitate to step into the light even after the door is opened.

Similarly, some believers struggle because they do not yet understand the full reality of what Christ accomplished.

Scripture warns that lack of knowledge can lead to destruction.

Hosea 4:6 (NKJV) “My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge.”

Ignorance of spiritual truth often keeps believers trapped in patterns that Christ has already defeated.

An idiom wisely states, “**Chains on the mind are** often stronger than chains on the body.”

The Three Battles Every Believer Faces

Many Christians assume that every struggle comes from demonic attack. Others believe that spiritual warfare is not real. Both extremes create confusion.

The Bible reveals that believers face three different kinds of battles:

1. **The Devil** – spiritual opposition from the kingdom of darkness

2. **The Flesh** – the sinful nature and its desires
 3. **The Unrenewed Mind** – old patterns of thinking shaped by the past
- Without understanding these three sources of struggle, believers may fight the wrong battles with the wrong weapons.

As another idiom says, “**A soldier** who does not understand the battlefield will never win the war.”

This section of the book will help clarify these battles and show how believers can walk in true freedom.

Freedom Requires Both Power and Process

Deliverance is part of God's work, but lasting freedom also requires **discipleship and transformation**.

Casting out demons may remove spiritual oppression, but growth in Christ develops spiritual stability.

Freedom is therefore both **a miracle and a journey**.

The apostle Paul described this transformation as a progressive work.

2 Corinthians 3:18 (NKJV) “But we all... are being transformed into the same image from glory to glory.”

God's purpose is not only to rescue believers from bondage but also to **shape them into the image of Christ**.

An idiom explains this well: “**Breaking chains is** the beginning of freedom, but learning to walk is the journey of life.”

What This Section Will Reveal

In the chapters that follow, we will explore several crucial truths that many believers overlook:

- Why some Christians still experience generational struggles after salvation
- The difference between deliverance and discipleship

- How to distinguish between demons, the flesh, and the unrenewed mind
- The spiritual doors that allow the enemy access
- How believers can walk in permanent freedom

Understanding these principles will help believers move from **temporary relief to lasting victory**.

A Call to Step Out of the Prison

The gospel does not merely promise freedom; it invites believers to **step into it**.

Christ has already opened the prison doors, broken the chains, and defeated the enemy.

Now the believer must walk in the freedom that has been provided.

Scripture declares this powerful truth:

Colossians 1:13 (NKJV) "He has delivered us from the power of darkness and conveyed us into the kingdom of the Son of His love."

The prison door is open.

The chains are broken.

The question that remains is simple:

Will we continue living as prisoners, or will we step fully into the freedom Christ has given?

As the saying goes, "**The door of** the cage may be open, but the bird must still choose to fly."

CHAPTER 1

THE TRUE GOSPEL WE MUST TAKE SERIOUSLY

The gospel is the heart of the Christian faith. It is not merely a religious message or a motivational speech. It is the divine message of salvation given by God to rescue humanity from sin and death.

In every generation, the Church must guard the true apostolic gospel, because when the gospel is changed, the foundation of salvation is weakened.

The Scriptures present the gospel in a clear and orderly way:

1. The origin of sin
2. The work of Christ
3. The apostolic proclamation
4. The call to salvation
5. The warning against false gospels

Part One: Why Humanity Needs the Gospel

1. The Root of Humanity's Problem: Sin Entered Through Adam

To understand the gospel, we must first understand why humanity needs salvation.

Romans 5:12 “Therefore, just as through one man sin entered the world, and death through sin, and thus death spread to all men, because all sinned.”

Sin entered the world through Adam's disobedience. From that moment, death spread to the entire human race. Humanity inherited a fallen condition that no human effort could repair.

This means sin is not only something people do—it is also a condition affecting all humanity. “If the root is rotten, the branches cannot remain healthy.”

Because the root of humanity was corrupted by sin, mankind needed a new beginning.

2. The First Adam and the Last Adam

The Bible reveals that Jesus came as the answer to Adam's failure.

1 Corinthians 15:45 "And so it is written, 'The first man Adam became a living being.' The last Adam became a life-giving spirit."

Adam is called the first man, while Christ is called the last Adam.

The First Adam Brought:

- Sin
- Death
- A fallen nature

The Last Adam Brings:

- Life
- Restoration
- New spiritual birth

In Summary:

- Adam represents the old creation
- Christ represents the new creation

Just as humanity inherited death through Adam, believers receive eternal life through Jesus Christ.

Part Two: The Message of the Gospel

3. The Core of the Gospel: Christ's Death, Burial, and Resurrection

The apostle Paul clearly defined the gospel.

1 Corinthians 15:1–4 "Moreover, brethren, I declare to you the gospel which I preached to you... that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, and that He was buried, and that He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures."

This passage reveals the central pillars of the gospel:

1. Christ died for our sins
2. He was buried
3. He rose again on the third day

This happened according to the Scriptures

A. The Death of Christ

Meaning:

- Jesus died for our sins
- He took our punishment
- He became our substitute

His death was not an accident—it was a sacrifice for sin.

B. The Burial of Christ

Meaning:

- It confirms that He truly died
- It represents the end of the old life
- Sin was fully dealt with

Burial is the proof that the old man is finished.

C. The Resurrection of Christ

Meaning:

- Jesus conquered death
- He is alive forever
- He gives new life to believers

Romans 4:25 “Who was delivered up because of our offenses, and was raised because of our justification.”

The resurrection is the evidence that salvation is complete.

It also proves that Jesus is the life-giving Savior, the Last Adam who restores life to humanity.

Part Three: How the Gospel Was Preached

4. The Apostles Preached Jesus and the Resurrection

The apostles did not preach human philosophies or cultural ideas. Their message focused on Christ and His resurrection.

Acts 17:18–19 "He preached to them Jesus and the resurrection."

Even when Paul spoke among philosophers, he did not adjust the message to please them. He proclaimed Jesus and the resurrection.

Without the resurrection, Christianity would be an empty religion. But because Jesus rose again, the gospel carries the power of life.

5. Did the Other Apostles Preach a Different Gospel?

No. All the apostles preached the same gospel.

Peter

Acts 2:38 "Repent, and let every one of you be baptized... for the remission of sins."

Peter preached:

- Repentance
- Jesus' death and resurrection

John

John 20:31 "That you may believe that Jesus is the Christ... and that believing you may have life."

John emphasized:

- Faith in Christ
- Eternal life through Him

Philip the Evangelist

Acts 8:35 "Philip... preached Jesus to him." Philip simply preached Christ.

Why It Sometimes Seems Different

Because:

- Paul taught deep doctrine (grace, justification)
- Peter emphasized repentance and covenant
- John emphasized love and eternal life

But the foundation remained the same:

Jesus Christ died, was buried, and rose again.

Part Four: The Response the Gospel Demands

6. Believe and Confess Jesus as Lord

The gospel calls for a personal response.

Romans 10:9–10 "That if you confess with your mouth the Lord Jesus and believe in your heart that God has raised Him from the dead, you will be saved."

Salvation involves two important elements:

Believing in the Heart

A person must truly believe:

- Jesus died for sin
- God raised Him from the dead

Confessing Jesus as Lord

Confession means:

- Openly acknowledging Jesus as Lord
- Submitting to His authority

This faith leads to repentance and transformation.

“You cannot walk in darkness and light at the same time.”

When a person receives Christ, they turn away from the old life and embrace the new life that comes from the Last Adam.

7. Where Does Repentance Fit In?

The gospel is not just information—it demands a response.

Mark 1:15 "Repent, and believe in the gospel."

Repentance means:

- A change of mind
- A turning away from sin
- A turning toward God

8. Putting It Together: The Full Gospel

The true gospel has two parts:

A. The Message (What Christ Did)

- He died for your sins
- He was buried
- He rose again

B. The Response (What You Must Do)

- Repent
- Believe
- Confess Jesus as Lord

Part Five: The Warning Against False Gospels

9. The Serious Warning

Because the gospel is so important, the Bible gives a strong warning to those who change it.

Galatians 1:8–9 “But even if we, or an angel from heaven, preach any other gospel to you than what we have preached to you, let him be accursed.”

Paul makes it clear:

- The gospel is not flexible
- It is not to be modified
- It is not to be mixed with human ideas

There is only one true gospel, and any alteration is dangerous.

Changing the gospel is like changing the foundation of a building—everything built on it will eventually collapse.

10. Why Paul Warned the Galatians

The Galatians were:

- Adding law to the gospel
- Mixing grace with works
- Changing the simplicity of salvation

Paul rebuked them because any gospel that adds to or removes from Christ's finished work is false.

11. What Is a False Gospel Today?

A false gospel is anything that:

- Removes repentance
- Ignores sin
- Denies Christ's sacrifice
- Adds human effort as the basis of salvation

Part Six: Important Clarifications

12. Is “Preaching the Word” the Same as the Gospel?

2 Timothy 4:2 “Preach the word!”

This is broader than the gospel.

The Gospel:

The core message of salvation (Christ's death, burial, resurrection + repentance and faith)

The Word:

The whole counsel of God:

- Doctrine
- Correction
- Instruction
- Prophecy
- Spiritual growth

Summary:

- The gospel is the foundation
- The Word is the full building

You start with the gospel, but you do not stop there.

13. Is Praise and Worship the Gospel?

No. Praise and worship are not the gospel. They are a response to the gospel.

The Gospel Tells You:

What Christ has done.

Worship Expresses:

Your response to what He has done.

Example:

Gospel: "Christ died for your sins and rose again."

Worship: "Thank You, Jesus, for saving me."

Worship flows from revelation of the gospel, but it is not the gospel itself.

14. The Real Danger Today

Confusion comes when people replace the gospel with:

- Motivation
- Prosperity messages
- Worship experiences
- Church activities

These things may have value, but they are not the gospel.

15. Clear Distinction

Thing	What It Is
Gospel	The message of salvation
Preaching the Word	Teaching the whole Bible
Worship	Response to God
Doctrine	Explanation of truth

Part Seven: Deep Spiritual Insight

16. The Gospel Must Be Experienced

The gospel is not just that Jesus died.

His death demands your death to sin.

His burial demands the end of your old life.

His resurrection demands that you walk in newness of life.

17. A Simple Definition of the Gospel

The gospel is the good news that Jesus Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again—and through repentance and faith in Him, we receive forgiveness and new life.

Conclusion

The true gospel follows a clear biblical order:

1. Sin entered the world through Adam
2. Jesus Christ came as the Last Adam
3. Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again
4. The apostles preached Jesus and the resurrection
5. People must repent, believe, and confess Him as Lord
6. Anyone who preaches another gospel is under serious warning

You can worship without preaching the gospel. You can preach many things without preaching the gospel. But without the gospel, there is no salvation.

The gospel is the message that gives life to every other message.

For this reason, believers must take the true gospel seriously, because it is the only message that brings salvation and eternal life.

The gospel is not merely information—it is the power of God that transforms sinners into new creations through Jesus Christ, the Last Adam and the giver of life.

Closing Statement

“The gospel is not complete until the sinner repents, the old man dies, and the new life begins in Christ.”

CHAPTER 2

WHY THE CROSS MUST ALWAYS BE THE CENTER OF EVANGELISM

Evangelism is the proclamation of the **good news of salvation**. However, the effectiveness of evangelism depends entirely on **the message that is preached**. If the message changes, the result also changes.

The apostles understood that the **center of the gospel is the cross of Jesus Christ**. For this reason, they never removed the cross from their preaching.

Today, however, many evangelistic messages have shifted away from the cross and toward **human-centered themes** such as success, prosperity, self-improvement, or motivational ideas.

While these topics may attract attention, they cannot save the human soul. The power of evangelism lies in **the message of the cross**.

1. The Cross Solves the Problem of Sin

The primary reason Jesus came into the world was to deal with the problem of sin.

Romans 5:12 “Therefore, just as through one man sin entered the world, and death through sin, and thus death spread to all men, because all sinned.”

Through Adam, sin entered the world and death followed. Humanity became separated from God and trapped under the power of sin.

Because the problem was spiritual, the solution had to be **a divine sacrifice**.

The cross is where Jesus carried the sins of humanity and paid the price for redemption.

An idiom says: *“When the root of the problem is removed, the branches lose their power.”*

The cross addresses the **root problem of sin**.

2. The Apostles Preached the Cross as the Gospel

The apostles consistently preached the message of Christ's death and resurrection.

1 Corinthians 15:1–4 “Moreover, brethren, I declare to you the gospel... that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, and that He was buried, and that He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures.”

This passage reveals the heart of the gospel:

- Christ died for our sins
- He was buried
- He rose again

This is the message that saves sinners.

The cross is therefore not merely a symbol of Christianity—it is **the foundation of salvation**.

3. The Cross Reveals God's Love and Justice

The cross demonstrates both the **love of God** and the **justice of God**.

God's justice required that sin be punished. At the same time, God's love desired to rescue humanity.

At the cross, these two realities met. Jesus took upon Himself the punishment that belonged to sinners so that humanity could be reconciled to God.

The cross therefore shows that salvation is not based on **human effort**, but on **God's grace**.

4. Paul Did Not Replace the Cross With Philosophy

The apostle Paul encountered many cultures that valued intellectual discussions and philosophical reasoning.

One example is found when he arrived in Athens.

Acts 17:18–19 "...because he preached to them Jesus and the resurrection."

Athens was filled with philosophers who enjoyed debates and intellectual ideas. If Paul wanted to impress them, he could have presented a philosophical message.

But Paul did not change the gospel.

He continued to preach **Jesus and the resurrection**, which are directly connected to the work of the cross.

This teaches a powerful lesson: **the gospel must never be changed to fit human preferences**.

5. The Cross Leads to the Resurrection and New Life

The cross and the resurrection are inseparable. The cross dealt with sin, and the resurrection demonstrated the victory over death.

1 Corinthians 15:45 "The first man Adam became a living being. The last Adam became a life-giving spirit."

Adam brought sin and death into the world, but Jesus Christ—the Last Adam—rose from the dead and became the source of new life.

Through the cross and resurrection, humanity can receive **forgiveness and eternal life**.

6. Salvation Comes Through Faith in the Crucified and Risen Christ

The gospel must lead people to a personal response.

Romans 10:9–10 “That if you confess with your mouth the Lord Jesus and believe in your heart that God has raised Him from the dead, you will be saved.”

Salvation requires:

- Believing in the heart that Jesus rose from the dead
- Confessing Jesus as Lord

This faith connects a person to the saving work accomplished on the cross.

7. The Danger of Removing the Cross From Evangelism

The apostle Paul warned the Church about changing the gospel.

Galatians 1:6–9 “I marvel that you are turning away so soon... to a different gospel.”

When the cross is removed from evangelism, the message becomes powerless. It may inspire people, but it will not save them.

An idiom says: *“If the foundation is removed, the house cannot stand.”*

The cross is the foundation of the gospel. Without it, evangelism becomes **empty religion** rather than the message of salvation.

Conclusion

The cross must always remain at the center of evangelism because it is the place where salvation was accomplished.

The Scriptures reveal this clearly:

Sin entered the world through Adam (Romans 5:12). Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again (1 Corinthians 15:1–4). Jesus became the life-giving Savior (1 Corinthians 15:45).

Salvation comes through faith in the risen Lord (Romans 10:9–10).

Any gospel that removes the cross is a dangerous distortion (Galatians 1:6–9).

For this reason, every evangelist must return to the **apostolic message of the cross**, because it is the only message that has the power to save sinners and bring eternal life.

CHAPTER 3

THE TRUE GOSPEL FOR EVANGELISTS — THE GOSPEL THE APOSTLES PREACHED

Introduction

In many places today, evangelists preach different kinds of messages. Some preach morality, others preach prosperity, and some preach religion or church traditions.

While these topics may contain good ideas, **they are not the gospel.**

The gospel is not human advice about how to live better. The gospel is **God's announcement of what He has done for humanity through Jesus Christ.**

An evangelist must therefore preach **the same gospel that the apostles preached**, because there is only one true gospel.

Galatians 1:8 (NIV) "But even if we or an angel from heaven should preach a gospel other than the one we preached to you, let them be under God's curse."

This warning shows that the message of salvation must **never be altered.**

"When the foundation is changed, the house collapses."

1. The Apostles Preached the Gospel of Christ's Death and Resurrection

The apostle Paul the Apostle summarized the gospel very clearly.

1 Corinthians 15:1–4 (NIV) "Now, brothers and sisters, I want to remind you of the gospel I preached to you... By this gospel you are saved..."

That Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, that he was buried, and that he was raised on the third day according to the Scriptures.”

This was the **center of apostolic preaching**.

The gospel declares that:

Humanity fell into sin through Adam (**Romans 5:12**).

Sin brought death and separation from God.

Christ came as the **Last Adam** to restore humanity.

Through His death and resurrection, forgiveness and new life are available.

“The cross is the bridge between fallen man and a holy God.”

2. The Apostles Preached Repentance and Forgiveness

The apostles did not only preach belief; they called people to **repentance**.

Before ascending to heaven, Jesus Christ gave this instruction.

Luke 24:46–47 (NIV) “The Messiah will suffer and rise from the dead on the third day, and repentance for the forgiveness of sins will be preached in his name to all nations.”

On the day of Pentecost, Peter the Apostle preached the same message.

Acts 2:38 (NIV) “Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins.”

Repentance means **turning away from sin and turning toward God**. *“You cannot walk east and west at the same time.”*

3. The Apostles Preached Freedom from the Power of Sin

Salvation is not only about forgiveness; it is also about **deliverance from the power of sin**.

Romans 6:1–2 (NIV) “What shall we say, then? Shall we go on sinning so that grace may increase? By no means! We are those who have died to sin; how can we live in it any longer?”

The apostles taught that believers are no longer slaves of sin.

Romans 6:16 (NIV) “Don’t you know that when you offer yourselves to someone as obedient slaves, you are slaves of the one you obey?”

Through Christ, believers receive **new life and new power to live righteously**. *“A man who has been freed from prison should not return to his chains.”*

4. The Apostles Preached the Kingdom of God

The apostles continued the message that Christ Himself preached: **the kingdom of God**.

Acts 28:31 (NIV) “He proclaimed the kingdom of God and taught about the Lord Jesus Christ—with all boldness and without hindrance.”

The gospel declares that:

- Christ is King.
- His kingdom has begun.
- Those who believe enter into a new covenant relationship with God.

5. The Apostles Preached Salvation by Grace

The gospel is not about earning salvation through works.

Ephesians 2:8–9 (NIV) “For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith—and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God.”

Human religion says: “Work to reach God.”
The gospel says: “God came down to save humanity.”

“Man builds ladders to heaven, but the cross is God’s bridge to earth.”

6. The Gospel Must Be Preached to Everyone

The apostles preached the gospel to **both the poor and the rich**, because all people are sinners.

Romans 3:23–24 (NIV) “For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God, and all are justified freely by his grace.”

Wealth cannot save a soul, and poverty cannot automatically produce righteousness. Only Christ saves.

“Gold cannot buy a soul, and poverty cannot cleanse one.”

Conclusion

The true gospel for evangelists is the **same gospel the apostles preached**:

1. Humanity fell into sin through Adam.
2. Christ came as the Savior and Last Adam.
3. He died for our sins and rose again.
4. People must repent and believe.
5. Salvation brings forgiveness and freedom from sin.
6. Through faith, believers enter the kingdom of God.

An evangelist must preach **Christ and His finished work**, not human philosophies or material promises.

“When the trumpet gives an uncertain sound, the army cannot prepare for battle.”

CHAPTER 4

WHAT IS SALVATION BASING ON WHAT THE APOSTLES PREACHED

1. We Must First Understand What Salvation Is

Before a person can preach or receive the gospel, they must first understand **what salvation is**.

The Bible declares:

Romans 10:9–10 (NKJV) “That if you confess with your mouth the Lord Jesus and believe in your heart that God has raised Him from the dead, you will be saved.

For with the heart one believes unto righteousness, and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.”

Salvation therefore comes when a person **believes the true gospel and confesses Jesus Christ as Lord**.

But this raises an important question:

What exactly must we believe?

We must believe **the gospel that the apostles preached**, not a message invented by men.

2. What Gospel Did the Apostles Preach?

The apostles did not preach human ideas, philosophy, or moral improvement. They preached **Jesus Christ and His resurrection**.

When the apostle Paul went to Athens, he encountered philosophers who loved intellectual debates.

Acts 17:18–19 “Then certain Epicurean and Stoic philosophers encountered him... because he preached to them Jesus and the resurrection.”

Even in the middle of philosophers, Paul **did not change the gospel**. He did not replace the cross with philosophy. Instead, he continued preaching **Jesus and the resurrection**.

Paul later summarized the gospel clearly:

1 Corinthians 15:1–4 “Moreover, brethren, I declare to you the gospel...

That Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, and that He was buried, and that He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures.”

This is the **core of the apostolic gospel**:

1. **Jesus Christ died for our sins**
2. **He was buried**
3. **He rose again on the third day**

This message is the **foundation of salvation**.

3. Salvation From What?

If the gospel is salvation, we must ask another question:

Salvation from what?

The Bible teaches that humanity needs salvation because **sin entered the world through Adam**.

Romans 5:12 “Therefore, just as through one man sin entered the world, and death through sin, and thus death spread to all men, because all sinned.”

When Adam sinned, **sin entered humanity and death followed.**

But the consequences of sin did not stop with humanity. Sin also affected the entire creation.

Romans 8:20 “For the creation was subjected to futility, not willingly, but because of Him who subjected it in hope.”

This means that the fall of man brought **frustration, decay, and corruption into the whole world.**

Creation itself became subject to **vanity and bondage** because of sin.

This is why the world experiences **death, suffering, and decay.**

Humanity therefore needs **a second Adam to restore what the first Adam destroyed.**

4. The Second Adam: Christ the Life-Giver

The Bible reveals that Jesus came as the **second Adam** to restore humanity.

1 Corinthians 15:45 “The first man Adam became a living being. The last Adam became a life-giving Spirit.”

The first Adam brought **sin and death.**

But the last Adam, Jesus Christ, brings **life and righteousness.**

Through His death and resurrection, Christ defeated sin and opened the door for humanity to receive eternal life.

Salvation therefore means **being transferred from Adam's fallen nature into Christ's new life.**

5. The Danger of Drifting From the True Gospel

One of the greatest dangers in the church today is **drifting away from the gospel the apostles preached.**

Many modern messages focus on:

- moral improvement
- motivational speaking
- human success
- social philosophy

But the apostles did not preach **humanism**. They preached **Christ crucified and risen.**

The Bible gives a very serious warning about changing the gospel.

Galatians 1:6–8 “I marvel that you are turning away so soon from Him who called you in the grace of Christ, to a different gospel.”

And the warning becomes even stronger:

Galatians 1:8–9 “But even if we, or an angel from heaven, preach any other gospel to you than what we have preached to you, let him be accursed.”

This means the gospel **cannot be modified, improved, or replaced.**

Not even an angel has authority to change it. The gospel is not ours to edit. It is **God’s message to humanity.**

6. The Lesson for Evangelists Today

Many evangelists today have drifted from the apostolic gospel. Instead of preaching repentance and salvation from sin, some preach messages centered on **human interests and moral values.**

But the gospel is not merely about making people better citizens.

The gospel is about **saving sinners from sin through Jesus Christ.**

Even when Paul encountered philosophers in Athens, he **did not adjust the gospel to impress them.**

He continued preaching **Jesus and the resurrection.**

An old proverb says: *"If you remove the foundation of a house, the building cannot stand."*

In the same way, if we remove **the cross, sin, and the resurrection,** we no longer have the gospel.

The true gospel must always proclaim:

- **Jesus Christ is Lord**
- **He died for our sins**
- **He was buried**
- **He rose again**
- **Repent and believe the gospel**

This is the message that saved the world in the days of the apostles, and it is **the same message that will save the world today.**

CHAPTER 5

THE ENTRANCE OF SIN — THE STORY OF THE FIRST ADAM

Romans 5:12 (NIV) “Therefore, just as sin entered the world through one man, and death through sin, and in this way death came to all people, because all sinned.”

This verse is one of the most important explanations of the human condition in the entire Bible. It reveals that the problem of humanity did not begin with many people—it began with **one man**, Adam.

To understand salvation, the gospel, and the necessity of the new birth, we must first understand **what truly happened in Adam**.

“To solve a problem, you must first understand where it began.”

1. The Origin of the Problem

Sin did not begin with humanity collectively—it began with one man.

In the Garden of Eden, God placed Adam in a perfect environment where there was fellowship with God, harmony with creation, and no death.

However, God gave Adam a command.

Genesis 2:16–17 (NIV) “You are free to eat from any tree in the garden; but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for when you eat from it you will certainly die.”

This command established a **covenant relationship** between God and Adam. Adam was not simply living in a garden; he was living under divine authority.

When Adam disobeyed God in **Genesis 3**, something far greater than a personal mistake occurred. His act was **a legal breach of covenant**.

Because Adam represented humanity, his fall affected the entire human race.

Adam was not merely an individual man—he was the **representative head of humanity**.

In theology this is sometimes called **federal headship**, meaning that the actions of one representative affect everyone under his authority.

“When the captain sinks the ship, the passengers go down with it.”

When Adam fell, humanity fell with him.

2. Adam as the Root of Humanity

The Bible presents Adam as the root from which the human family grew.

Every human being who has ever lived traces their origin back to Adam. Therefore, what happened to Adam spiritually affected every person born after him.

When Adam sinned:

- Humanity's spiritual nature became corrupted.
- The image of God in humanity was damaged.
- Fellowship with God was broken.

Just as the health of a tree depends on the root, the spiritual condition of humanity depends on the first man.

“When the root is poisoned, the tree cannot bear healthy fruit.”

Because Adam was the root of humanity, the poison of sin flowed into every branch—every human being.

This explains why sin appears universally across cultures, generations, and societies.

3. Sin as an Inherited Nature

Many people think sin is simply a matter of bad choices. But Scripture teaches that sin is deeper than behavior—it is **a condition of the heart**.

The problem is not merely what humans do; it is **what humans are by nature**.

King David expressed this clearly.

Psalms 51:5 (NIV) “Surely I was sinful at birth, sinful from the time my mother conceived me.”

David did not mean he committed personal sins before birth. Instead, he recognized that humanity **inherits a sinful nature**.

This means:

- People are born with a tendency toward sin.
- The heart naturally moves away from God.
- Human nature has been corrupted.

This explains why even children must be taught righteousness. Without guidance, the natural tendency of the human heart is selfishness.

Jeremiah 17:9 (NIV) “The heart is deceitful above all things and beyond cure. Who can understand it?”

“A bitter spring cannot produce sweet water.” Human nature cannot produce righteousness by its own power.

4. Death Entered Through Sin

Romans 5:12 teaches that **death entered through sin**.

Before Adam sinned, death did not exist in the human experience. Humanity was created for life and fellowship with God.

However, Adam's disobedience opened the door to death in three forms.

Spiritual Death

The first death Adam experienced was spiritual separation from God.

Immediately after sinning, Adam and Eve hid from God.

Genesis 3:8 (NIV) "Then the man and his wife heard the sound of the Lord God as he was walking in the garden... and they hid from the Lord God."

Before sin, Adam walked openly with God. After sin, fear replaced fellowship.

This is the essence of spiritual death: **separation from God**.

Physical Death

Physical death also entered the world through sin.

Human bodies became subject to decay, disease, and mortality.

Romans 6:23 (NIV) "For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord."

The human body was never originally designed for death. Death became humanity's destiny because of sin.

Eternal Death

The final consequence of sin is eternal separation from God.

Without redemption, humanity remains spiritually dead and separated from God forever.

This is why salvation is not merely about improving life on earth—it is about **restoring humanity's relationship with God**.

"A branch cut from the tree cannot survive on its own."

5. The Immediate Effects of Adam's Sin

After Adam sinned, the consequences were immediate and visible.

The harmony of creation collapsed.

Shame Entered

Adam and Eve suddenly felt shame about their nakedness.

Genesis 3:7 (NIV) "Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they realized they were naked."

Innocence was replaced with guilt.

Fear Entered

Adam began to fear God.

Genesis 3:10 (NIV) "I heard you in the garden, and I was afraid because I was naked; so I hid."

Before sin, God's presence brought joy. After sin, it brought fear.

Blame Entered

Adam blamed Eve, and Eve blamed the serpent. Sin destroys relationships and replaces responsibility with accusation.

"When harmony breaks, accusation begins."

Creation Was Cursed

Even the earth was affected.

Genesis 3:17 (NIV) “Cursed is the ground because of you.”

The fall did not only damage humanity—it disrupted creation itself.

Chapter Summary

Adam's fall was not a small mistake; it was **humanity's collapse**.

Through one man:

- Sin entered the world.
- Human nature became corrupted.
- Death became the destiny of humanity.
- Creation itself was affected.

Humanity inherited a fallen nature that could not repair itself.

No philosophy, religion, or moral system can fully solve the problem that began in Adam.

The human story begins with a fall—but it does not end there.

God prepared a solution that would come through another man: **Christ**.

“Where the first man failed, another man would restore.”

Reflection Questions

1. Do I see sin as behavior only, or as a deeper condition within human nature?
2. Why can human effort never fix the problem that began in Adam?
3. How does understanding Adam's fall help me understand the necessity of salvation?

CHAPTER 6

THE BONDAGE OF CREATION — HOW SIN AFFECTS THE WORLD

Romans 8:20 (NIV) “For the creation was subjected to frustration, not by its own choice, but by the will of the one who subjected it, in hope.”

The fall of humanity did not only affect the human soul—it affected **the entire created order**. The universe that God originally declared “very good” became subject to decay, disorder, and suffering.

To understand why the world experiences pain, disasters, and instability, we must understand the biblical teaching that **creation itself fell into bondage when humanity fell into sin**.

“When the foundation cracks, the whole house begins to tremble.”

1. Creation Was Cursed

When Adam disobeyed God, the consequences extended beyond humanity to the earth itself.

God declared this judgment:

Genesis 3:17 (NIV) “Cursed is the ground because of you; through painful toil you will eat food from it all the days of your life.”

Notice that the curse was placed not directly on humanity alone, but also **on the ground**. The earth itself was affected because humanity had been given authority over creation.

In the beginning, God gave Adam dominion over the earth.

Genesis 1:26 (NIV) “Let them rule over the fish in the sea and the birds in the sky... and over all the earth.”

Because Adam was the steward and ruler of creation, when he fell, the world under his authority was also affected.

Creation became subject to:

- **Decay** — everything gradually deteriorates.
- **Disease** — both humans and animals experience suffering.
- **Natural disasters** — earthquakes, storms, and destructive forces.
- **Futility** — systems that once functioned perfectly now struggle.

The earth is not broken because God designed it poorly; it is broken because **sin fractured it**

“When the driver crashes, the passengers suffer.”

Adam was the driver of creation. His crash affected the entire vehicle of existence.

2. The Meaning of “Frustration” or Futility

Romans 8:20 says creation was subjected to **frustration** or **futility**.

The Greek concept behind this word refers to **emptiness, decay, and inability to reach its intended purpose**.

In other words, creation now struggles to function as God originally intended.

Examples include:

- Crops failing despite effort.
- Ecosystems deteriorating.
- Animals suffering and dying.
- Human bodies aging and weakening.

The world still reflects God's glory, but it also shows **signs of brokenness**.

Ecclesiastes 1:2 (NIV) “Meaningless! Meaningless! says the Teacher. Utterly meaningless! Everything is meaningless.”

This does not mean creation has no value—it means creation cannot fully achieve its purpose **while under the curse of sin**.

“A broken instrument cannot play the perfect melody.”

3. The Groaning of Creation

Paul the Apostle describes creation using the language of **groaning. Romans 8:22 (NIV)**. “We know that the whole creation has been groaning as in the pains of childbirth right up to the present time.”

This groaning is not the sound of destruction—it is the sound of **anticipation**. Paul compares creation’s suffering to **the pains of childbirth**, which means something new is coming.

Creation is waiting for redemption. It longs for the day when God will restore what was lost in the fall.

“The night groans because it knows the morning is coming.”

4. Humanity Also Groans

The fall did not only affect the external world—it affected the human soul.

Paul continues:

Romans 8:23 (NIV) “Not only so, but we ourselves, who have the first fruits of the Spirit, groan inwardly as we wait eagerly for our adoption to sonship, the redemption of our bodies.”

Even believers experience the effects of the fallen world:

- sickness
- suffering
- aging
- emotional pain
- spiritual battles

But believers groan with **hope**, knowing redemption is coming.

5. The Consequences of the Fall

Genesis describes several immediate consequences of Adam's sin.

Thorns and Hardship

Genesis 3:18 (NIV) "It will produce thorns and thistles for you."

Work, which was originally joyful, became laborious and difficult.

Pain in Childbirth

Genesis 3:16 (NIV) "I will make your pains in childbearing very severe."

Even the process of bringing life into the world became marked by suffering.

Relational Conflict

Human relationships also became strained.

Conflict between people, families, and nations reflects the brokenness introduced by sin.

Spiritual Blindness

Humanity's ability to understand God became darkened.

2 Corinthians 4:4 (NIV) "The god of this age has blinded the minds of unbelievers."

Without spiritual renewal, people struggle to perceive divine truth.

"A blind man cannot describe the colors of the sunrise."

6. The Rapid Spread of Sin

The corruption introduced by Adam spread quickly.

A powerful example appears in the story of Cain and Abel. In **Genesis 4**, Cain murdered his brother Abel.

This event occurred in the **second generation of humanity**. It demonstrates how quickly sin can corrupt the human heart.

Genesis 4:8 (NIV) "Now Cain said to his brother Abel, 'Let's go out to the field.' While they were in the field, Cain attacked his brother Abel and killed him."

Violence, jealousy, and hatred became part of human history.

"A spark in dry grass quickly becomes a wildfire."

7. Creation Awaits Redemption Through Christ

Although creation is under bondage, the Bible promises that restoration is coming.

Romans 8:21 (NIV) "That the creation itself will be liberated from its bondage to decay and brought into the freedom and glory of the children of God."

The redemption accomplished by Jesus Christ will ultimately restore the entire cosmos.

This restoration will include:

- A renewed creation
- Freedom from decay
- Harmony between humanity and nature

- Eternal life for God's people

"The storm may rage, but the sunrise is certain."

Chapter Summary

Sin did not affect humanity alone—it affected **the entire cosmos**.

Through Adam's fall:

- Creation became subject to decay and suffering.
- The natural world began to experience disorder.
- Humanity experienced spiritual blindness and relational conflict.

Yet creation is not hopeless.

The world is **groaning in anticipation**, waiting for the redemption that comes through Christ.

The fall explains the brokenness of the world, but the gospel announces **its future restoration**.

Reflection Questions

1. How does understanding creation's fall deepen my appreciation for salvation?
2. Why can political systems, philosophy, or science never fully repair a world broken by sin?
3. How does the promise of creation's restoration give hope in a suffering world?

The Last Adam — God's Answer to the Fall

This will connect:

- **Romans 5:17–19**
- **1 Corinthians 15:45**
- **Colossians 2:14–15** (which you mentioned earlier) the victory of Christ over sin, death, and the curse.

CHAPTER 7

THE LAST ADAM — CHRIST, THE LIFE-GIVER

1 Corinthians 15:45 (NIV) “So it is written: ‘The first man Adam became a living being’; the last Adam, a life-giving spirit.”

The story of humanity can be understood through two representative men: Adam and Jesus Christ.

The first Adam introduced sin, death, and separation from God. The Last Adam came to reverse that tragedy and restore life.

Understanding this contrast is essential to understanding the gospel itself.

“When the first foundation cracks, a new foundation must be laid.” Christ is that new foundation for humanity.

1. Why Jesus Is Called the Last Adam

The Bible presents Adam as the **representative head of the human race**. When he sinned, humanity fell with him.

Adam was not simply an individual; he represented all humanity. His decision affected every person born after him.

Through Adam came:

- **Sin** — corruption entered human nature.
- **Death** — both spiritual and physical death began.
- **Separation from God** — fellowship with God was broken.

But God did not abandon humanity. He sent His Son, Jesus Christ, as a new representative for humanity.

The apostle Paul the Apostle explains this contrast clearly.

Romans 5:18 (NIV) “Consequently, just as one trespass resulted in condemnation for all people, so also one righteous act resulted in justification and life for all people.”

Where Adam’s action brought condemnation, Christ’s obedience brought justification.

Through Christ came:

- **Righteousness** — a restored relationship with God.
- **Life** — spiritual life and eternal life.
- **Reconciliation** — peace between humanity and God.

Jesus is not called the “second Adam” but the **Last Adam** because there will never be another representative head after Him.

Christ’s work is final, complete, and sufficient.

“The first signature brought debt; the second signature cleared the account.”

Adam signed humanity into bankruptcy. Christ signed humanity into redemption.

2. The Spiritual Exchange at the Cross

The cross was not simply a tragic execution—it was the moment of a **divine exchange**.

At the cross, Christ took upon Himself the consequences of human sin so that humanity could receive the blessings of His righteousness.

This exchange is described clearly in Scripture.

2 Corinthians 5:21 (NIV) “God made him who had no sin to be sin for us, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.”

This verse reveals the heart of the gospel. At the cross:

- Christ took our **sin**.
- We received His **righteousness**.

He took our **death** so that we might receive His **life**. He carried our **condemnation** so that we could receive **justification**.

This exchange was possible because Christ lived a perfectly righteous life and willingly offered Himself as a sacrifice.

"The innocent stepped into the courtroom and took the sentence of the guilty."

3. Substitution: Christ Took Our Place

The work of Christ on the cross is often described as **substitution**.

Substitution means that Christ stood in the place of sinners and bore the punishment that belonged to them.

A powerful illustration appears in the trial of Barabbas.

Barabbas was guilty of crimes against the Roman government and deserved punishment. Yet he was released while Jesus was condemned.

Matthew 27:26 (NIV) "Then he released Barabbas to them. But he had Jesus flogged, and handed him over to be crucified."

Barabbas walked free while Christ took his place.

This story illustrates the essence of the gospel: **the guilty go free because the innocent takes their place**.

"The prisoner walked out because another took the chains."

4. Christ Restored What Adam Lost

The fall of Adam caused humanity to lose several vital blessings.

Through Christ, these blessings are restored.

Life Restored

Adam brought death; Christ brings life.

John 10:10 (NIV) “I have come that they may have life, and have it to the full.”

Righteousness Restored

Adam’s sin brought condemnation, but Christ gives righteousness.

Romans 5:17 (NIV) “Those who receive God’s abundant provision of grace and of the gift of righteousness will reign in life through the one man, Jesus Christ.”

Relationship Restored

Through Christ, believers are reconciled with God. **Romans 5:10 (NIV)** “While we were God’s enemies, we were reconciled to him through the death of his Son.”

What Adam lost in the garden, Christ restores through the cross. *“Where the first man closed the gate, the second man opened it again.”*

5. The Last Adam Gives Spiritual Life

The first Adam became a living being, but Christ gives **life to others**.

This is why Paul describes Christ as **a life-giving spirit**. The new life that Christ gives is not merely physical existence—it is **spiritual life**.

This life includes:

- Reconciliation with God
- Freedom from condemnation
- the indwelling presence of the Holy Spirit
- The promise of eternal life

Those who believe in Christ are transferred from the old humanity in Adam into the new humanity in Christ.

"A new tree begins when the seed changes."

Chapter Summary

Jesus Christ is the **Last Adam**, the final and perfect representative of humanity.

Through Adam came:

- Sin
- Death
- Separation from God.

Through Christ came:

- Righteousness
- Life
- Reconciliation.

At the cross, a divine exchange occurred. Christ took the penalty of sin so that humanity could receive forgiveness and new life.

What was lost through Adam has been restored through Christ.

"The first chapter of humanity was written in Adam, but the final chapter is written in Christ."

Reflection Questions

1. Do I truly understand my identity in the Last Adam?
2. Am I living according to Adam's fallen nature or according to Christ's victory?
3. How does Christ's substitution on the cross change the way I view salvation?

CHAPTER 8

WHY THE BLOOD OF CHRIST WAS NECESSARY FOR SALVATION

The Mystery of the Blood

One of the deepest truths in the gospel is the **power of the blood**. From the beginning of Scripture to the end, the Bible reveals that the blood is central to God's plan of redemption.

Without understanding this truth, it is difficult to fully appreciate the sacrifice of **Jesus Christ**.

*When the foundation is understood, the whole building makes sense. The blood of Christ is the **foundation of salvation**.*

1. Life Is in the Blood

The first reason the blood was necessary is because **life is contained in the blood**.

Leviticus 17:11 "For the life of the flesh is in the blood, and I have given it to you upon the altar to make atonement for your souls."

God established a spiritual principle: **atonement for sin requires the giving of life**.

Sin brings death, and therefore a life had to be offered in order to restore life. *Where a life is taken, a life must answer for it.*

2. Sin Demands Justice

God is loving, but He is also just. Sin cannot simply be ignored because it violates God's holiness.

Romans 6:23 “For the wages of sin is death.”

Justice demanded that the penalty of sin be paid. If God simply overlooked sin, His justice would be compromised.

Therefore, the shedding of blood became the way for justice and mercy to meet. *A judge who ignores crime destroys justice.*

The cross allowed God to remain **both just and merciful**.

3. The Old Testament Sacrifices Pointed to Christ

In the Old Testament, animals were sacrificed as offerings for sin. These sacrifices were performed repeatedly because they could only provide temporary covering.

Hebrews 10:4 “It is not possible that the blood of bulls and goats could take away sins.”

Those sacrifices were **symbols pointing to the coming Messiah**. *A shadow announces that the real person is near.*

All the sacrifices in the Old Testament pointed to the ultimate sacrifice of Christ.

4. Christ Became the Perfect Sacrifice

Unlike animal sacrifices, Christ offered Himself as a perfect and sinless sacrifice.

1 Peter 1:18–19 “You were not redeemed with corruptible things like silver or gold... but with the precious blood of Christ, as of a lamb without blemish.”

Because Jesus was sinless, His sacrifice was sufficient to deal with the sins of the entire world.

A perfect payment clears even the greatest debt. The blood of Christ accomplished what no other sacrifice could accomplish.

5. What the Blood of Christ Accomplished

The blood of Christ brought several powerful blessings to believers.

1. Redemption

Believers are purchased from the bondage of sin. **Ephesians 1:7**

2. Remission of Sins

Sins are forgiven and removed. **Matthew 26:28**

3. Reconciliation With God

Humanity is restored to fellowship with God. **Colossians 1:20**

4. Cleansing of the Conscience

Believers are freed from guilt and condemnation. **Hebrews 9:14**

6. The Power of the Blood Today

The blood of Christ is not merely a historical event; it continues to speak for believers today.

1 John 1:7 "The blood of Jesus Christ His Son cleanses us from all sin."

Through the blood of Christ:

- Believers receive forgiveness
- Believers overcome the enemy
- Believers walk in spiritual victory

The blood is the signature that seals the covenant.

Conclusion: The Price of Our Salvation

The blood of Christ reveals the depth of God's love and the seriousness of sin. Salvation was not cheap; it required the greatest sacrifice heaven could offer.

Because of the sacrifice of **Jesus Christ**, humanity can now approach God with confidence.

Hebrews 10:19 "Having boldness to enter the Holiest by the blood of Jesus."

When the price is fully paid, the door of freedom stands open.

The blood of Christ remains the **eternal testimony that salvation has been secured.**

CHAPTER 9

THE FINISHED WORK OF THE CROSS

Hebrews 10:14 (NIV) “For by one sacrifice he has made perfect forever those who are being made holy.”

Colossians 2:14–15 (NIV) “Having canceled the charge of our legal indebtedness, which stood against us and condemned us; he has taken it away, nailing it to the cross.

And having disarmed the powers and authorities, he made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross.”

The cross stands at the center of the Christian faith. Everything in the gospel—repentance, forgiveness, salvation, and new life—flows from what happened at the cross of Jesus Christ.

It was not merely a place of suffering; it was the place where God completed the work of redemption.

“Where the wound was deepest, the healing began.”

1. “It Is Finished”

As Jesus hung on the cross, He spoke three powerful words recorded in the Gospel of John:

John 19:30 (NIV) “When he had received the drink, Jesus said, ‘It is finished.’ With that, he bowed his head and gave up his spirit.”

This statement was not an expression of defeat—it was a declaration of victory.

The Greek word used here is *tetelestai*, a word often used in ancient financial records to indicate that a debt had been **fully paid**.

The word carries several powerful meanings:

- **Paid in full**
- **Completed**
- **Accomplished**

Jesus was announcing that the mission given to Him by the Father had been fully completed.

Everything necessary for humanity's redemption had been accomplished.

"When the debt is stamped 'Paid,' the collector has no voice."

At the cross, the debt of sin was settled once and for all.

2. Perfected Forever

The book of Hebrews reveals a remarkable truth about Christ's sacrifice.

Hebrews 10:14 (NIV) "For by one sacrifice he has made perfect forever those who are being made holy."

This verse contains two important realities that must be understood together.

Our Position Before God

Through the sacrifice of Christ, believers are declared **perfect in their legal standing before God**.

This is called **justification**—God declares the believer righteous because of Christ's finished work.

It does not mean the believer has reached moral perfection, but it means the believer's **status before God is settled**.

Our Ongoing Transformation

While justification is immediate and complete, sanctification is progressive.

Sanctification is the process through which believers grow in holiness as they walk with God.

Therefore, the Christian life involves two truths:

- We **are perfected in Christ** before God.
- We **are being transformed** in our daily lives.

“The adoption papers are signed instantly, but the child grows into the family over time.”

Our identity is secure even while our character continues to mature.

3. The Cancellation of Sin’s Record

Before the cross, humanity carried a record of guilt before God.

The apostle Paul the Apostle explains this clearly.

Colossians 2:14 (NIV) “Having canceled the charge of our legal indebtedness, which stood against us and condemned us; he has taken it away, nailing it to the cross.”

The phrase “**legal indebtedness**” refers to a written record of debts or charges.

In ancient times, debts were recorded in documents that legally bound the debtor. Paul uses this imagery to describe humanity’s condition before God.

Because of sin, humanity carried a record of guilt that condemned us. But at the cross, that record was **canceled**.

Christ did not simply cover the record—He **removed it completely**.
"A erased record cannot be used in court."

Once the charge is canceled, the accusation loses its authority.

4. Disarming the Enemy

The cross did more than forgive sin—it defeated the forces of darkness.

Colossians 2:15 (NIV) "And having disarmed the powers and authorities, he made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross."

The "powers and authorities" refer to spiritual forces that oppose God's kingdom. One of the primary weapons used by Satan is **accusation**.

The enemy accuses humanity because of sin. But once Christ paid the penalty for sin, the legal basis for accusation was removed. The enemy was **disarmed**.

The cross transformed what looked like defeat into victory.

"A soldier without weapons cannot win the battle." Through the cross, the weapons of condemnation and accusation were stripped away.

5. A Prophetic Picture in the Old Testament

A powerful prophetic picture of this victory appears in the book of Zechariah. In **Zechariah 3**, the high priest Joshua stands before God wearing filthy garments while Satan accuses him.

But God rebukes the accuser and orders that Joshua's filthy garments be removed and replaced with clean clothing.

Zechariah 3:4 (NIV) "See, I have taken away your sin, and I will put fine garments on you."

This scene foreshadows the work of Christ.

Through the cross:

- Sin is removed
- Accusation is silenced
- Righteousness is given.

"When the king changes the clothes, the accusation loses its power."

6. The Cross as God's Final Answer to Sin

The cross was not a temporary solution—it was the **final answer to the problem of sin**.

Unlike the sacrifices of the Old Testament, which had to be repeated, Christ's sacrifice was offered **once for all time**.

Hebrews 10:12 (NIV) "But when this priest had offered for all time one sacrifice for sins, he sat down at the right hand of God."

The fact that Christ sat down signifies that the work was complete. No further sacrifice was required.

"When the builder sits down, the house is finished."

Chapter Summary

The cross was not partial—it was complete. Through the sacrifice of Christ:

- The record of sin was canceled
- The debt of humanity was paid
- The power of accusation was broken
- The forces of darkness were defeated.

The finished work of the cross provides the foundation for salvation, forgiveness, and new life.

Believers do not live trying to finish what Christ began—they live from the reality that **the work has already been completed**.

“The victory was won on the cross before the battle reached our lives.”

Reflection Questions

1. Do I live as though the work of the cross is finished, or do I act as though my salvation is still uncertain?
2. What accusations or guilt do I need to silence by trusting the finished work of Christ?
3. How does understanding the completeness of the cross change my relationship with God?

CHAPTER 10

WHY THE RESURRECTION IS THE HEART OF THE GOSPEL

The gospel of Jesus Christ is built upon one of the greatest events in history: **the resurrection of Jesus Christ**. Without the resurrection, the gospel would be incomplete, and the Christian faith would lose its power.

The apostles understood this truth clearly. That is why whenever they preached the gospel, they emphasized **the resurrection of Jesus**.

1. The Apostles Preached Jesus and the Resurrection

When the apostles proclaimed the gospel, the resurrection was always at the center of their message.

Acts 17:18–19 “Then certain Epicurean and Stoic philosophers encountered him... because he preached to them Jesus and the resurrection.”

Even in Athens, where philosophy and intellectual debate dominated the culture, the apostle Paul did not change his message. He did not replace the gospel with philosophical ideas to impress the thinkers of the city.

Instead, he continued to preach **Jesus and the resurrection**.

This shows that the power of the gospel is not in human wisdom but in the **victory of Christ over death**.

2. The Resurrection Completes the Work of the Cross

The death of Jesus paid the price for sin, but the resurrection demonstrated that the sacrifice was accepted by God.

The apostle Paul summarized the gospel clearly.

1 Corinthians 15:3–4 “Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, and that He was buried, and that He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures.”

These three events form the heart of the gospel:

- Christ **died for our sins**
- He **was buried**
- He **rose again on the third day**

If Christ had died but remained in the grave, there would be no victory over death. The resurrection proves that Jesus conquered **sin, death, and the grave**.

An idiom says: *“Victory is not declared on the battlefield until the enemy is defeated.”*

The resurrection is the moment when the victory of Christ was publicly revealed.

3. The Resurrection Confirms Jesus as the Life-Giving Savior

The resurrection also reveals who Jesus truly is.

1 Corinthians 15:45 “The first man Adam became a living being. The last Adam became a life-giving spirit.”

Adam introduced sin and death into the world. But Jesus, the **Last Adam**, rose from the dead and became the source of **new life**.

Through Adam, humanity inherited death. Through the risen Christ, believers receive **eternal life**.

This is why the resurrection is essential to the gospel. It proves that Jesus is not merely a teacher or prophet—He is the **living Savior**.

4. Salvation Requires Belief in the Resurrection

The Bible clearly teaches that faith in the resurrection is essential for salvation.

Romans 10:9–10 “That if you confess with your mouth the Lord Jesus and believe in your heart that God has raised Him from the dead, you will be saved.”

This verse reveals two important truths:

- Salvation involves **confessing Jesus as Lord**.
- Salvation requires **believing that God raised Him from the dead**.

The resurrection is therefore not a minor doctrine. It is a **central truth that must be believed for salvation**.

5. The Resurrection Proves the Defeat of Sin and Death

The resurrection demonstrates that the power of sin has been broken.

Romans 5:12 teaches that sin entered the world through Adam, bringing death to humanity. For generations, death ruled over mankind.

But when Jesus rose from the dead, He defeated the power of death itself.

An idiom says: *“The sunrise proves that the night has ended.”*

In the same way, the resurrection of Christ proves that the reign of death has been broken for those who believe in Him.

6. The Apostles Warned Against Changing the Gospel

Because the resurrection is central to the gospel, the apostles warned strongly against altering the message.

Galatians 1:8–9 “But even if we, or an angel from heaven, preach any other gospel... let him be accursed.”

This warning reminds believers that the gospel must remain exactly as it was originally preached.

If the message of the cross and resurrection is replaced with philosophy, motivation, or moral instruction, the true gospel is lost.

Conclusion

The resurrection is the **heart of the gospel** because it confirms the victory of Christ and the hope of eternal life.

The Scriptures show us clearly:

The apostles preached **Jesus and the resurrection** (Acts 17:18–19).

Christ died, was buried, and rose again (1 Corinthians 15:3–4).

Jesus is the **Last Adam who gives life** (1 Corinthians 15:45).

Salvation requires believing in the resurrection (Romans 10:9–10).

Anyone who changes this gospel faces a serious warning (Galatians 1:8–9).

For this reason, the Church must continue to proclaim **the risen Christ**, because the resurrection is the foundation of the Christian faith and the hope of salvation.

CHAPTER 11

THE POWER OF REDEMPTION

The Price of Freedom

Human history tells the story of a fallen race longing for restoration. From the moment sin entered the world, humanity lost its original glory, fellowship with God was broken, and the earth came under the bondage of corruption.

Yet God, in His mercy, designed a plan to bring humanity back. That plan is called **redemption**.

Redemption is one of the most powerful words in the gospel. It is not merely forgiveness; it is **a divine rescue mission** in which God Himself paid the price to restore what was lost.

*A prisoner cannot open the prison door from inside; someone outside must pay the price for his release. That “someone” is **Jesus Christ**.*

1. What Redemption Means

The word redemption means **to buy back, rescue, or release by paying a price**.

In ancient times, redemption was commonly used in slave markets. When a slave was redeemed, it meant someone had paid the required price to set that person free.

The Bible uses this powerful picture to explain what Christ did for humanity.

Ephesians 1:7 “In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of sins, according to the riches of His grace.”

Humanity was under the slavery of sin, and only a perfect sacrifice could pay the price for freedom.

2. Why Redemption Was Necessary

Redemption became necessary because of the fall of humanity.

When Adam sinned, the entire human race inherited a sinful nature. Sin brought separation from God, spiritual death, and the curse upon creation.

Romans 5:12 “Through one man sin entered the world, and death through sin, and thus death spread to all men.”

Sin placed humanity in **spiritual captivity**. No human effort, religion, or good works could remove that bondage.

A man drowning in the sea cannot rescue himself; he needs a savior from above. That Savior is Christ.

3. The Price of Redemption

Redemption always requires a price. In the Old Testament, sacrifices were offered to cover sin temporarily, but these sacrifices could never fully remove sin.

Hebrews 10:4 “It is not possible that the blood of bulls and goats could take away sins.”

God therefore provided the ultimate sacrifice—His Son.

1 Peter 1:18–19 “You were not redeemed with corruptible things like silver or gold... but with the precious blood of Christ.”

The blood of Jesus became the **eternal payment** for the redemption of humanity.

When the debt is too great, only a wealthy benefactor can clear the account. Christ cleared the account of sin.

4. What We Are Redeemed From

Redemption delivers believers from several spiritual realities.

1. From the Power of Sin

Romans 6:6

Believers are no longer slaves to sin.

2. From the Curse of the Law

Galatians 3:13

Christ became a curse so that we might be free from the curse.

3. From the Dominion of Satan

Colossians 1:13–14

Believers are delivered from the kingdom of darkness.

4. From Eternal Death

Through redemption, believers receive eternal life.

5. What Redemption Gives Us

Redemption does not only remove bondage; it restores blessings.

Through Christ's redemption we receive:

- Forgiveness of sins
- Reconciliation with God
- Adoption into God's family

- Freedom from condemnation
- Eternal life

Romans 8:1

“There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus.”

Redemption changes our spiritual status completely. *A man once condemned now walks as a free citizen.*

6. Redemption Is Received by Faith

Although Christ paid the price for all humanity, redemption becomes effective only when a person believes in Him.

Romans 3:24–25 “Being justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus.”

Faith connects the believer to the finished work of the cross.

7. Living as the Redeemed

Redemption is not only a doctrine; it is a lifestyle.

Those who are redeemed must live in the freedom Christ purchased for them.

Galatians 5:1 “Stand fast therefore in the liberty by which Christ has made us free.”

A redeemed life is marked by:

- Holiness
- Gratitude
- Obedience
- Devotion to God

A freed slave should not return to the chains he was rescued from.

Conclusion: The Song of the Redeemed

Redemption is the heart of the gospel. Through the blood of Christ, humanity was rescued from the kingdom of darkness and restored to fellowship with God.

One day in eternity, the redeemed will sing the song of salvation before God's throne.

Revelation 5:9 "You were slain, and have redeemed us to God by Your blood."

The cross settled the matter.

The price was paid.

The door of freedom was opened.

*When the ransom is paid, the captive walks free. And through **Jesus Christ**, humanity has been eternally redeemed.*

CHAPTER 12

THE MYSTERY OF REMISSION OF SINS

When the Record Is Erased

One of the greatest blessings of the gospel is the **remission of sins**. Humanity's greatest problem has never been poverty, sickness, or ignorance; it has always been **sin**.

Sin separates people from God and brings guilt, condemnation, and spiritual death.

But through the sacrifice of **Jesus Christ**, God provided a way for sins not only to be forgiven but also **removed from the record**. This divine act is called **remission**.

When a debt is wiped from the ledger, the debtor stands free. Remission means that God clears the account of sin.

1. What Remission Means

The word **remission** means **the cancellation, removal, or complete forgiveness of sin**.

It is not simply ignoring sin. Instead, it is **God removing the guilt and penalty of sin because the price has been paid**.

Hebrews 9:22 "Without shedding of blood there is no remission."

This verse reveals an important truth: **sin cannot be forgiven without a sacrifice**. Justice demands payment, and God's justice was satisfied through the blood of Christ.

2. The Old Testament Shadow of Remission

In the Old Testament, sacrifices were offered regularly to deal with sin. Animals were sacrificed, and their blood was used as a temporary covering.

However, these sacrifices could not permanently remove sin.

Hebrews 10:4 “It is not possible that the blood of bulls and goats could take away sins.”

Those sacrifices only **pointed forward to the perfect sacrifice of Christ.**

A shadow cannot replace the person who casts it. The Old Testament sacrifices were only shadows of the real solution that would come through Jesus.

3. Remission Through the Blood of Christ

When Jesus died on the cross, His blood accomplished what animal sacrifices could never achieve.

Matthew 26:28 “This is My blood of the new covenant, which is shed for many for the remission of sins.”

The blood of Christ:

- Removes guilt
- Cancels the penalty of sin
- Restores fellowship with God

When the judge signs the pardon, the prisoner walks out of the prison gate.

Christ's blood became the **divine pardon for humanity.**

4. Remission and the Gospel Message

The early apostles preached remission as the heart of the gospel.

Acts 2:38 “Repent, and let every one of you be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins.”

Repentance and faith open the door for the remission of sins.

This means that when a person truly turns to Christ:

- Their sins are forgiven
- Their guilt is removed
- Their record before God is cleared

5. The Difference Between Remission and Redemption

Although they are closely connected, remission and redemption are not the same.

- **Redemption** refers to the price that was paid to rescue humanity from bondage.
- **Remission** refers to the cancellation of the sins after the price has been paid.

Redemption pays the ransom; remission tears up the charges. Through Christ's work, both were accomplished for believers.

6. The Blessing of Remission

When a person receives remission of sins, several spiritual blessings follow:

1. Freedom from Guilt

The conscience is cleansed.

Hebrews 10:22

2. Peace with God

The barrier between humanity and God is removed.

3. A New Beginning

Remission opens the door to a transformed life. *When the slate is wiped clean, a new story can begin.*

7. Living in the Reality of Remission

Many believers struggle with guilt even after receiving forgiveness. Yet the gospel declares that Christ has already dealt with sin.

Believers must learn to **walk in the freedom of remission**.

Romans 8:1 "There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus."

Remission means that the believer is no longer condemned before God.

However, this freedom should lead to **holiness, not careless living**. *A man who receives mercy should not return to the crime that almost destroyed him.*

Conclusion: The Beauty of a Cleansed Record

Remission reveals the depth of God's mercy. Through the sacrifice of Christ, the record of sin can be erased, and the sinner can stand before God as forgiven and restored.

The gospel declares that **no sin is too great for the blood of Christ to cleanse**.

Through **Jesus Christ**, humanity receives the greatest gift: **the remission of sins and a new life with God**. *When the record is erased, the future is opened.*

CHAPTER 13

REDEMPTION, REMISSION, AND JUSTIFICATION — THE THREE PILLARS OF SALVATION

The Three Dimensions of Salvation

The salvation accomplished by **Jesus Christ** is deeper than many people realize.

The gospel is not only about forgiveness; it is a complete work that restores humanity to God.

Three important truths reveal the depth of salvation:

1. **Redemption**
2. **Remission**
3. **Justification**

These three pillars work together to form the foundation of the believer's salvation.

A house cannot stand on one pillar; it must rest on a strong foundation.

In the same way, the believer's salvation rests on these three divine acts.

1. Redemption — The Price Was Paid

Redemption refers to the **price paid to rescue humanity from the bondage of sin**.

Humanity fell into slavery through sin, and a ransom was required to set humanity free.

Ephesians 1:7 "In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of sins, according to the riches of His grace."

The blood of Christ became the ransom that purchased our freedom. Through redemption, believers are delivered from:

- The power of sin
- The curse of the law
- The dominion of Satan

Redemption is like paying the ransom that releases a captive from prison. The cross was the payment that bought our freedom.

2. Remission — The Record Was Cleared

Remission refers to the **removal and cancellation of sin after the price has been paid.**

Hebrews 9:22 “Without shedding of blood there is no remission.”

The blood of Christ did not only pay the price for sin; it also **removed the guilt and the record of sin.**

Through remission:

- sins are forgiven
- guilt is removed
- the record of sin is erased

If redemption pays the debt, remission tears the page out of the record book. Because of remission, believers are no longer condemned before God.

3. Justification — The Believer Is Declared Righteous

Justification is the third pillar of salvation. It means **God declares the believer righteous in His sight.**

This is more than forgiveness. It is a legal declaration from God's court that the believer is now righteous.

Romans 5:1 "Therefore, having been justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ."

Through justification:

- The believer is accepted by God
- The believer stands righteous before God
- The believer receives peace with God

Justification is like a judge declaring an accused person completely innocent. In God's courtroom, the believer is not merely pardoned but **declared righteous**.

4. How the Three Work Together

These three pillars form a beautiful picture of salvation.

1. **Redemption** — The ransom is paid.
2. **Remission** — The sin is removed.
3. **Justification** — The believer is declared righteous.

Another way to understand it:

- Redemption deals with **bondage**
- Remission deals with **sin**
- Justification deals with **our standing before God**

First the chains are broken, then the record is erased, and finally the person is welcomed as a free citizen. This is the full picture of salvation.

5. The Believer's Responsibility

Although Christ accomplished salvation, believers must respond by faith and obedience.

Romans 3:24 "Being justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus."

Faith connects the believer to the finished work of Christ.

Those who receive this salvation must live in holiness and gratitude. *"A man who has been rescued from the storm should not return to the sinking ship."*

Conclusion: The Complete Work of the Cross

The cross of Christ accomplished more than many people understand. Through His sacrifice, God provided a complete salvation.

Through **redemption**, the believer is set free. Through **remission**, the believer's sins are removed. Through **justification**, the believer is declared righteous.

This is the beauty of the gospel

Romans 8:1 "There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus."

Because of **Jesus Christ**, the believer can stand before God free, forgiven, and justified.

When the judge cancels the debt and declares the prisoner innocent, freedom becomes permanent.

CHAPTER 14

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN SALVATION, REDEMPTION, AND BEING BORN AGAIN

Understanding the Language of the Gospel

Many believers use the words **salvation**, **redemption**, and **being born again** as if they mean the same thing. Although they are closely connected, they describe **different aspects of God's work in rescuing humanity**.

Understanding these truths helps believers appreciate the depth of what **Jesus Christ** accomplished through the cross.

When you understand the parts of a key, you understand how it opens the door. In the same way, these three truths unlock the full understanding of the gospel.

1. Redemption — The Price of Freedom

Redemption is the **payment of a ransom to set someone free from bondage**.

Humanity fell under the power of sin, and a price had to be paid to bring humanity back to God.

Ephesians 1:7 "In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of sins, according to the riches of His grace."

Through redemption:

- The price of sin was paid
- Humanity was purchased back to God
- The power of sin was broken

Redemption is like paying the ransom that releases a captive. The blood of Christ became the price that purchased humanity's freedom.

2. Salvation — The Complete Rescue

Salvation is the **total deliverance God provides for humanity**. It includes forgiveness, redemption, reconciliation, and eternal life.

Acts 4:12 “Nor is there salvation in any other, for there is no other name under heaven given among men by which we must be saved.”

Salvation rescues humanity from:

- Sin
- Condemnation
- Spiritual death
- Eternal separation from God

If redemption pays the ransom, salvation brings the captive safely home.

Salvation is the **complete package of God's rescue plan**.

3. Being Born Again — The Inner Transformation

Being born again refers to **the spiritual rebirth that happens when a person receives Christ**.

It is not about religion or external change; it is about **a new spiritual life inside a person**.

John 3:3 “Unless one is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God.”

When a person is born again:

- The spirit becomes alive to God
- A new nature is received
- The Holy Spirit begins to dwell within the believer

A washed garment is clean, but a new garment is completely different.

Being born again is not merely cleaning the old life—it is receiving **a new life from God**.

4. How the Three Work Together

These three truths form a complete picture of the gospel.

1. **Redemption** — Christ paid the price.
2. **Salvation** — God rescues the sinner completely.
3. **Being Born Again** — The sinner receives a new spiritual life.

Another way to understand it:

- Redemption deals with **the price of sin**.
- Salvation deals with **deliverance from sin**.
- Being born again deals with **the transformation of the heart**.

First the prisoner is ransomed, then he is rescued from the prison, and finally he begins a new life as a free man.

5. Why Being Born Again Is Necessary

Many people practice religion but have never experienced spiritual rebirth.

Religion may change behavior, but **only the new birth changes the nature of a person**.

2 Corinthians 5:17 “If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation.”

The new birth is the evidence that salvation has truly taken place.

Conclusion: The Full Work of the Gospel

The gospel reveals the beauty of God's plan for humanity.

Through **redemption**, the price for sin was paid. Through **salvation**, humanity is rescued from destruction. Through **the new birth**, believers receive a new life from God.

All of this is made possible through **Jesus Christ**.

When the chains are broken and the heart is changed, true freedom begins.

The gospel is not only about escaping judgment—it is about **entering a completely new life with God**.

CHAPTER 15

YOU ARE SAVED, YOU ARE BEING SAVED, AND YOU WILL BE SAVED

The Three Dimensions of Salvation

One of the reasons many believers become confused about salvation is that the Bible speaks about it in **three different ways**.

Sometimes Scripture says believers **are saved**, sometimes it says they **are being saved**, and at other times it says they **will be saved**.

At first glance, this may seem contradictory. But when understood properly, it reveals the **beautiful and complete plan of God for humanity** through **Jesus Christ**.

A journey has a beginning, a road, and a destination. Salvation follows the same pattern.

1. We Have Been Saved — The Past Work of Salvation

The first dimension of salvation refers to what Christ already accomplished through His death and resurrection.

Ephesians 2:8 “For by grace you have been saved through faith.”

This refers to the moment when a person believes in Christ and receives forgiveness of sins.

At that moment:

- The believer is **justified** before God
- The believer is **born again**
- The believer receives **eternal life**

The penalty of sin is removed.

*When the judge signs the pardon, the prisoner is legally free. This is often called **justification**.*

2. We Are Being Saved — The Present Work of Salvation

The second dimension of salvation refers to the **ongoing transformation of the believer's life**.

1 Corinthians 1:18 "To us who are being saved it is the power of God."

This describes the process through which God continues to work in the life of the believer.

During this stage:

- Believers grow in holiness
- The power of sin is gradually broken
- The character of Christ is formed in them

This process is called **sanctification**.

Philippians 2:12 "Work out your own salvation with fear and trembling."

This does not mean earning salvation; it means **living out the salvation already received**.

A seed that has been planted must grow before it becomes a tree.

3. We Will Be Saved — The Future Completion of Salvation

The third dimension of salvation refers to **the final victory over sin and death when Christ returns**.

Romans 13:11 “Now our salvation is nearer than when we first believed.”

When **Jesus Christ** returns:

- Believers will receive **glorified bodies**
- Sin will be **completely removed**
- Death will be **defeated forever**

1 Peter 1:5 “A salvation ready to be revealed in the last time.”

This final stage is called **glorification**. *The race begins at the starting line but is celebrated at the finish line.*

4. Salvation and the Three Parts of Man

These three stages of salvation also relate to the **three parts of human nature**.

According to **1 Thessalonians 5:23**, man consists of:

- Spirit
- Soul
- Body

Salvation touches all three:

1. **The spirit is saved immediately** when we are born again.
2. **The soul is being renewed daily** as we grow in Christ.
3. **The body will be glorified** when Christ returns.

A house may be legally purchased today, renovated over time, and finally fully restored.

5. Why This Truth Is Important

Understanding the three dimensions of salvation protects believers from two dangerous errors:

Error One: Thinking salvation is only future

Some people think salvation only happens at the end of time.

But the Bible teaches that believers **already have eternal life**.

Error Two: Thinking salvation requires no transformation

Others believe that once a person confesses Christ, nothing else matters.

But Scripture teaches that salvation produces **spiritual growth and holiness**.

True salvation includes **both a starting point and a continuing transformation**.

Conclusion: The Journey Toward Glory

Salvation is one of the greatest gifts God has given humanity. Through Christ's sacrifice, believers experience a salvation that spans the past, present, and future.

- **We have been saved** from the penalty of sin.
- **We are being saved** from the power of sin.
- **We will be saved** from the presence of sin.

All of this is made possible through **Jesus Christ**.

The traveler who has begun the journey must keep walking until he reaches the destination.

The Christian life is therefore **a journey that begins at the cross and ends in glory when Christ returns**.

CHAPTER 16

WAS SALVATION FINISHED AT THE CROSS OR IS IT STILL FUTURE?

The Mystery of Salvation

Many Christians ask a profound question: **“Was salvation finished at the cross, or is it something we are still waiting to receive?”**

Understanding this truth is essential because it affects how we live, how we walk in faith, and how we anticipate the return of **Jesus Christ**.

Salvation is both a **finished work** and a **journey**, and the Bible teaches that it spans **past, present, and future**.

A seed is planted today, begins to grow tomorrow, and bears fruit in the future.

1. Salvation Was Accomplished at the Cross

The work of Christ on the cross was **complete and sufficient** for our salvation.

John 19:30 “It is finished.”

This declaration means:

- **Redemption was purchased** – the price of sin was fully paid.
- **Remission was granted** – our sins were forgiven and erased.
- **Justification was provided** – we are declared righteous before God.

The cross is the foundation of salvation, the **cornerstone of God's plan**.

When the foundation is laid, the building can rise safely.

Even though the work was complete, its **benefits are applied over time** in the believer's life.

2. Salvation Is Experienced in the Present

Salvation is not just a historical event; it is **a daily reality for believers**.

Philippians 2:12 “Work out your own salvation with fear and trembling.”

This refers to the process of **sanctification**, where God transforms our lives.

During this journey:

- We grow in holiness.
- We overcome the power of sin.
- Our character becomes more like Christ.

A journey begins with a step, but the traveler must keep moving to reach the destination.

Even though salvation was secured at the cross, it is **experienced progressively** in the believer's life.

3. Salvation Will Be Completed in the Future

The final dimension of salvation is yet to come—**when Christ returns**.

1 Peter 1:5 “A salvation ready to be revealed in the last time.”

At His return:

- Our bodies will be glorified.
- Sin and death will be completely removed.
- Eternal victory will be fully realized.

The ticket is bought today, but the journey ends at the final destination.

This future completion of salvation is often called **glorification**, when the believer fully experiences what Christ secured at the cross.

4. Salvation: Past, Present, and Future

Salvation can be understood in **three time dimensions**:

Dimension	What It Means	Key Scripture
Past	We have been saved from the penalty of sin	Ephesians 2:8
Present	We are being saved from the power of sin	Philippians 2:12
Future	We will be saved from the presence of sin	1 Peter 1:5

First the foundation is laid, then the house is built, and finally the house is completed and furnished.

5. Living with the Hope of Full Salvation

Understanding that salvation is both finished and ongoing gives believers:

1. **Confidence** – We know that Christ has already won the victory.
2. **Perseverance** – We continue to grow spiritually in the present.
3. **Hope** – We eagerly anticipate the fullness of salvation when Christ returns.

Romans 8:24–25 “For we are saved by hope... we wait for it with patience.”

Salvation is not only a one-time event; it is **a journey we walk with Christ until His return.**

The traveler enjoys the journey but looks forward to the destination.

Conclusion: The Journey of Salvation

Salvation is **already finished in principle** but **continues in process and will be perfected in the future.**

- **Finished:** The cross secured victory over sin and death.
- **Ongoing:** We grow in grace, holiness, and Christ-likeness.
- **Future:** Full glorification a waits at Christ's return.

Believers are invited to walk this journey with faith, joy, and hope, knowing that **Jesus Christ** has already won the ultimate victory.

The race has been won in the starting gun, but the runner still presses on to the finish line.

CHAPTER 17

REPENTANCE — THE DOORWAY TO SALVATION

Acts 3:19 (NIV) “Repent, then, and turn to God, so that your sins may be wiped out, that times of refreshing may come from the Lord.”

Repentance is one of the most central messages of the gospel. From the preaching of the prophets in the Old Testament to the message of the apostles in the New Testament, repentance has always been the **first step toward restoration with God**.

Before a person can experience forgiveness, transformation, and new life through Jesus Christ, there must be a **change of direction in the heart**.

Repentance opens the door to salvation. “*A locked door cannot open until the key is turned.*”

Repentance is the turning of that key.

1. What True Repentance Means

Many people misunderstand repentance. They think repentance simply means feeling guilty or saying sorry. But biblical repentance is much deeper.

Repentance is not merely an emotional response; it is a **decision that changes the course of life**.

The Greek word translated as repentance in the New Testament is *metanoia*, which means **a change of mind that results in a change of direction**.

True repentance involves three elements:

Recognition

A person realizes that their life has been moving away from God.

Conviction

The heart becomes aware that sin has broken fellowship with God.

Turning

The person chooses to leave the old path and move toward God.

Repentance is therefore not simply regret—it is **a complete reorientation of the heart and life.**

“You cannot walk east and arrive west.”

If someone continues walking in the same direction, they cannot reach a different destination.

Repentance means turning from sin and walking toward God.

2. Repentance Before Salvation

Throughout the Bible, repentance always precedes restoration.

Before God heals, restores, and forgives, He calls people to turn back to Him.

One of the clearest examples appears in the parable of the prodigal son told by Jesus Christ in **Luke 15**.

In this story, the younger son leaves his father's house and wastes his inheritance in reckless living. Eventually, he finds himself hungry, broken, and feeding pigs.

But something powerful happens.

Luke 15:17 (NIV) “When he came to his senses, he said, ‘How many of my father’s hired servants have food to spare, and here I am starving to death!’”

This moment represents the beginning of repentance.

The prodigal son did three things:

1. **He came to his senses** — he recognized his condition.
2. **He rose up** — he made a decision to change direction.
3. **He returned to his father** — he acted on that decision.

Luke 15:20 (NIV) “So he got up and went to his father.”

Repentance is not merely thinking about returning—it is **actually returning**. *“The road home begins with the first step back.”*

3. Godly Sorrow vs Worldly Sorrow

Not every feeling of regret leads to true repentance. The Bible distinguishes between **worldly sorrow** and **godly sorrow**.

The apostle Paul the Apostle explains this clearly.

2 Corinthians 7:10 (NIV) “Godly sorrow brings repentance that leads to salvation and leaves no regret, but worldly sorrow brings death.”

Worldly Sorrow

Worldly sorrow focuses on the consequences of sin rather than the sin itself.

Examples include:

- Feeling bad because one was caught.
- Regretting the loss caused by sin.

- Experiencing shame without changing behavior.

Worldly sorrow often leads to temporary remorse but not transformation.

Godly Sorrow

Godly sorrow focuses on the offense against God. It leads a person to desire real change and restoration.

King David expressed godly sorrow after his sin.

Psalms 51:4 (NIV) “Against you, you only, have I sinned and done what is evil in your sight.” Godly sorrow leads to repentance, which leads to salvation.

“Rain that only wets the surface cannot nourish the roots.” True repentance must reach the heart.

4. Repentance Is a Door, Not a Destination

Repentance is essential, but it is not the final step in salvation. Repentance opens the door, but **Christ provides the new life**.

After turning from sin, the believer enters into a relationship with Christ through faith.

This leads to:

- Forgiveness of sins
- Reconciliation with God
- Spiritual renewal
- The indwelling of the Holy Spirit

The purpose of repentance is not to keep people in constant fear or guilt. Instead, it leads them into a **covenant relationship with God**.

1 John 1:9 (NIV) “If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness.”

In Christ, repentance leads to freedom rather than condemnation. *“The doorway is not the house—it is the entrance into a new home.”*

Repentance leads us into the life that God intends for His people.

5. The Role of Repentance in the Gospel Message

Repentance was a central message in the preaching of the early church.

The apostles did not preach a gospel without repentance.

For example:

- John the Baptist called people to repentance before the coming of Christ.
- Jesus Christ began His ministry with the same message.

Mark 1:15 (NIV) “The kingdom of God has come near. Repent and believe the good news!”

Repentance and faith work together. Repentance turns a person away from sin, and faith turns the person toward Christ.

“Two feet are needed to walk forward—one leaves the old path, the other steps onto the new one.”

Chapter Summary

Repentance is the doorway into salvation.

It is not merely feeling sorry for sin; it is a decisive turning of the heart toward God.

True repentance involves:

- Recognizing sin
- Feeling godly sorrow
- Turning away from the old life
- Returning to God

Repentance opens the door to forgiveness, restoration, and new life through Christ.

"The journey to a new life begins with turning around."

Reflection Questions

1. Have I truly turned away from sin, or have I only felt regret about it?
2. What direction is my life currently moving toward?
3. Is my sorrow over sin leading to transformation or only temporary regret?

CHAPTER 18

WHAT IT TRULY MEANS TO BE BORN AGAIN

Introduction

The phrase “**born again**” is often used in churches, but many people do not fully understand its meaning.

Some think it simply means joining a church, changing behavior, or adopting a religious lifestyle. However, the Bible teaches that the new birth is something far deeper.

Being born again is **a spiritual** transformation in which God gives a person a new life through Jesus Christ.

It is the transition from the life inherited through Adam to the new life given through Christ.

“You cannot start a new journey with an old passport.”

To understand the new birth, we must first understand **what happened to humanity in Adam**.

1. The Problem: Humanity Fell Through Adam

The Bible explains that sin entered the world through the first man, Adam.

Romans 5:12 (NIV) “Therefore, just as sin entered the world through one man, and death through sin, and in this way death came to all people, because all sinned.”

This means that humanity inherited a **fallen nature**. The problem was not merely individual actions but a deeper condition.

Every human being is born into a world affected by sin and death.

Because of Adam's fall:

- Humanity became spiritually separated from God.
- Sin began to dominate human nature.

- Death became the destiny of every person.

"When the root is poisoned, the fruit cannot be healthy."

2. Creation Was Subjected to Futility

The fall of Adam did not only affect humans; it affected the entire creation.

Romans 8:20 (NIV) "For the creation was subjected to frustration, not by its own choice, but by the will of the one who subjected it, in hope."

The word **futility** or **frustration** means emptiness, corruption, and decay. Humanity lost the original glory that God intended.

This explains why the world experiences:

- Suffering
- Corruption
- Spiritual blindness
- Moral confusion

Without Christ, humanity lives in a **broken system inherited from Adam**. *"A broken compass cannot guide a traveler."*

3. Religion Cannot Solve the Adamic Problem

Many people try to solve the human problem through religion, morality, or traditions. But these efforts cannot remove the fallen nature inherited from Adam.

Even a highly religious man like Nicodemus needed something deeper.

That is why Jesus Christ told him:

John 3:3 (NIV) "Very truly I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless they are born again."

The new birth is necessary because the old nature cannot enter God's kingdom. *"Polishing a rusted metal does not remove the rust inside."*

Religion can improve behavior, but it cannot transform the nature of the heart.

4. Christ Came as the Last Adam

God's solution to the Adamic problem was not reform but **replacement**.

Christ came as the **Last Adam**, representing a new humanity.

1 Corinthians 15:22 (NIV) "For as in Adam all die, so in Christ all will be made alive."

The first Adam brought sin and death, but Christ brought righteousness and life.

Through His death and resurrection:

- The power of sin was broken
- The curse was defeated
- New life became available

The apostle Paul the Apostle described this contrast clearly.

"Where the first door closed, the second door opened wider."

5. The New Birth Transfers a Person into a New Life

When someone believes in Christ, something supernatural happens. The person is spiritually transferred from Adam's family into Christ's family.

2 Corinthians 5:17 (NIV) "Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come: The old has gone, the new is here!"

This transformation includes:

- A new spiritual identity
- A new relationship with God
- Freedom from the dominion of sin
- A new desire to live righteously

The new birth is not merely **turning over a new leaf**; it is **receiving a new life**.

Idiom: *"The caterpillar does not improve itself; it becomes a butterfly."*

6. The New Birth Is the Work of the Holy Spirit

The new birth cannot be produced by human effort. It is the work of the Holy Spirit.

Jesus explained this clearly:

John 3:6 (NIV) "Flesh gives birth to flesh, but the Spirit gives birth to spirit."

Human effort can create religion, but only the Spirit can produce spiritual life.

This is why evangelists must preach the gospel clearly so that people may receive this transformation. *"Life can only come from life."*

Conclusion

To be born again means:

1. Recognizing the fallen condition inherited from Adam.
2. Believing in the saving work of Christ.
3. Receiving new life through the Holy Spirit.
4. Becoming part of a new humanity in Christ.

The new birth is God's answer to the **Adamic problem**.

Without it, religion cannot save, morality cannot restore, and wealth cannot redeem.

But through Christ, humanity can receive **a new beginning and eternal life**.

Finally

"The old story ends in Adam, but the new story begins in Christ."

CHAPTER 19

REPENTANCE, SALVATION, AND THE POWER OF THE CROSS

One of the most misunderstood teachings in many churches today is the subject of repentance after salvation.

Many believers are taught that even after they have confessed **Jesus Christ** as Lord and Savior, they must continue repenting for the sins they committed before they were saved.

As a result, many Christians live in **perpetual guilt**, constantly returning to the same past sins that Christ already paid for on the cross.

Instead of walking in freedom, they live like prisoners who have been released but still believe they are in chains.

This confusion has caused many believers to doubt the **power of the gospel**.

But the question we must ask is this:

Did the cross truly deal with our past sins, or must we keep repenting for them again and again?

To answer this question, we must go back to the foundation of the gospel.

The Purpose of Repentance

Repentance is the doorway into salvation. Before a person comes to God, they must acknowledge their sinful condition and turn away from their old life.

When **John the Baptist** began his ministry, his message was simple:

Matthew 3:2 "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand."

Later, **Jesus Christ** preached the same message:

Mark 1:15 "Repent, and believe in the gospel."

Repentance means:

- Turning away from sin
- Changing one's mind about sin
- Turning toward God.

It is the moment when a sinner recognizes their need for salvation and turns to Christ.

This repentance leads to **conversion**.

What Happens at Salvation

When a person truly receives Christ, something supernatural happens.

The Bible declares:

2 Corinthians 5:17 "Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; old things have passed away; behold, all things have become new."

Salvation is not merely a religious decision. It is a **spiritual transformation**.

The old life ends, and a new life begins.

At that moment:

- The sinner becomes righteous before God
- The past is forgiven
- The person is spiritually reborn.

This is what **Jesus Christ** meant when He told **Nicodemus**:

John 3:3, "Unless one is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God."

When someone is born again, their past sins are **not partially forgiven — they are completely removed**.

The Finished Work of the Cross

The power of salvation lies in the finished work of Christ on the cross.

The Bible says:

Hebrews 10:14, “For by one offering He has perfected forever those who are being sanctified.”

Notice the phrase “**one offering.**”

The sacrifice of Christ was not temporary or incomplete. It was **final and sufficient.**

When **Jesus Christ** died on the cross, He did not pay for some sins and leave others unpaid. He paid for all sins — past, present, and future.

That is why He declared:

John 19:30 “It is finished.”

The work of redemption was completed.

The Problem with Continuous Repentance for Past Sins

Many believers are taught to continually repent for sins they committed **before they were saved.**

This teaching creates a dangerous misunderstanding.

If a person must keep repenting for sins that were already forgiven, it suggests that the cross was **not sufficient.**

It unintentionally denies the power of the gospel.

This is where the warning in Scripture becomes relevant.

2 Timothy 3:5 “Having a form of godliness but denying its power.”

Some people maintain religious practices, but they do not fully believe in the transforming power of the cross.

They confess Christ with their mouths, yet they continue living under condemnation.

But the gospel does not produce **perpetual guilt**. The gospel produces **freedom**.

Repentance After Salvation

This does not mean that believers never repent again. The Christian life involves **growth and sanctification**.

If a believer sins after salvation, they must confess it and turn away from it.

The Bible teaches:

1 John 1:9 "If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness."

This repentance is not about returning to old forgiven sins. It is about maintaining fellowship with God.

There is a difference between:

- Repentance that leads to salvation
- Repentance that restores fellowship

One brings us into the family of God; the other helps us walk rightly within it.

Walking in the Freedom of the Gospel

A believer who understands the power of salvation will not live under constant condemnation.

Instead, they will walk in the freedom of grace.

The Bible declares:

Romans 8:1 "There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus."

The gospel does not keep reminding believers of their past. It calls them into their **new identity in Christ**.

When God forgives, He does not keep records of the forgiven past.

The believer must learn to accept the freedom that Christ has already provided.

Conclusion

Repentance is essential for salvation, but once a person truly receives Christ, their past sins are fully forgiven through the finished work of the cross.

Continuously repenting for sins that were already forgiven can prevent believers from experiencing the fullness of the gospel.

The true power of the gospel is not only that it forgives sin, but that it **creates a new life**.

Through the sacrifice of **Jesus Christ**, the sinner becomes a new creation, free from the guilt of the past and empowered to live a transformed life.

The church must return to preaching the gospel in its fullness — a gospel that does not only call people to repentance, but also leads them into the **freedom and power of redemption**.

CHAPTER 20

WHY MANY PEOPLE HEAR THE GOSPEL BUT ARE NOT TRULY BORN AGAIN

Introduction

In many churches today, thousands of people attend services, sing worship songs, and even participate in religious activities. Yet the question remains: **are they truly born again?**

The Bible shows that hearing the gospel and experiencing true salvation are not always the same thing. Many people receive the message emotionally or intellectually, but their hearts remain unchanged.

This is why the apostles emphasized **the new birth**, not merely religious participation.

When Nicodemus came to Jesus Christ, he was already a religious leader. Yet Jesus told him something shocking.

John 3:3 (NIV) “Very truly I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless they are born again.”

This statement reveals a powerful truth: **religion is not enough; transformation is necessary.**

“A change of clothes does not change the heart.”

1. Some Hear the Gospel but Do Not Understand It

One reason many people are not born again is that they hear the gospel but do not truly understand it.

Jesus explained this through the parable of the sower.

Matthew 13:19 (NIV) “When anyone hears the message about the kingdom and does not understand it, the evil one comes and snatches away what was sown in their heart.”

Without understanding the gospel, the message cannot take root.

A person may hear sermons every week, yet the truth never penetrates the heart. *“Seeds on the road cannot grow roots.”*

2. Some Receive the Gospel Emotionally but Not Deeply

Another group receives the message with excitement but lacks depth.

Matthew 13:20–21 (NIV) “The seed falling on rocky ground refers to someone who hears the word and at once receives it with joy. But since they have no root, they last only a short time.”

These people respond emotionally, but when challenges come, they fall away.

The apostles taught that true faith produces **endurance and transformation**. *“A house without foundation cannot survive the storm.”*

3. Some Hear the Gospel but Remain Attached to the World

Others hear the gospel but remain entangled in worldly desires.

Matthew 13:22 (NIV) “The seed falling among the thorns refers to someone who hears the word, but the worries of this life and the deceitfulness of wealth choke the word.”

Wealth, ambitions, and worldly concerns can suffocate spiritual life.

This explains why both the rich and the poor must hear the gospel. Material conditions cannot replace spiritual transformation. *“A plant surrounded by thorns cannot grow freely.”*

4. True Salvation Produces a New Life

When someone is truly born again, a real transformation occurs. The apostle Paul the Apostle described it clearly.

2 Corinthians 5:17 (NIV) “Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come: The old has gone, the new is here!”

Salvation is not simply improvement; it is **new creation**. Old patterns begin to disappear, and a new desire to follow God emerges. *“When the root changes, the fruit also changes.”*

5. The Role of the Holy Spirit in the New Birth

The new birth is not something humans produce by effort. It is the work of the Holy Spirit.

Jesus explained this to Nicodemus. **John 3:5–6 (NIV)** “No one can enter the kingdom of God unless they are born of water and the Spirit. Flesh gives birth to flesh, but the Spirit gives birth to spirit.”

Human effort can create religion, but **only the Spirit can produce life**. *“A river cannot flow without a source.”*

6. Evidence of True New Birth

The apostles taught that genuine salvation produces visible evidence.

These signs include:

- A desire to obey God
- Freedom from the domination of sin
- Love for God and others
- Spiritual growth

1 John 3:9 (NIV) “No one who is born of God will continue to sin, because God’s seed remains in them.”

This does not mean believers never fail, but it means **sin no longer rules their lives.**

"A new king changes the laws of the kingdom."

Conclusion

Many people hear the gospel but are not truly born again because:

1. They do not understand the message.
2. They receive it emotionally but without depth.
3. Worldly desires choke the truth.
4. They accept religion instead of transformation.

True salvation produces **a new heart, a new life, and a new direction.**

The mission of every evangelist is therefore not only to preach but to lead people into **genuine new birth through Christ.**

Finally

"The gospel is not meant to decorate life; it is meant to transform it."

CHAPTER 21

FREEDOM FROM SIN AND CONDEMNATION

Romans 8:1 (NIV) “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.”

Romans 6:14 (NIV) “For sin shall no longer be your master, because you are not under the law, but under grace.”

One of the greatest truths in the gospel is the freedom believers receive through Jesus Christ. The cross not only forgives sin—it also breaks sin's power and removes the condemnation that once stood against humanity.

Through Christ, believers are no longer prisoners of guilt, fear, or spiritual bondage. Instead, they enter a new life governed by grace and empowered by the Holy Spirit.

“The chains may remain on the floor, but the prisoner has already walked out.”

1. What Condemnation Means

To understand the freedom Christ brings, we must first understand the meaning of condemnation.

Condemnation is a **legal verdict of guilt** pronounced by a judge. It carries a sentence that must be executed. Because of sin, humanity stood condemned before God.

Romans 3:23 (NIV) “For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.”

Sin placed humanity under a sentence of spiritual death and separation from God. But through Christ, that sentence has been removed.

Romans 8:1 (NIV) “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.”

Notice the phrase “**now no condemnation.**” This means the believer’s legal standing before God has completely changed.

Through faith in Christ:

- Guilt is forgiven
- Condemnation is removed
- Acceptance with God is restored.

“You cannot imprison a man who has already been pardoned.” The believer is no longer standing in the courtroom awaiting judgment; the verdict has already been declared in Christ.

2. Understanding Romans 6–7–8

The apostle Paul the Apostle explains the believer’s freedom through three connected chapters in the book of Romans.

Together, Romans 6, 7, and 8 form one of the clearest teachings on the Christian life.

Romans 6: Freedom from the Dominion of Sin

Romans 6 teaches that believers are united with Christ in His death and resurrection. **Romans 6:6 (NIV)** “For we know that our old self was crucified with him so that the body ruled by sin might be done away with, that we should no longer be slaves to sin.”

This means that when Christ died, the believer’s **old identity in Adam** was crucified with Him.

Sin once ruled like a master over humanity. But through Christ, that authority has been broken.

Sin may still tempt, but it no longer has the right to rule. *“A dethroned king may shout orders, but he no longer controls the kingdom.”*

Romans 7: The Struggle Under the Law

Romans 7 describes the struggle of trying to live righteously through human effort alone. Paul explains how the law reveals sin but does not provide the power to overcome it.

Romans 7:19 (NIV) “For I do not do the good I want to do, but the evil I do not want to do—this I keep on doing.”

The law shows what is right, but it cannot change the human heart. Without the power of the Spirit, people remain trapped in a cycle of failure and frustration.

This is why many religious people struggle: they try to obey God through **self-effort rather than spiritual transformation**.

“A mirror can show dirt on the face, but it cannot wash it away.” The law reveals sin but cannot remove its power.

Romans 8: Freedom Through the Spirit

Romans 8 reveals the solution: life through the Holy Spirit. **Romans 8:2 (NIV)** “Because through Christ Jesus the law of the Spirit who gives life has set you free from the law of sin and death.”

The Christian life is not achieved through human strength—it is empowered by the Spirit of God living within the believer.

This is why Paul begins the chapter with the declaration:

Romans 8:1 (NIV) “There is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.”

Freedom from condemnation leads to freedom in living. The Christian life is not self-improvement—it is **Spirit-empowered transformation**.

3. Under Grace, Not Under Law

Romans 6:14 states that believers are no longer under the law but under grace.

Grace does not mean that sin no longer matters. Instead, grace provides the **power to overcome sin**.

The law commands righteousness but cannot produce it. Grace transforms the heart so that righteousness becomes possible.

When believers understand their identity in Christ, their behavior begins to change.

“When a man discovers he is a prince, he stops living like a beggar.” Identity shapes conduct.

4. Grace Produces Transformation

A powerful example of grace transforming a life appears in the story of Zacchaeus.

Zacchaeus was a tax collector who had become wealthy through dishonesty. But when he encountered Jesus Christ, something remarkable happened.

Luke 19:8 (NIV) “But Zacchaeus stood up and said to the Lord, ‘Look, Lord! Here and now I give half of my possessions to the poor, and if I have cheated anybody out of anything, I will pay back four times the amount.’”

Notice that Jesus did not command Zacchaeus to repay people. Grace transformed his heart, and restitution followed naturally.

This illustrates an important truth: Grace does not produce careless living—it produces **changed lives**. *“When the heart is changed, the hands begin to act differently.”*

5. Living in the Freedom Christ Provides

Freedom in Christ does not mean the absence of responsibility. Instead, it means living with a new source of power.

Believers now live:

- Empowered by the Holy Spirit
- Guided by God's truth
- Motivated by love rather than fear.

Galatians 5:1 (NIV) “It is for freedom that Christ has set us free.”

This freedom enables believers to live in holiness, not because they must earn acceptance, but because they have already received it.

“A bird flies not because it is forced to, but because it has wings.”

Grace gives believers the wings to live differently.

Chapter Summary

Through Christ:

- Condemnation has been removed
- Sin's dominion has been broken
- Believers are empowered by the Holy Spirit.

Freedom from sin does not mean permission to sin—it means **the power to live a transformed life**.

The believer no longer struggles to earn God's acceptance. Instead, they live from the reality that they are already accepted in Christ.

"The chains of sin were broken at the cross, and the Spirit now leads the believer into freedom."

Reflection Questions

1. Am I trying to live the Christian life through self-effort, or am I relying on the power of the Spirit?
2. Do I see myself as condemned, or do I embrace the freedom Christ has given?
3. In what areas of my life do I need to fully walk in the freedom of grace?

CHAPTER 22

FORGIVEN ONCE, TRANSFORMED FOREVER

Epistle to the Hebrews 10:17 (NIV) *“Their sins and lawless acts I will remember no more.”*

This verse reveals one of the most profound promises of the new covenant: **God chooses not to remember forgiven sin**. It does not mean God loses knowledge; it means He **refuses to hold it against the believer**.

1. Forgiveness Is Complete

Under the old covenant sacrifices were repeated again and again because they **covered sin but did not remove it permanently**.

But Christ's sacrifice accomplished something entirely different.

Epistle to the Hebrews 10:12 explains: “But when this priest had offered for all time one sacrifice for sins, he sat down at the right hand of God.”

The phrase “**sat down**” is important. Priests in the temple never sat because their work was never finished. Jesus sat down because **the work of redemption was complete**.

Two Dimensions of Forgiveness

God's forgiveness operates in two ways:

1. Judicial forgiveness

The legal debt of sin is cancelled.

2. Relational forgiveness

Fellowship with God is restored.

This means the believer is not only **pardoned in court** but also **welcomed back into relationship**. “**When** the record is burned, there is nothing left to read.”

Once Christ removes sin, there is no remaining charge to be brought against the believer. This truth is echoed in **Epistle to the Romans 8:33**: "Who will bring any charge against those whom God has chosen?"

2. Remembering vs. Living in Repentance

Many Christians confuse **memory with guilt**. It is possible to remember past sins without living under condemnation.

There is an important difference between:

Healthy remembrance

- Reminds us of God's mercy
- Produces gratitude
- Strengthens humility

Unhealthy guilt

- replays past failures
- Weakens confidence before God
- Keeps the believer spiritually stuck

Christ died **once for sin**, as explained in **First Epistle of Peter 3:18**.

If a believer continually lives as though forgiveness has not occurred, they unintentionally act as if **the cross was insufficient**.

Conviction vs. Condemnation

The Holy Spirit convicts **to restore**.
Condemnation accuses **to enslave**.

Conviction says:

"Turn back to God."

Condemnation says:

"You will never change."

The first voice leads to life; the second leads to despair.

3. New Identity in Christ

The greatest transformation of salvation is **identity**. **Second Epistle to the Corinthians 5:17** declares: "If anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come."

This means salvation is not merely **behavior improvement**—it is **spiritual rebirth**.

A believer is not simply:

- A sinner trying harder
- A guilty person being tolerated

Instead, they are:

- A **new creation**
- A **child of God**
- A **citizen of God's kingdom**

Old identity belonged to **Adam**; the new identity belongs to **Christ**.

The transformation begins internally and then gradually expresses itself externally through holy living.

4. The Restoration of Peter

A powerful example of restored identity is **Simon Peter**. Peter denied Jesus three times before the crucifixion (recorded in the **Gospel of Luke 22**).

This failure could have permanently defined his life. But after the resurrection, Jesus restored Peter publicly in **Gospel of John 21** by asking him three times:

"Do you love me?" Each question replaced one denial.

After this restoration:

- Peter preached boldly at **Acts of the Apostles 2**
- Three thousand people were saved
- He became one of the foundational leaders of the early church

Peter's failure became part of his testimony, **not his identity**. This shows an important truth:

God redeems our past without allowing it to control our future.

5. Living as the Forgiven

When believers truly understand forgiveness, several changes occur:

1. Confidence in prayer increases

They approach God without fear.

2. Gratitude replaces shame

Their worship becomes sincere.

3. Transformation accelerates

Identity fuels behavior change.

This is why **First Epistle of John 1:9** promises: "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness."

Forgiveness is not fragile—it is **anchored in Christ's finished work**.

Expanded Chapter Summary

Through Christ's sacrifice, forgiveness is complete and permanent. God removes the legal record of sin and restores the believer into relationship with Him.

While believers may remember their past, they are not called to live under its guilt. In Christ they receive a new identity as new creations, living in freedom rather than shame.

Reflection Questions

1. Am I approaching God confidently or still carrying hidden guilt?
2. Do I allow past failures to shape my identity?
3. How would my life change if I fully believed that God has truly forgiven me?

CHAPTER 23

THE GOSPEL OF POWER — VICTORY OVER SIN AND DEATH

Epistle to the Romans 6:16 (NIV) “Don’t you know that when you offer yourselves to someone as obedient slaves, you are slaves of the one you obey...”

This verse reveals a spiritual principle: **what we yield to becomes our master**. Before salvation, humanity was enslaved to sin.

But through Christ, believers are transferred into a new mastery—**righteousness and life**.

1. Grace Is Not Weakness

Some people misunderstand grace as permission to continue sinning. But Scripture teaches the opposite.

Epistle to Titus 2:11–12 (NIV) says: “For the grace of God has appeared... It teaches us to say ‘No’ to ungodliness and worldly passions...”

Grace is not passive. It **trains, disciplines, and empowers** believers to live differently.

Under the law, people were commanded to be holy but lacked the inner power to obey. Under grace, the Holy Spirit works within believers to produce the life God requires.

The law says: “*Do better.*” Grace says: “*Receive new power.*”

“Grace is not a cushion for laziness; it is fuel for transformation.”

Grace does not lower God’s standard—it **provides the strength to meet it**.

2. Authority Over Sin

The apostle Paul explains in **Epistle to the Romans 6** that believers share in Christ's death and resurrection.

Three spiritual realities occur at salvation:

1. We died with Christ

The old self that was enslaved to sin was crucified.

2. We were buried with Christ

Our former life ended.

3. We were raised with Christ

A new life began.

Because of this union with Christ, sin loses its ruling authority.

Paul therefore declares in **Epistle to the Romans 6:14**:

“For sin shall no longer be your master, because you are not under the law, but under grace.”

This does not mean temptation disappears. Temptation still exists, but **dominion has changed**.

Illustration

A thief may knock at the door, but he no longer owns the house.

Believers now have the authority to refuse sin because their identity and allegiance have changed.

3. Victory Over Death

The gospel does not only address sin—it also conquers **death**, the final consequence of sin.

In **First Epistle to the Corinthians 15:55 (NIV)** Paul celebrates:

“Where, O death, is your victory? Where, O death, is your sting?”

Before Christ:

- Death was humanity's ultimate enemy
- The grave appeared final
- Fear dominated human life

But when Jesus rose from the dead, He broke death's authority.

The resurrection means that death is no longer the end for believers—it is a **door into eternal life**.

4. The Sign of Christ's Authority Over Death

Before His own resurrection, Jesus demonstrated His authority over death through the raising of **Lazarus** in **Gospel of John 11**.

Lazarus had been in the tomb four days. Humanly speaking, the situation was beyond hope.

Yet Jesus called him out of the grave. This miracle revealed two important truths:

1. Christ has authority over death.
2. The resurrection power of God is real and active.

Jesus later declared:

"I am the resurrection and the life." The raising of Lazarus foreshadowed the greater victory that would come through Christ's own resurrection.

5. The Gospel as Transforming Power

Many people treat the gospel as **religious information**, but the New Testament describes it as **divine power**.

Paul writes in **Epistle to the Romans 1:16**: "For I am not ashamed of the gospel, because it is the power of God that brings salvation."

This power accomplishes three things:

- 1. It forgives sin.**
- 2. It breaks sin's authority.**
- 3. It promises resurrection life.**

Because of this, believers are not called to live defeated lives. They are called to live **in the victory Christ has already secured.**

Chapter Summary

The gospel is not merely a message about forgiveness—it is the power of God that liberates believers from the dominion of sin and the fear of death.

Through union with Christ in His death and resurrection, believers receive authority to live in righteousness and hope beyond the grave.

Grace empowers transformation, and the resurrection guarantees ultimate victory.

Reflection Questions

1. What habits or influences am I yielding myself to daily?
2. Do I truly believe that Christ has given me authority over sin?
3. How does the hope of resurrection shape the way I live today?

CHAPTER 24

LIVING FORWARD — NEWNESS OF LIFE IN THE LAST ADAM

Epistle to the Romans 6:4 (NIV)

“We were therefore buried with him through baptism into death in order that... we too may live a new life.”

This verse describes the **transition from the old life to the new life**. Through union with Christ, believers share in His death, burial, and resurrection.

The purpose of this union is not only forgiveness—it is **a completely new way of living**.

The Christian life therefore begins with salvation but continues with **ongoing transformation**.

1. Newness Means Movement

The phrase **“newness of life”** implies change, progress, and growth. A person who encounters Christ cannot remain spiritually stagnant. Salvation introduces a **new direction** for life.

Before conversion, life moves toward self-centered desires and sin. After conversion, life begins to move toward **righteousness, holiness, and intimacy with God**. “You cannot drive forward while staring in the rearview mirror.”

A believer who constantly focuses on past failures will struggle to walk confidently into the future God intends.

Paul demonstrates this mindset in **Epistle to the Philippians 3:13–14**:

“Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead, I press on toward the goal...”

The Christian life is therefore **a journey forward**, not a return to the past.

2. Daily Application of the New Life

Living in the **Last Adam**—Christ—means intentionally walking in the new identity given through salvation.

Scripture shows several daily practices that help believers grow in this new life.

Renewing the Mind

Epistle to the Romans 12:2 teaches that believers must allow their thinking to be transformed.

Spiritual growth begins with **renewed thinking**. Old patterns of thought must be replaced with truth from God's Word.

When the mind changes, behavior follows.

Walking in the Spirit

Epistle to the Galatians 5:16 says: “Walk by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the flesh.”

The Christian life is not lived by human strength alone. It requires **dependence on the Holy Spirit**, who guides, convicts, and empowers believers.

Walking in the Spirit means:

- Listening to God's guidance
- Yielding to His direction
- Rejecting sinful impulses

Pursuing Spiritual Growth

Growth happens intentionally. Believers grow through:

- Prayer

- Studying Scripture
- Fellowship with other believers
- Obedience to God

Just as physical life requires nourishment, spiritual life requires **spiritual discipline and devotion**.

3. Spiritual Growth Is a Process

Salvation happens instantly, but maturity develops gradually.

When Jesus called His disciples in the **Gospel of Matthew 4**, they immediately followed Him. Yet they did not instantly understand everything.

Throughout the Gospels they:

- Asked questions
- Made mistakes
- Learned through experience

Even **Simon Peter**, one of the closest disciples, struggled with fear and misunderstanding before becoming a bold leader of the early church.

This shows an important truth:

Calling begins a journey; growth completes it.

God does not expect instant perfection, but He does expect **continual progress**.

4. Living From the Last Adam

Earlier chapters explained that Jesus is the **Last Adam**, the final representative of humanity. The first Adam introduced:

- Sin
- Death
- Separation from God

Christ introduced:

- Righteousness
- Life
- Reconciliation

Because believers are united with Christ, they now live **from His victory rather than Adam's failure**. This new life expresses itself through:

- Holiness
- Faith
- Love
- Obedience

Living in Christ means drawing daily strength from the life He provides.

Expanded Chapter Summary

Through union with Christ in His death and resurrection, believers enter a new life characterized by spiritual growth and transformation.

The Christian life is meant to move forward, not backward. By renewing the mind, walking in the Spirit, and pursuing spiritual maturity, believers progressively reflect the life of Christ, the Last Adam.

Reflection Questions

1. In what areas of my life am I still looking backward instead of moving forward?
2. What daily practices help me grow spiritually?
3. How can I intentionally walk in the new life Christ has given me?

CHAPTER 25

CONVICTION VS CONDEMNATION — WALKING IN ASSURANCE

Epistle to the Romans 8:1 (NIV) “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.”

This verse is a **cornerstone of assurance**. It distinguishes between the **Holy Spirit's work of correction** and Satan's work of accusation. Understanding this difference is critical for living a victorious, confident Christian life.

1. Understanding the Difference

Conviction

Conviction is a **work of the Holy Spirit**. It is:

- **Specific:** It targets particular sins or attitudes.
- **Corrective:** Its purpose is to guide, not to destroy.
- **Restorative:** It leads to repentance and reconciliation with God.

First Epistle of John 2:1 says: “My dear children, I write this to you so that you will not sin. But if anybody does sin, we have an advocate with the Father—Jesus Christ, the Righteous One.”

Conviction points us toward **correction and hope**, not despair.

Condemnation

Condemnation is **accusation from the enemy**. It is:

- **Vague:** It makes us feel guilty without clear guidance.
- **Crushing:** It saps confidence and causes shame.
- **Paralyzing:** It leads to withdrawal, fear, and self-loathing.

“Conviction points to the stain; condemnation declares you the stain.”

Condemnation wants to keep the believer stuck in **yesterday's mistakes**, while conviction redirects toward **today's opportunity in Christ**.

2. Assurance in Christ

Assurance comes from understanding **what Christ has already accomplished**.

1 John 1:9 (NIV): "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness."

Romans 8:1 (NIV): "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

The believer can have **peace and certainty** because salvation is **based on Christ's finished work**, not human effort.

Insight

- Conviction **produces growth**.
- Condemnation **produces fear**.
- Assurance **produces confidence** in God's covenant promises.

"You cannot live in yesterday's storm while sailing today's ship."

The believer moves forward when they respond to conviction and reject condemnation.

3. Responding Properly

When you feel conviction:

1. **Acknowledge it:** Recognize the Holy Spirit is correcting you.
2. **Confess:** Bring the sin into God's light.
3. **Receive forgiveness:** Trust God's promise; Hebrews 10:14 assures that Christ's sacrifice is complete.
4. **Move forward:** Do not linger in guilt or shame.

Biblical Example:

David (Psalm 51) was convicted after sinning with Bathsheba. He did not remain paralyzed in guilt.

He **repented, received restoration**, and continued in his calling as king and worshiper of God.

Condemnation, on the other hand, wants to keep you **frozen in failure**, disconnected from your purpose.

4. Living in Assurance Daily

- Keep your eyes on **Christ's finished work**.
- Distinguish between **Holy Spirit correction and enemy accusation**.
- Walk forward in confidence, knowing **your identity is secure in Him**.

Assurance is the believer's **shield against guilt, power against shame**, and **foundation for boldness** in ministry, evangelism, and daily living.

Chapter Summary

- Conviction restores and guides; condemnation enslaves and deceives.
- Assurance is found in understanding that Christ **paid your debt fully**.
- A believer walks in freedom by **confessing sin, receiving grace, and moving forward**, rather than dwelling in yesterday's mistakes.

Reflection Questions

1. When I feel guilt, how do I discern if it is conviction or condemnation?
2. Am I relying on my own efforts or Christ's finished work for assurance?
3. How can I teach others to walk in assurance, not fear?

CHAPTER 26

WALKING IN HOLINESS — FREEDOM WITHOUT FEAR

First Epistle of Peter 1:15–16 (NIV) *“But just as he who called you is holy, so be holy in all you do; for it is written: ‘Be holy, because I am holy.’”*

This passage establishes the **standard and source of holiness**. God is holy, and because we are called into union with Him, holiness is both our **identity and lifestyle**.

1. Holiness Is Identity Before It Is Action

Many believers think holiness is **first about what they do**. They strive to avoid sin, maintain rituals, or appear righteous. But the Bible teaches that holiness flows **from belonging, not behavior**.

- We are **holy because we are God’s children**, not because our actions earn it.
- Holiness is **who we are in Christ**, and actions are a reflection of that identity.

When holiness is based on identity, obedience flows naturally. When it is based on pressure, it produces anxiety.

“A royal child does not beg to act like royalty—it lives from its identity.”

Believers must internalize their **position in Christ** before they can practice holiness effectively. Like a tree rooted in fertile soil, holiness emerges naturally when the heart is rooted in God.

2. Freedom Without Fear

- Holiness under **law** produces fear: fear of punishment, fear of failure, fear of judgment.
- Holiness under **grace** produces devotion: love, reverence, and desire to reflect God’s character.

First Epistle of John 4:18 (NIV): *“There is no fear in love. But perfect love drives out fear, because fear has to do with punishment. The one who fears is not made perfect in love.”*

Believers who understand grace walk boldly. They obey God **not to earn favor**, but because they **already have favor in Christ**.

Practical Application:

- Stop using guilt as motivation.
- Stop striving for perfection to earn God's approval.
- Walk in **confidence that Christ's righteousness covers you**.

3. Resisting Temptation

Holiness is not the absence of temptation—it is **the power to overcome it**.

First Corinthians 10:13 (NIV): *“No temptation has overtaken you except what is common to mankind.*

And God is faithful; he will not let you be tempted beyond what you can bear. But when you are tempted, he will also provide a way out so that you can endure it.”

- Temptation is **inevitable**, but sin is **optional**.
- God equips every believer with the **strength and strategy** to resist sin.

Biblical Example:

- **Joseph** (Genesis 39) faced sexual temptation with Potiphar's wife.
- He did not rationalize or negotiate; he **fled from sin**, prioritizing God's presence over comfort or gain.

“Do not wait for the trap to close—step away before you are caught.”

Holiness involves proactive choices: avoiding compromise, seeking God's help, and cultivating environments that protect purity.

4. Holiness in Daily Life

Walking in holiness is **practical**:

1. **Renew your mind daily** – Feed on Scripture, meditate on God's truth (Romans 12:2).
2. **Guard your heart** – Remove sources of temptation (Proverbs 4:23).
3. **Practice obedience** – Small acts of obedience reflect large transformation.
4. **Depend on the Spirit** – Without the Holy Spirit, holiness is impossible (Galatians 5:16).

Holiness is not a burden—it is **freedom to reflect God's character** in every area of life.

“Freedom is not doing whatever you want—it is living without what enslaves you.”

Chapter Summary

Holiness flows from **identity in Christ**, not performance.

- **Identity:** We are God's children, set apart for His purposes.
- **Freedom:** Grace removes fear, allowing devotion instead of anxiety.
- **Power:** The Holy Spirit provides strength to resist temptation and live rightly.

Walking in holiness is living **consistently with who you are in Christ**. It is freedom expressed through obedience, not fear or compulsion.

Reflection Questions

1. Am I pursuing holiness out of fear or love for God?
2. In what areas do I need to take **practical steps to avoid temptation**?
3. How can I remind myself daily that holiness is **my identity, not a burden**?
4. Where am I relying on my own strength instead of God's Spirit to live holy?

CHAPTER 27

THE TRANSFORMING POWER OF FAITH IN THE CROSS

Galatians 2:20 (NIV) *"I have been crucified with Christ and I no longer live, but Christ lives in me.*

The life I now live in the body, I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me."

This scripture encapsulates the heart of the Christian life: **our union with Christ in His death and resurrection.**

Faith is not simply mental assent—it is **daily participation in the life of Christ.**

1. Faith Anchored in the Cross

Faith begins where **human effort ends.** The cross declares:

- Sin is paid for completely (Hebrews 10:14)
- The power of death is broken (1 Corinthians 15:55)
- Satan is disarmed (Colossians 2:14–15)

Faith does not try to earn salvation—it rests **on what Christ already accomplished.**

"You do not rebuild a house whose foundation is already perfect."

Trying to live the Christian life apart from faith in the cross is like trying to walk on a bridge without trusting its support.

You will either falter in fear or collapse under the weight of self-effort.

2. Transformation Through Belief

2 Corinthians 3:18 (NIV): *"...we all... are being transformed into his image with ever-increasing glory, which comes from the Lord, who is the Spirit."*

Transformation is **not achieved by focusing on sin**. It happens as we **fix our eyes on Christ**, allowing His life to flow through us.

How it works:

- Crucifixion of the old self means **no longer living under Adam's failures**.
- Resurrection life means **Christ's character, love, and righteousness fill our daily walk**.
- Dependence on the Spirit turns obedience from duty to delight.

"You become the reflection of the face you look at most."

When we dwell on Christ—His love, His work, His victory—**our hearts, thoughts, and actions naturally change**.

Biblical Example:

- Paul, once a persecutor of the Church, became its greatest apostle (Acts 9).
- His transformation was not self-driven; it was **rooted in encountering Christ's life and surrendering to the cross**.

3. Living Crucified and Resurrected Daily

Faith in the cross is **not only positional—it is practical**. Daily life involves:

1. **Acknowledging the death of the old self**
 - Romans 6:6 reminds us: "Our old self was crucified with Him."
 - We stop letting sin dictate thought patterns, emotions, and actions.
2. **Walking in resurrection life**
 - We live in the power of Christ's indwelling Spirit.
 - Choices reflect His righteousness, love, and peace.
3. **Rejecting self-righteousness and dependence on effort**
 - Trust replaces striving.
 - Faith produces obedience without fear of failure.

“Do not carry yesterday’s chains when the keys have already been handed to you.”

True transformation is progressive, but **faith keeps the heart aligned with what Christ has already accomplished**. The cross is the starting point and the daily fuel for holy living.

4. The Results of Faith in the Cross

- **Freedom from guilt and condemnation** (Romans 8:1)
- **Power over sin and temptation** (Romans 6:14)
- **Renewed identity as a new creation** (2 Corinthians 5:17)
- **Life that glorifies God naturally**

Faith in the cross **does not demand perfection first**; it **produces transformation** over time as the Spirit works through belief.

Chapter Summary

Faith anchored in the cross is **the ultimate source of transformation**:

1. It rests on Christ’s finished work, not human effort.
2. It transforms by focusing on Christ, not sin.
3. It produces daily living that reflects resurrection life.

“You cannot drink from an empty cup; first, you must drink the life of Christ flowing in you.”

The more we believe in the reality of the cross, the more our lives show **Christ in thought, word, and action**.

Reflection Questions

1. Where am I relying on **self-effort instead of faith in Christ’s work**?
2. How can I deepen my daily awareness that **I live because Christ lives in me**?
3. Which areas of life require **crucifixion of the old self** and resurrection into Christ’s life?
4. Am I gazing at Christ daily, or obsessing over my failures?

CHAPTER 28

THE MARKS OF A TRULY BORN AGAIN PERSON

Introduction

Many people attend church, pray, or follow religious practices, but not everyone is truly born again.

The Bible gives clear signs that show whether someone has **received new life in Christ**.

Being born again is not about **appearance, ritual, or emotion**; it is about a **heart transformation** and a new relationship with God through Jesus Christ.

Idiom: *“The fruit shows the tree, not the leaf.”*

1. A Desire to Repent and Turn from Sin

A truly born again person **repents of sin**, leaving the life ruled by Adam's fallen nature.

Acts 3:19 (NIV) “Repent, then, and turn to God, so that your sins may be wiped out, that times of refreshing may come from the Lord.”

Romans 6:6–7 (NIV) “For we know that our old self was crucified with him so that the body ruled by sin might be done away with, that we should no longer be slaves to sin—because anyone who has died has been set free from sin.”

“A river changes direction only when the dam is removed.”

Practical Note: Repentance is not just feeling sorry; it is **turning away from sin and trusting Christ to forgive and change the heart**.

2. A Love for God and His Word

True new birth produces **a love for God** and a hunger to know Him.

1 John 5:3 (NIV) “This is love for God: to obey his commands. And his commands are not burdensome.”

Psalms 119:97 (NIV) “Oh, how I love your law! I meditate on it all day long.”

“A lamp is lit not for decoration but to shine.”

Practical Note: A born again person delights in prayer, worship, and Scripture—not out of obligation, but from a new heart.

3. Freedom from the Dominion of Sin

The new birth **breaks the power of sin** in a believer's life. While temptation remains, sin no longer dominates.

Romans 8:2 (NIV) “Because through Christ Jesus the law of the Spirit who gives life has set you free from the law of sin and death.” *A freed prisoner no longer lives by the rules of the jail.*

Practical Note: Freedom from sin does not mean perfection, but it means a new desire and ability to obey God.

4. A Desire to Obey God

A truly born again person shows **evidence through obedience**.

John 14:15 (NIV) “If you love me, keep my commands.”

1 John 2:3–6 (NIV) “We know that we have come to know him if we keep his commands.

Whoever says, 'I know him,' but does not do what he commands is a liar, and the truth is not in that person."

"The proof of bread is in the eating, not in the wrapper."

Practical Note: Obedience is not legalism; it is the natural fruit of a heart transformed by God.

5. A Changed Perspective on Life

A born again person **sees life differently**:

- Material wealth is no longer the ultimate goal
- Moral standards are guided by God, not human opinion
- Eternity matters more than temporary pleasures

Colossians 3:1–2 (NIV) "Since, then, you have been raised with Christ, set your hearts on things above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God. Set your minds on things above, not on earthly things."

"The one climbing the mountain looks at the summit, not the valley."

6. Evidence of the Holy Spirit's Work

The new birth **produces spiritual fruit** in character and behavior:

Galatians 5:22–23 (NIV) "But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, forbearance, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control."

"A tree is known by its fruit, not its leaves."

Practical Note: The Spirit's presence transforms the inner life, producing qualities that were impossible before being born again.

7. Endurance in Faith

A truly born again believer **perseveres through trials** because faith is rooted in Christ, not circumstances.

James 1:12 (NIV) “Blessed is the one who perseveres under trial because, having stood the test, that person will receive the crown of life that the Lord has promised to those who love him.”

“A stone in the stream may be battered by water, but it does not disappear.”

Conclusion

The marks of a truly born again person include:

1. Repentance and turning from sin
2. Love for God and His Word
3. Freedom from sin's dominion
4. Obedience to God
5. Eternal perspective on life
6. Spiritual fruit produced by the Holy Spirit
7. Endurance in faith

These are not merely outward actions—they reflect a **heart transformed by God**.

CHAPTER 29

OPEN DOORS

How Believers Accidentally Give the Enemy Access

Many believers sincerely love God yet still experience spiritual struggles that seem difficult to overcome.

They pray, attend church, and read the Bible, but certain patterns continue to appear in their lives.

When this happens, many people immediately assume that they are under a curse or severe demonic attack.

However, Scripture teaches an important spiritual principle: **the enemy often operates through doors that people unknowingly leave open.**

The devil does not always force his way into a life; often he simply walks through doors that were never closed.

As an idiom says, **“A thief does not need to break the door if the door is already open.”**

Understanding spiritual doors is essential for anyone who desires lasting freedom.

The Bible Warns Believers Not to Give the Enemy Space

The apostle Paul gave a direct warning to believers about this issue.

Ephesians 4:27 (NKJV) “Nor give place to the devil.” The phrase **“give place”** means giving opportunity, room, or access.

This scripture reveals something important: the enemy may gain influence when believers unintentionally create opportunities for him.

Another verse describes the devil as someone who looks for openings.

1 Peter 5:8 (NKJV) “Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil walks about like a roaring lion, seeking whom he may devour.”

The enemy is always **seeking**, which means he is looking for a weakness, an opening, or an invitation.

An idiom says, “Even the strongest fortress can fall if one gate is left unguarded.”

Door Number One: Persistent Sin

One of the most common spiritual doors is **habitual sin**.

When a believer repeatedly practices sin without repentance, it weakens spiritual protection.

Romans 6:16 (NKJV) “Do you not know that to whom you present yourselves slaves to obey, you are that one’s slaves whom you obey...”

Sin creates spiritual vulnerability because it places the believer under the influence of what he practices.

This is why Scripture warns believers to resist sin actively.

Romans 6:12 (NKJV) “Therefore do not let sin reign in your mortal body.”

An idiom says, “**If you keep feeding a fire, you should not be surprised when the flames grow stronger.**”

Repentance closes this door and restores spiritual strength.

Door Number Two: Unforgiveness

Another dangerous door is **unforgiveness**.

Many believers pray for deliverance while secretly carrying bitterness in their hearts.

Jesus warned about the spiritual consequences of refusing to forgive.

Matthew 6:14–15 (NKJV) “For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you.

But if you do not forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.”

Unforgiveness creates spiritual bondage because it keeps the heart tied to pain and resentment.

Paul also warned believers not to allow bitterness to take root.

Hebrews 12:15 (NKJV) “Looking carefully lest anyone fall short of the grace of God; lest any root of bitterness springing up cause trouble.”

An idiom wisely says, “**Bitterness is** like drinking poison and expecting another person to die.”

Forgiveness does not excuse wrongdoing, but it **releases the heart from bondage**.

Door Number Three: Fear and Unbelief

Fear can also open doors for spiritual oppression. Fear magnifies problems and weakens faith.

Scripture teaches that fear does not come from God.

2 Timothy 1:7 (NKJV) “For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power and of love and of a sound mind.”

When fear dominates the mind, it distorts perception and undermines trust in God.

Another proverb says, “**Fear builds prisons where faith builds doors.**”

Faith, on the other hand, strengthens spiritual authority.

Door Number Four: Occult Involvement

Occult practices are among the most serious spiritual doors.

These may include:

- Witchcraft
- Divination
- Consulting mediums
- Ancestral rituals
- Charms and spiritual objects

God strongly warned His people against such practices.

Deuteronomy 18:10–12 (NKJV) “There shall not be found among you anyone who makes his son or his daughter pass through the fire, or one who practices witchcraft, or a soothsayer, or one who interprets omens...”

Occult involvement invites spiritual forces that oppose God.

An idiom says, “**If you invite darkness into the house**, you should not be surprised when the light disappears.”

True freedom requires completely renouncing such practices.

Door Number Five: Words and Confessions

The words people speak can also shape their spiritual environment.

Scripture emphasizes the power of words.

Proverbs 18:21 (NKJV) “Death and life are in the power of the tongue.”

Constantly speaking defeat, fear, or hopelessness can reinforce negative thinking patterns.

However, speaking truth aligns the heart with God's promises.

An idiom says, “**The tongue is a** small key that can open either a prison or a palace.”

Believers should therefore learn to speak faith and truth.

Closing Spiritual Doors

Freedom is maintained when believers intentionally close these doors.

Closing spiritual doors often includes:

- Genuine repentance
- Forgiving others
- Renouncing past occult involvement
- Renewing the mind with Scripture
- Walking in obedience to God

James summarized this process in a powerful verse.

James 4:7 (NKJV) "Therefore submit to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you."

Notice the order: **submission first, resistance second.**

When believers submit to God, the enemy loses his ground.

Conclusion

The enemy often operates through doors that people unknowingly leave open. Understanding these doors allows believers to guard their lives wisely.

Freedom is not only about casting out demons; it is also about **living a disciplined and obedient life before God.**

As Scripture reminds us: **1 John 4:4 (NKJV)** "He who is in you is greater than he who is in the world."

When believers close the doors to darkness and walk in obedience, the authority of Christ becomes evident in their lives.

And as the saying goes, "When every door to darkness is closed, the light of God fills the house."

CHAPTER 30

WHY SOME CHRISTIANS STILL EXPERIENCE GENERATIONAL PROBLEMS AFTER SALVATION

Understanding Legal Redemption and Practical Transformation

One of the most confusing questions many believers ask is this: **“If I am saved, why do I still see patterns in my life that look like generational curses?”**

Some people come to Christ expecting that the moment they confess Jesus, every problem in their life will instantly disappear.

Yet after salvation, they sometimes notice familiar patterns—addictions, family conflicts, anger, fear, poverty cycles, or certain spiritual struggles that appear to have existed in their family line.

This raises a serious theological question: **Did the cross truly break the curse, or do generational curses continue even after salvation?**

The Bible provides a clear answer. Christ has indeed redeemed believers from the curse, but understanding how that redemption works requires spiritual insight.

As an idiom wisely says, **“A prisoner may be released from the prison gate, but he must still learn how to live as a free man.”**

Christ Has Already Redeemed Us From the Curse

The foundation of the believer's freedom is the work of Christ on the cross.

Galatians 3:13 (NKJV) “Christ has redeemed us from the curse of the law, having become a curse for us.”

This verse makes it clear that Jesus **took the curse upon Himself**. In legal terms, the punishment that belonged to humanity was transferred to Christ.

Through His sacrifice, the believer's relationship with God is restored.

The cross therefore breaks the **legal authority of the curse**.

Another powerful declaration confirms this transformation.

2 Corinthians 5:17 (NKJV) "Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; old things have passed away; behold, all things have become new."

The moment someone receives Christ, a new spiritual identity begins. The believer is no longer defined by the past but by the **new life given through Christ**.

The Spirit Is Instantly Reborn, but the Soul Must Be Renewed

Although salvation changes the believer's **spirit immediately**, the **mind and habits require transformation over time**.

Scripture teaches that the believer must renew the mind.

Romans 12:2 (NKJV) "And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind."

The spirit may be reborn instantly, but the soul carries memories, habits, cultural influences, and learned behaviors from the past.

An old saying illustrates this well: "**You can take a man out of the village in one day**, but it may take years to take the village out of the man."

Similarly, salvation transfers the believer into God's kingdom, but the **process of transformation** continues through spiritual growth.

Some Generational Problems Are Learned Patterns

Many things that appear to be generational curses are actually **generational patterns**.

Children often imitate the behavior they observe in their homes.

If anger, addiction, or broken relationships are common in a family, the next generation may unconsciously repeat those patterns.

Scripture acknowledges that family influence can affect multiple generations.

Exodus 20:5 (NKJV) “Visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children to the third and fourth generations of **those who hate Me.**”

However, the verse includes an important condition: “**of those who hate Me.**”

This refers to generations that **continue in rebellion**, not those who turn to God.

When a person genuinely comes to Christ, a **new spiritual lineage begins.**

As another idiom says, “**The chain of the past breaks when a new link is forged.**”

Ignorance of Identity Keeps Many Believers in Bondage

Another reason some believers continue to struggle is **lack of knowledge about their identity in Christ.**

Scripture warns that ignorance can lead to destruction.

Hosea 4:6 (NKJV) “My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge.”

If a believer thinks he is still under a curse, fear and doubt may influence his life even though Christ has already redeemed him.

But the Bible clearly states that believers have been delivered from the power of darkness.

Colossians 1:13 (NKJV) “He has delivered us from the power of darkness and conveyed us into the kingdom of the Son of His love.”

Notice the phrase **“has delivered.”**

Deliverance is not only a future promise—it is already accomplished through Christ.

An idiom says, **“A prince who believes he is poor will live like a beggar.”**

Understanding identity in Christ empowers believers to walk in freedom.

Open Doors Can Invite Spiritual Oppression

Although the curse has been broken, believers must still guard their lives carefully.

Scripture warns against giving the enemy an opportunity.

Ephesians 4:27 (NKJV) “Nor give place to the devil.”

Open doors may include:

- Persistent sin
- Unforgiveness
- Occult involvement
- Fear and unbelief
- Disobedience to God

These things do not mean the believer is cursed, but they can allow **spiritual oppression**.

An idiom explains this clearly: **“Even a strong house becomes vulnerable when the door is left open.”**

Closing these doors through repentance and obedience protects the believer’s freedom.

Spiritual Growth Is a Process

God often works through **processes rather than instant perfection**.

The believer grows gradually into Christ-like maturity.

2 Corinthians 3:18 (NKJV) “But we all... are being transformed into the same image from glory to glory.”

Notice the phrase “**from glory to glory.**” Transformation happens step by step.

Just as a seed grows slowly into a tree, spiritual maturity develops over time.

An idiom says, “**Fruit does not appear the day the seed is planted.**”

Conclusion

The cross of Christ has already broken the legal authority of every curse. When a person receives salvation, a new spiritual identity begins.

However, lasting freedom requires growth in three important areas:

- **Renewing the mind** through God's Word
- **Closing spiritual doors** through obedience
- **Growing in spiritual maturity**

Salvation is immediate, but transformation is progressive.

As Jesus declared:

John 8:36 (NKJV) “Therefore if the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed.”

And as the saying reminds us:

“Breaking chains may happen in a moment, but learning to walk in freedom is a lifelong journey.”

CHAPTER 31

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN A DEMON, THE FLESH, AND THE UNRENEWED MIND

Understanding the Three Sources of Spiritual Struggle

One of the greatest mistakes in the Church today is confusing **demons, the flesh, and the unrenewed mind**.

Many believers blame every struggle on demons, while others deny spiritual warfare entirely. The truth of Scripture reveals that the believer's battles often come from **three different sources**.

If these sources are not properly understood, people may seek deliverance when they actually need **discipline**, or they may attempt self-improvement when they actually need **spiritual authority over demonic oppression**.

As an idiom wisely says, “**A doctor** who misdiagnoses the disease will prescribe the wrong medicine.”

In the same way, when the problem is misunderstood, the solution becomes ineffective.

The Three Sources of Spiritual Struggle

The Bible identifies three major areas that influence human behavior:

1. The Devil (Demonic Influence)
2. The Flesh (Sinful Nature)
3. The Unrenewed Mind (Old Thought Patterns)

Understanding the difference between these three helps believers walk in true freedom.

1. Demonic Influence: External Spiritual Oppression

Demons are real spiritual beings that oppose God and attempt to influence human lives. Scripture clearly shows that Satan and his kingdom operate to steal, destroy, and deceive.

Jesus explained the enemy's mission.

John 10:10 (NKJV) "The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy."

Demonic activity can include:

- Oppression
- Temptation
- Deception
- Fear and torment
- Bondage through occult involvement

The apostle Peter warned believers to remain spiritually alert.

1 Peter 5:8 (NKJV) "Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil walks about like a roaring lion, seeking whom he may devour."

Notice the phrase "**seeking whom he may devour.**"

This means the enemy **cannot devour everyone**, but he looks for access.

An idiom says, "**A lion only attacks the animal that strays from the herd.**"

Believers must therefore walk in vigilance and spiritual authority.

However, not every problem is caused by demons.

2. The Flesh: The Inner Sinful Nature

The flesh refers to the **sinful tendencies within human nature** that desire things contrary to God.

Even after salvation, the believer must learn to overcome the flesh.

Galatians 5:17 (NKJV) “For the flesh lusts against the Spirit, and the Spirit against the flesh; and these are contrary to one another.”

The works of the flesh are clearly listed in Scripture.

Galatians 5:19–21 (NKJV) “Now the works of the flesh are evident, which are: adultery, fornication, uncleanness, lewdness, idolatry, sorcery, hatred, contentions, jealousies, outbursts of wrath, selfish ambitions...”

These are not always caused by demons; they are **expressions of the fallen nature**.

An idiom says, “**You cannot blame** the wind if the roof of your house is already weak.”

The flesh must be **crucified through spiritual discipline and obedience to God**.

Galatians 5:24 (NKJV) “And those who are Christ’s have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires.”

Deliverance alone cannot crucify the flesh; it requires **daily submission to the Holy Spirit**.

3. The Unrenewed Mind: Old Thinking Patterns

The third source of struggle is the **unrenewed mind**.

A person may be saved spiritually but still think according to old beliefs, fears, and cultural conditioning.

Scripture commands believers to renew their minds.

Romans 12:2 (NKJV) “And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind.”

Many behaviors are simply the result of **wrong thinking**, not demons.

For example:

- A person raised in fear may continue living in fear.
- Someone raised in poverty may struggle to believe God's provision.
- Someone raised in anger may respond aggressively.

An idiom says, **"The chains on the mind are often stronger than the chains on the body."**

The Word of God renews the mind and reshapes thinking.

John 8:32 (NKJV) "And you shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free."

Why Many Deliverance Ministries Struggle

Many ministries focus only on demons while ignoring the **flesh and the mind**.

As a result, people receive deliverance but later return with the same problems.

This happens because:

- The demon may leave,
- But the **flesh remains undisciplined**,
- And the **mind remains unchanged**.

It is like cleaning a house but leaving the **foundation cracked**.

Without addressing the root issues, the same problems may reappear.

The Balanced Biblical Approach

True spiritual freedom comes from addressing all three areas.

1. Resist the Devil

James 4:7 (NKJV) "Therefore submit to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you."

2. Crucify the Flesh

Romans 8:13 (NKJV) “For if you live according to the flesh you will die; but if by the Spirit you put to death the deeds of the body, you will live.”

3. Renew the Mind

Ephesians 4:23 (NKJV) “And be renewed in the spirit of your mind.”

When these three principles work together, the believer experiences **lasting transformation**.

Conclusion

Spiritual struggles do not always come from the same source.

Sometimes the enemy must be **resisted**, sometimes the flesh must be **crucified**, and sometimes the mind must be **renewed**.

Discernment is therefore essential in the Christian life.

As the saying goes, “**A wise soldier knows which battle he is fighting.**”

When believers understand these distinctions, they stop living in confusion and begin walking in victory.

Scripture reminds us of the authority given to every believer:

Luke 10:19 (NKJV) “Behold, I give you the authority to trample on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy.”

Through Christ, the believer has authority over demons, power through the Spirit to overcome the flesh, and truth through the Word to renew the mind.

And when these three align, **true freedom becomes a living reality**.

CHAPTER 32

DELIVERANCE VS. DISCIPLESHIP

Why Casting Out Demons Alone Does Not Produce Lasting Freedom

In many parts of the Church today, deliverance has become a central focus. People travel long distances seeking someone to cast demons out of them.

Prayer lines are filled with individuals desperate to be free from oppression, addiction, fear, sickness, and spiritual bondage.

Deliverance is biblical and necessary. Jesus Himself cast out demons and gave His disciples authority to do the same.

Mark 16:17 (NKJV) “And these signs will follow those who believe: In My name they will cast out demons...”

However, a critical truth is often overlooked: **deliverance alone does not guarantee lasting freedom.** Many people experience temporary relief, yet after some time the same problems return.

Why does this happen?

The answer is simple but profound: **deliverance removes the enemy, but discipleship fills the life with Christ.**

As an idiom says, “**Removing weeds from a garden is good,** but if you do not plant good seeds, the weeds will return.”

Freedom Requires More Than Expulsion

Jesus gave a very important warning about what happens when a person receives deliverance but does not experience transformation.

Matthew 12:43–45 (NKJV) “When an unclean spirit goes out of a man, he goes through dry places, seeking rest, and finds none.

Then he says, ‘I will return to my house from which I came.’ And when he comes, he finds it empty, swept, and put in order.

Then he goes and takes with him seven other spirits more wicked than himself, and they enter and dwell there; and the last state of that man is worse than the first.”

Notice the key word in this passage: **empty**.

The house was clean but **not occupied**.

Deliverance removed the demon, but **discipleship did not fill the life with the presence, truth, and discipline of Christ**.

An empty house invites new tenants.

As the saying goes, “**Nature abhors a vacuum.**”

When the soul is empty of truth and spiritual discipline, darkness quickly returns.

Deliverance Deals with the Enemy; Discipleship Deals with the Nature

Deliverance addresses **spiritual oppression**, but discipleship transforms **character and nature**.

Many believers want demons cast out, but they do not want their habits, attitudes, and lifestyles corrected.

Yet Scripture teaches that transformation requires **renewing the mind**.

Romans 12:2 (NKJV) “And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind.”

A demon may influence behavior, but **the mind determines direction.**

If the mind remains unchanged, the person may return to the same doors that once allowed darkness to enter.

An idiom says, **“If a man keeps returning to the same door, he should not be surprised when the same trouble greets him.”**

True freedom requires both **deliverance and discipleship.**

Jesus Called People to Follow Him, Not Only to Be Freed

When Jesus delivered people, He also called them into a life of obedience and relationship with Him.

After healing and forgiving a man, Jesus gave this warning:

John 5:14 (NKJV) “See, you have been made well. Sin no more, lest a worse thing come upon you.”

Freedom requires **a new direction.**

The problem with many believers is that they want **freedom without transformation.**

But Christ did not come only to remove demons; He came to **restore the image of God in man.**

2 Corinthians 3:18 (NKJV) “But we all... are being transformed into the same image from glory to glory.”

Deliverance may happen in a moment, but **discipleship is a lifelong journey.**

As another idiom says, **“A seed sprouts overnight, but a tree takes years to mature.”**

The Role of Truth in Maintaining Freedom

One of the most powerful weapons against spiritual bondage is **truth**.

Jesus said freedom is not maintained through emotional experiences alone but through **knowing and walking in truth**.

John 8:31–32 (NKJV) “If you abide in My word, you are My disciples indeed. And you shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.”

Notice that Jesus connected **freedom to discipleship**.

Freedom is not sustained by occasional prayer meetings; it is sustained by **abiding in the Word of God**.

Truth renews the mind, strengthens faith, and closes doors that once allowed darkness to operate.

Spiritual Growth Closes Old Doors

Some believers repeatedly seek deliverance because they never address the **doors that allowed the enemy access**.

Scripture warns believers to guard their lives carefully.

Ephesians 4:27 (NKJV) “Nor give place to the devil.”

This means believers must deal with things such as:

- Unforgiveness
- Immorality
- Occult involvement
- Persistent disobedience
- Bitterness and pride

Deliverance may remove the enemy temporarily, but **if the door remains open, the enemy may return**.

It is like repairing a house but leaving the windows broken. Eventually the storm will come in again.

The Power of Identity in Christ

Another reason some believers struggle after deliverance is **ignorance of their new identity in Christ**.

The believer is not merely someone who received prayer. The believer has been **transferred into a new kingdom**.

Colossians 1:13 (NKJV) "He has delivered us from the power of darkness and conveyed us into the kingdom of the Son of His love."

Freedom becomes stable when the believer understands who he is.

An idiom says, "**A prince** who forgets his throne will live like a slave." Identity determines authority.

When believers understand their position in Christ, they resist the enemy with confidence.

The Balance the Church Must Recover

The Church must restore the balance between **deliverance and discipleship**.

Deliverance is important because it breaks spiritual oppression. But discipleship is essential because it builds **spiritual maturity**.

Without discipleship, deliverance becomes a cycle where people repeatedly seek prayer but never grow.

Jesus did not command the Church merely to cast out demons; He commanded the Church to **make disciples**.

Matthew 28:19–20 (NKJV) “Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations... teaching them to observe all things that I have commanded you.”

Deliverance may open the prison door, but **discipleship teaches the former prisoner how to live in freedom.**

Conclusion

Lasting freedom requires both **power and process.**

Deliverance removes the enemy's grip, but discipleship forms the believer into the image of Christ.

When these two work together, freedom becomes permanent.

The believer is no longer merely someone who escaped bondage but someone who has **grown into spiritual maturity.**

As Scripture declares:

John 8:36 (NKJV) “Therefore if the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed.”

And as the saying goes: **“Breaking chains is the beginning of freedom,** but learning to walk is the journey of life.”

CHAPTER 33

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN RELIGION AND BEING BORN AGAIN

Why This Matters

Many people claim to know God, follow traditions, or practice religion faithfully. Yet the Bible draws a **clear distinction between religion and being born again**.

Understanding this difference is essential for genuine salvation and a vibrant walk with **Jesus Christ**.

A shadow may look like the tree, but it cannot give shade or fruit.

Religion can appear similar to faith outwardly, but being born again produces **true life and transformation** inside.

1. Religion: Following Rules Without Transformation

Religion is often **external compliance with rituals, rules, or moral codes**.

Examples include:

- Performing ceremonies without heart devotion
- Following traditions blindly
- Trusting works rather than God's grace

Isaiah 29:13 "These people honor me with their lips, but their hearts are far from me."

Religion can **look good outwardly** but may leave the soul unchanged. *A painted wall may look clean, but the foundation underneath may be rotten.*

2. Being Born Again: Transformation from the Inside

Being born again is **a spiritual rebirth that changes the heart and spirit**.

John 3:3 “Unless one is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God.”

Key characteristics of being born again:

- **A new heart** – desires align with God (Ezekiel 36:26)
- **A new nature** – the believer now has Christ's life within (2 Corinthians 5:17)
- **Faith and relationship** – salvation is received by grace through faith, not works (Ephesians 2:8–9)

A new tree bears new fruit, not the fruit of the old tree.

Being born again is not about performing acts; it's about **receiving new life** that naturally produces godly fruit.

3. Religion vs. Being Born Again: The Contrasts

Aspect	Religion	Being Born Again
Basis	Human effort, rituals	God's grace, faith
Change	External only	Internal heart and spirit
Relationship	Often distant from God	Personal intimacy with God
Outcome	Legalistic, prideful	Love, joy, peace, obedience

Religion may wash the hands, but only rebirth cleanses the heart.

4. Signs of Genuine New Birth

How can someone know they are truly born again?

1. **Repentance** – A turning away from sin and self (Acts 3:19)
2. **Faith in Christ** – Believing Jesus is Lord and Savior (Romans 10:9–10)
3. **Desire for God's Word and Prayer** – Hunger for intimacy with God
4. **Fruit of the Spirit** – Love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, etc. (Galatians 5:22–23)

A new tree is recognized by its fruit. Being born again produces **visible and invisible change** in life.

5. Religion Can Lead to False Security

Many people trust religion for salvation rather than Christ.

Matthew 7:21 “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the kingdom of heaven, but only the one who does the will of my Father.”

Outward rituals and appearances are **not enough**. God looks at the heart and the spirit. *A mask may hide a face, but it cannot change it.*

6. Living as a Born-Again Believer

Being born again transforms life in three key ways:

1. **Freedom from sin’s power** – The believer grows in holiness
2. **Intimacy with God** – Daily fellowship and prayer become natural
3. **Purposeful living** – The believer walks in God’s will and calling

A person who receives new life walks in a new direction. True salvation is not a religion—it is **a relationship with a living God**.

Conclusion: Choose Life, Not Ritual

Religion can provide structure, tradition, or community, but only **being born again gives eternal life**.

Romans 6:23 “For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.”

One may follow the path of many, but only the new life path leads home.

Being born again is **the beginning of a journey of transformation, intimacy, and hope**, preparing the believer for the day **Jesus Christ** returns to complete the journey of salvation.

CHAPTER 34

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN CHURCH MEMBERSHIP AND TRUE SALVATION

In many parts of the world today, Christianity has become closely associated with religious institutions, denominational identities, and cultural traditions.

Many people identify themselves as Christians because they belong to a church, participate in religious practices, or follow the teachings of a particular denomination.

However, the Scriptures teach that church membership is not the same as salvation. A person may belong to a church and still not experience the new birth that comes through the true gospel.

This distinction is critical, especially in an age where the message of salvation is sometimes replaced by moral instruction, religious ritual, or cultural Christianity.

To understand the difference, we must return to the message of the apostles.

Salvation According to the Gospel of the Apostles

The apostles did not preach religion; they preached the gospel of salvation.

The message they proclaimed centered on Jesus Christ—His death, burial, and resurrection.

In Acts 17:18–19, when the apostle Paul encountered philosophers in Athens, he did not change the message to accommodate their intellectual culture. Instead, he preached Jesus and the resurrection.

Likewise, Paul clearly summarized the gospel in 1 Corinthians 15:1–4, declaring that:

- Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures
- He was buried
- He rose again on the third day according to the Scriptures

This message forms the foundation of true salvation.

Salvation occurs when a person believes this gospel and confesses Jesus as Lord, as written in Romans 10:9–10.

Thus, salvation is not obtained through religious affiliation but through faith in the redemptive work of Christ.

The Problem Salvation Addresses: Sin

To understand salvation, we must first understand what humanity is saved from.

The Bible teaches that sin entered the world through one man, Adam.

According to Romans 5:12, sin entered the world through Adam, and death came through sin. As a result, death spread to all humanity.

This means the human problem is not merely moral weakness or lack of education; it is a fallen spiritual condition.

Human beings are born into a world affected by sin, and therefore salvation must address the root problem of sin and spiritual death.

Christ: The Last Adam

The solution to the problem of sin is found in Jesus Christ.

The apostle Paul describes Christ as the last Adam in 1 Corinthians 15:45, saying that the first Adam became a living being, but the last Adam became a life-giving Spirit.

This reveals a profound truth.

Adam brought sin and death into humanity. Christ brings life and restoration.

Through His death and resurrection, Christ defeated sin and death and made it possible for humanity to receive new life.

Salvation, therefore, is not simply forgiveness; it is the reception of new spiritual life through Christ.

The Seal of the Holy Spirit

When a person truly believes the gospel, God grants them the Holy Spirit.

According to Ephesians 1:13, believers are sealed with the Holy Spirit of promise after hearing and believing the word of truth.

This sealing is significant because it indicates that the believer now belongs to God and has received new spiritual life.

It is not produced by rituals or ceremonies. It is the work of God in response to genuine faith.

The Spirit of Man and the Holy Spirit

Another important distinction is the difference between the human spirit and the Holy Spirit.

The Scriptures clarify this in 1 Corinthians 2:10–11, which explains that the spirit of a person knows the things within that person, but the Spirit of God knows the things of God.

Every human being possesses a human spirit, but not every person has the Holy Spirit dwelling within them.

The Holy Spirit is given to those who believe in Christ and receive the gospel. Through the Spirit, believers gain spiritual understanding and fellowship with God.

Religion Without New Birth

Many people grow up within religious systems and assume that participation in religious practices equals salvation.

They may:

- Attend church regularly
- Participate in rituals
- Identify strongly with their denomination

Yet the Bible teaches that true salvation requires spiritual rebirth, not merely religious participation.

Religion can shape behavior and culture, but it cannot transform the human heart.

Only the gospel of Christ can accomplish this.

The Danger of Departing from the True Gospel

The apostle Paul issued a strong warning about departing from the gospel.

In Galatians 1:6–9, he rebuked those who were turning to a different gospel and declared that anyone who preaches another gospel should be accursed.

This warning remains relevant today.

When the gospel is replaced with human philosophy, moral teaching, cultural traditions, or personal agendas, the message of salvation becomes distorted.

The church must guard the apostolic gospel carefully.

Conclusion

The difference between church membership and true salvation is fundamental.

Church membership involves participation in a religious community.

True salvation involves spiritual rebirth through faith in Jesus Christ.

The apostles preached a clear message:

Christ died for our sins.

He was buried.

He rose again.

Those who believe this gospel, repent, and confess Christ as Lord receive salvation and the seal of the Holy Spirit.

For this reason, the Church must remain faithful to the original gospel preached by the apostles, for it alone brings humanity from sin and death into eternal life.

CHAPTER 35

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN BEING BORN AGAIN AND BEING BORN INTO RELIGION

Many people today claim to know Jesus Christ. They attend church, confess Christ with their mouths, and participate in religious practices.

Yet the Bible shows that **there is a** difference between religion and the new birth.

A person can be **religious without being born again**, and this has existed since biblical times.

1. Being Born Into Religion

Being born into religion means a person **inherits beliefs, traditions, and practices from a religious system**. Their identity is shaped by the church or culture they belong to.

Such a person may:

- Attend church regularly
- Participate in rituals
- Follow religious traditions
- Identify with a denomination

But their faith may be based on **external practices rather than inner** transformation.

Religion focuses heavily on **ceremonies, traditions, and systems**. For example, some churches emphasize:

- incense or censers in worship
- liturgical rituals
- cultural traditions
- denominational identity

While some practices may have historical or symbolic meaning, **they do not produce the new birth**.

An idiom says: "**A** uniform does not make a soldier."

In the same way, **religious practices do not automatically produce spiritual life.**

2. Being Born Again

Being born again is a **spiritual transformation performed by God.** It is not inherited from family or obtained through rituals.

It occurs when a person:

- hears the true gospel
- believes in Christ from the heart
- repents from sin
- receives new life from God

The new birth is **an inner change of nature.**

A born-again believer experiences:

- a new spiritual life
- a renewed relationship with God
- the indwelling of the Holy Spirit

This transformation goes beyond religion. It is **a change in the spirit of a person.**

3. The Difference Between the Spirit of Man and the Holy Spirit

One area where confusion often arises is the difference between **the human spirit and the Holy Spirit.**

The Bible clearly distinguishes between them.

1 Corinthians 2:10–11 "For what man knows the things of a man except the spirit of the man which is in him? Even so no one knows the things of God except the Spirit of God."

This passage shows two different realities:

The spirit of man

- Every human being possesses a human spirit.
- It is the part of a person that enables awareness, reasoning, and inner life.

The Holy Spirit

- The Spirit of God is divine.
- He reveals the things of God and gives spiritual understanding.

Not everyone who has a human spirit **has the Holy Spirit dwelling in them**. The Holy Spirit comes to dwell in a person when they truly receive Christ.

4. The Seal of the Holy Spirit

The Bible teaches that when a person truly believes in Christ, God gives them **the Holy Spirit as a seal**.

Ephesians 1:13 “In Him you also trusted, after you heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation; in whom also, having believed, you were sealed with the Holy Spirit of promise.”

This sealing means:

- God marks the believer as His own
- the Holy Spirit dwells in the believer
- the believer receives spiritual life

This seal is not given through religious ceremonies. It comes **through faith in the true gospel**.

5. Why Many Religious People Are Confused

Many religious systems mix **tradition, culture, and theology**. As a result, people may sincerely believe they know Christ, yet their faith is shaped more by **religious identity than by the gospel**.

For example:

Some traditions emphasize **ritual worship practices**.

Others emphasize **doctrinal systems** that may confuse the relationship between the human spirit and the Holy Spirit.

Others mix **cultural traditions with Christian language**.

This mixture can lead people to **identify with Christianity without experiencing the new birth**.

6. The Test of True Faith

The true test of faith is not the denomination someone belongs to, but whether they have **received the life of Christ through the gospel**.

A born-again believer is someone who:

- Believes that Christ died for their sins
- Believes that God raised Him from the dead
- Repents from sin
- Receives the Holy Spirit

This is the salvation described in **Romans 10:9–10**.

Conclusion

The difference between religion and the new birth is profound.

Religion focuses on **external practices**.

The new birth produces **inner transformation**.

A person may know many religious traditions and still lack the life of Christ. But when a person truly believes the gospel, they receive **the seal of the Holy Spirit and become a new creation**.

For this reason, the Church must always return to the **true gospel preached by the apostles**, because it is the message that leads people not merely to religion, but to **spiritual rebirth and eternal life**.

CHAPTER 36

WHY MORAL TEACHING WITHOUT THE CROSS CANNOT SAVE

In many places today, the message preached in churches and evangelistic meetings has slowly shifted. Instead of proclaiming the gospel of Christ, many messages now focus mainly on **moral improvement, good behavior, and human values**.

People are taught how to be kind, disciplined, successful, and responsible.

While moral teaching is valuable for society, it is **not the gospel** and it **cannot save the soul**.

The danger arises when moral instruction replaces the message of **the cross of Christ**. When this happens, the Church moves from preaching salvation to promoting **humanism**, where the focus is on human effort rather than divine redemption.

1. The Gospel Addresses the Problem of Sin

The reason the gospel exists is because humanity has a deep spiritual problem: **sin**.

Romans 5:12 “Therefore, just as through one man sin entered the world, and death through sin, and thus death spread to all men, because all sinned.”

Sin entered the world through Adam, and from that moment, the human race became subject to sin and death. This means that the problem of humanity is not merely bad behavior but **a fallen nature**.

An idiom says: *“You cannot heal a poisoned well by cleaning the bucket.”*

In the same way, teaching people good morals does not remove the root problem of sin.

2. The Cross Is the Center of the Gospel

Because the problem of humanity is sin, the solution had to be **a divine sacrifice**.

The apostle Paul defined the gospel clearly.

1 Corinthians 15:1–4 “Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, and that He was buried, and that He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures.”

The gospel is centered on three historical events:

- The **death of Christ for our sins**
- His **burial**
- His **resurrection on the third day**

Without the cross, there is **no forgiveness of sins**. Without the resurrection, there is **no victory over death**.

This is why the apostles preached **Christ crucified and risen**, not merely moral improvement.

3. Moral Teaching Cannot Change Human Nature

Humanism focuses on improving behavior through education, philosophy, or discipline. It assumes that people can become righteous simply by learning better values.

However, the Bible teaches that the problem is deeper than behavior.

The human heart itself needs transformation.

An idiom says: *“Painting a rotten tree does not make it bear good fruit.”*

A person may behave morally outwardly, yet the inner nature remains unchanged. Only the saving work of Christ can give a person **new life**.

4. Christ Came as the Last Adam

God's solution to humanity's fallen condition was Jesus Christ.

1 Corinthians 15:45 "The first man Adam became a living being. The last Adam became a life-giving spirit."

Adam introduced sin into the world. Christ came as the **Last Adam** to bring life and restoration.

Through Adam came **death**.
Through Christ comes **new life**.

Moral teaching cannot reverse the fall of Adam. Only the work of Christ can restore what was lost.

5. The Apostles Never Replaced the Gospel With Philosophy

The apostles encountered many cultures filled with philosophical ideas. Yet they never changed the gospel to match human thinking.

Acts 17:18–19 "...because he preached to them Jesus and the resurrection."

When Paul preached in Athens, he faced intellectual philosophers who valued deep reasoning. If Paul wanted to impress them, he could have turned his message into a philosophical discussion.

But he did not do that.

Instead, he preached **Jesus and the resurrection**.

This shows that the gospel is **not designed to impress human wisdom but to save human souls**.

6. Salvation Comes Only Through Faith in Christ

The Bible clearly explains how salvation is received.

Romans 10:9–10 “That if you confess with your mouth the Lord Jesus and believe in your heart that God has raised Him from the dead, you will be saved.”

Salvation does not come through moral education or human discipline. It comes through **faith in Jesus Christ and His resurrection**.

A person must believe the gospel and confess Jesus as Lord.

7. The Danger of Replacing the Gospel

The apostle Paul warned strongly about changing the gospel.

Galatians 1:6–8 “I marvel that you are turning away so soon... to a different gospel.”

And he continued with a serious warning.

Galatians 1:8–9 “But even if we, or an angel from heaven, preach any other gospel... let him be accursed.”

This warning shows that altering the gospel is not a small mistake. It is a **dangerous departure from the truth**.

When the gospel is replaced with motivational messages, moral lessons, or human philosophies, the Church loses its **saving message**.

Conclusion

Moral teaching may improve society, but it **cannot save the soul**.

The gospel addresses the deeper problem of humanity: **sin**.

The Bible shows us clearly:

Sin entered the world through Adam (Romans 5:12).

Jesus came as the Last Adam to bring life (1 Corinthians 15:45).

Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again (1 Corinthians 15:1–4).

Salvation comes through believing and confessing Christ (Romans 10:9–10).

Any gospel that replaces this message is a dangerous distortion (Galatians 1:6–9).

For this reason, evangelists must return to **the apostolic gospel**, because the message of **the cross and resurrection** is the only message that has the power to save humanity.

CHAPTER 37

WHY MANY RELIGIOUS PEOPLE MUST STILL BE BORN AGAIN

Introduction

Many attend churches, mosques, or religious institutions faithfully. Some live moral lives, follow rituals, and perform good works. Yet the Bible makes it clear: **religion alone cannot save anyone**.

The reason is simple: **salvation is a spiritual birth, not a religious performance**. Without being born again, a person remains in the fallen nature inherited from Adam.

This is why even people from strong religious backgrounds—Muslims, Catholics, SDA, or others—need **the same new birth** that the apostles preached.

John 3:3 (NIV) “Very truly I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless they are born again.”

“A new journey cannot start with an old passport.”

1. Religion Cannot Remove the Adamic Nature

Every human inherits a fallen nature through Adam. This spiritual problem is universal:

Romans 5:12 (NIV) “Therefore, just as sin entered the world through one man, and death through sin, and in this way death came to all people, because all sinned.”

Religion, rituals, or good works cannot remove this nature—they can only **modify behavior** temporarily.

“Polishing a rusted chain does not make it strong.”

For example:

A Muslim may follow all religious practices but still remain **separated from God** without new birth.

A Catholic or SDA may attend mass or church regularly but without faith in Christ's finished work, their heart remains **spiritually dead**.

2. The Gospel Is Universal, Not Cultural or Religious

The apostles preached the gospel to **all nations**, not just one religious group. The gospel does not depend on:

- Race
- Nationality
- Religious affiliation
- Social status

Acts 10:34–35 (NIV) “Then Peter began to speak: ‘I now realize how true it is that God does not show favoritism but accepts from every nation the one who fears him and does what is right.’”

The new birth is **the only solution** that transcends human religion or culture.

“The river flows to all lands, not just one field.”

3. Religious Knowledge Without Transformation Is Dangerous

Some religious people think that following traditions or rules is sufficient. Jesus warned:

Matthew 7:21 (NIV) “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the kingdom of heaven, but only the one who does the will of my Father who is in heaven.”

True salvation is not about **words, rituals, or external appearances**, but about **spiritual transformation** through the Spirit.

Idiom: “A painted wall may look clean, but the foundation can be rotten.”

4. Faith in Christ Alone Produces New Birth

The apostles preached **faith in Christ** as the way to be born again.

Acts 4:12 (NIV) “Salvation is found in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven given to mankind by which we must be saved.”

The new birth is **not earned by works, prayer rituals, or moral living**. It is a gift received by believing in Christ. *“The key cannot open the door if it is never inserted.”*

5. Signs of Being Truly Born Again

When a person receives new life through Christ:

Spiritual blindness is removed – they begin to understand God's truth (Isaiah 42:7).

The power of sin is broken – they begin to live righteously (Romans 6:6–7).

Freedom from bondage – religion alone can control behavior, but new birth gives freedom from sin's slavery (Romans 8:2).

A new identity in Christ – they are no longer defined by cultural, religious, or human labels (2 Corinthians 5:17).

“A man who has left the prison can now walk freely in the open field.”

6. Why Evangelists Must Preach the True Gospel to All Religions

Evangelists cannot assume that religious background guarantees salvation. Every person must hear **the gospel of Christ crucified, resurrected, and offering new life.**

Romans 1:16 (NIV) "For I am not ashamed of the gospel, because it is the power of God that brings salvation to everyone who believes."

Evangelists must emphasize:

- Christ alone brings salvation
- Repentance is necessary
- Faith in the resurrection produces new life
- All humans, rich or poor, religious or not, need new birth

"A medicine is useless until it reaches the sick."

Conclusion

Even devout Muslims, Catholics, SDA, or other religious people must be **born again**. Religious rituals, traditions, and moral living **cannot solve the problem of sin and death inherited from Adam.**

Salvation is **entirely in Christ**, and the apostles' message remains the same today:

- Turn from sin (repentance)
- Believe in Christ
- Receive new life from the Spirit

"The same door that opened for the first believer is open for everyone."

Prayer:

Heavenly Father, help all people, from every religion, to hear Your gospel clearly. Open their hearts to receive Jesus Christ, be born again, and walk in newness of life. Let no one be deceived by rituals or traditions without transformation. In Jesus' name, Amen.

CHAPTER 38

THE FINISHED ATONEMENT — WHY THE CROSS LEFT NO DEBT

Epistle to the Hebrews 10:14 (NIV) “For by one sacrifice he has made perfect forever those who are being made holy.”

Introduction

One of the most powerful truths in the gospel is that **Christ’s sacrifice was complete**. The cross was not a temporary solution to sin; it was the final answer to humanity’s greatest problem.

Yet many believers live as if the work of redemption is incomplete. They constantly fear curses, condemnation, or spiritual bondage, especially when their lives do not match certain expectations such as wealth, marriage, or possessions.

But the Bible teaches that the cross of **Jesus Christ** accomplished something far deeper and greater than material success. It accomplished the **complete removal of sin’s debt**.

To understand this truth, we must look at the **Day of Atonement in the Old Testament** and how it points to the finished work of Christ.

1. The Day of Atonement in the Old Testament

In the Old Testament, God established the **Day of Atonement** as the most sacred day for the nation of Israel.

This is described in **Book of Leviticus 16**.

On that day, the high priest entered the Most Holy Place and offered sacrifices for the sins of the people. Two goats were used:

- One goat was sacrificed for sin.
- The other goat, called the scapegoat, carried the sins of the people away into the wilderness.

This symbolized the removal of guilt from the nation.

When the ceremony ended, the sins of the people had been **atoned for and symbolically removed**.

However, this process had to be repeated every year because the blood of animals could not permanently remove sin.

2. The Cross Fulfilled the Atonement

The sacrifices of the Old Testament were only shadows pointing forward to the perfect sacrifice of Christ.

When Jesus died on the cross, He fulfilled what the Day of Atonement symbolized.

Unlike the priests who offered sacrifices repeatedly, Christ offered Himself **once and for all**.

As written in **Epistle to the Hebrews 10:12**: "But when this priest had offered for all time one sacrifice for sins, he sat down at the right hand of God."

The fact that Christ sat down shows that **the work of redemption was finished**. The cross did not merely cover sin temporarily; it **dealt with it completely**.

3. No Sin Left Unpaid

Because Christ's sacrifice was perfect, no sin remains unpaid for those who trust in Him.

The believer stands before God as forgiven and reconciled.

This does not mean believers never commit mistakes again, but it means their **legal standing before God has been settled through Christ**.

The cross canceled the record of debt that stood against humanity.

Through Christ, believers receive forgiveness, righteousness, and peace with God.

4. Why Believers Still Confess Sin

If the cross dealt with sin completely, why do believers still confess their sins?

The answer lies in the difference between **relationship and fellowship**.

Salvation establishes the believer's relationship with God permanently. However, daily confession maintains a healthy fellowship with God.

The apostle explains this in **First Epistle of John 1:9**: "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness."

This confession does not repeat the sacrifice of Christ; rather, it keeps the believer's heart aligned with God.

5. Satan's Strategy of Accusation

Even though the cross has settled the issue of sin, the enemy constantly tries to deceive believers.

Jesus described the devil in **Gospel of John 8:44** as the father of lies.

One of Satan's greatest strategies is to convince believers that they are still under bondage.

He whispers accusations such as:

- "You do not have a house yet."
- "You are not married."
- "You are not prosperous."
- "You must still be under a curse."

"These lies attempt to shift the believer's focus from the cross to external circumstances. When believers accept these lies, many become discouraged and drift back into sin and spiritual bondage."

But the gospel declares that redemption is not measured by possessions.

6. The True Evidence of Redemption

The New Testament teaches that the greatest blessings believers receive are spiritual.

Scripture says in **Epistle to the Ephesians 1:3**: "He has blessed us in the heavenly realms with every spiritual blessing in Christ."

These blessings include:

- Forgiveness of sins
- Freedom from condemnation
- Adoption as children of God
- The presence of the Holy Spirit
- Eternal life

These realities prove that the believer has been delivered, regardless of material circumstances.

7. Living in the Confidence of the Cross

When believers understand the finished work of Christ, they stop living in fear of curses and condemnation.

Instead, they stand confidently in the truth of the gospel.

As written in **Epistle to the Romans 8:1**:

“Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.”

This assurance allows believers to walk in freedom, gratitude, and obedience to God.

Conclusion

The Day of Atonement in the Old Testament was a shadow of the greater reality fulfilled by Jesus Christ.

Through His sacrifice, the debt of sin was fully paid. No additional sacrifice is required, and no believer who trusts in Christ remains under condemnation.

Although believers continue to confess sins as part of their daily walk with God, the foundation of their salvation remains the finished work of the cross.

Satan may attempt to deceive believers by pointing to their circumstances, but the truth remains unchanged: **Christ has already secured their freedom.**

The believer's calling is to stand firmly in that truth and refuse any lie that diminishes the power of the cross.

CHAPTER 39

THE GOSPEL MANY PREACH TODAY VS THE GOSPEL THE APOSTLES PREACHED

Introduction

In every generation, the gospel faces a serious danger: **substitution**. Instead of rejecting the gospel openly, some replace it with something that sounds spiritual but lacks the power of salvation.

The apostles warned the church about this danger. The gospel must remain pure because **it is the power of God for salvation**.

Romans 1:16 (NIV) “For I am not ashamed of the gospel, because it is the power of God that brings salvation to everyone who believes.”

However, today many messages presented as the gospel are actually **altered versions**. They emphasize moral improvement, material success, or religious traditions instead of the saving work of Jesus Christ.

“When salt loses its taste, it cannot preserve anything.”

1. The Moral Gospel vs the Gospel of Salvation

Some preachers present the gospel as a call to **live morally and behave well**. They emphasize good conduct, kindness, and discipline.

While moral living is important, **morality is not the gospel**. A person can be moral yet still be spiritually dead.

Romans 3:23 (NIV) “For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.”

The apostles did not preach morality first; they preached **salvation through Christ**, which then produces moral transformation.

"You cannot wash a dirty river by cleaning the banks." True change begins in the **heart**, not merely in behavior.

2. The Prosperity Gospel vs the Gospel of Redemption

Another message often preached focuses mainly on **wealth, success, and material blessings**. God indeed blesses His people, but **material prosperity is not the gospel**.

The apostles did not travel across nations preaching money or earthly success. They preached redemption through Christ.

The apostle Paul the Apostle wrote:

1 Corinthians 2:2 (NIV) "For I resolved to know nothing while I was with you except Jesus Christ and him crucified."

The cross—not wealth—was the center of apostolic preaching. *"A man may gain the whole field but lose the treasure buried in it."*

3. The Religious Gospel vs the Gospel of New Birth

Another substitution is the **religious gospel**. It teaches people to belong to a denomination, follow traditions, or maintain rituals.

But belonging to a religious system cannot save a soul. Even very religious people needed salvation.

When speaking to **Nicodemus**, a deeply religious man, Jesus Christ said:

John 3:3 (NIV) "Very truly I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless they are born again."

The apostles therefore preached **the new birth**, not religious membership. *"You can sit in a garage for years and never become a car."* Being inside religion does not automatically produce salvation.

4. The Apostolic Gospel: Christ Crucified

The true gospel preached by the apostles centered on Christ's finished work.

1 Corinthians 15:3–4 (NIV) “Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, that he was buried, that he was raised on the third day according to the Scriptures.”

This message contains three essential truths:

1. Christ died for our sins.
2. Christ was buried.
3. Christ rose from the dead.

Through this work, sinners receive forgiveness and new life.

Idiom: “*The cross is the key that unlocks the prison of sin.*”

5. The Apostolic Gospel Produces Transformation

Unlike false gospels, the true gospel produces real change.

When a person believes in Christ:

- The power of sin is broken.
- The heart is renewed.
- The believer enters a new covenant relationship with God.

2 Corinthians 5:17 (NIV) “Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come: The old has gone, the new is here!”

This transformation is the evidence of genuine salvation. “*When the root changes, the fruit will also change.*”

6. The Danger of Preaching Another Gospel

The apostles warned that altering the gospel is dangerous.

Galatians 1:6–7 (NIV) “I am astonished that you are so quickly deserting the one who called you to live in the grace of Christ and are turning to a different gospel—which is really no

CHAPTER 40

WHY RETURNING TO PAST SINS UNDERMINES FAITH

Second Epistle of Peter 2:20–21 (NIV)

“If they have escaped the corruption of the world... and are again entangled in it... they are worse off at the end than they were at the beginning.”

Epistle to the Hebrews 10:26–27 (NIV)

“If we deliberately keep on sinning after we have received the knowledge of the truth...”

1. Returning Is Spiritual Regression

Salvation is meant to move a believer **forward into transformation**. Returning to past sin reverses that movement.

The Christian life is not merely **escaping punishment**; it is **entering a new life**. When someone knowingly returns to sin after receiving truth, three things happen:

- The conscience becomes dull
- Faith becomes weaker
- The heart becomes divided

Jesus described this danger in **Gospel of Luke 9:62**: “No one who puts a hand to the plow and looks back is fit for service in the kingdom of God.”

Looking back reveals that the **heart has not fully released the past**.

“A freed prisoner choosing to sleep in his old cell.”

Freedom has already been granted, yet the person voluntarily returns to bondage.

This is why returning to sin is not just a mistake—it is **a contradiction of the new life in Christ**.

2. The Danger of Entanglement

The Bible uses the word “**entangled.**” Sin rarely captures someone instantly. It works slowly.

The pattern usually looks like this:

1. **Neglect** – Prayer and fellowship decrease
2. **Compromise** – Small allowances are made
3. **Attachment** – The heart begins to justify the behavior
4. **Bondage** – Sin regains influence

James describes this progression clearly in **Epistle of James 1:14–15**:

- Desire conceives
- Sin develops
- Sin brings death

Sin is like **a creeping vine**. If not cut early, it wraps itself around the entire life.

This is why vigilance is necessary in the Christian walk.

The enemy rarely attacks with sudden destruction; he begins with **subtle compromise**.

3. Trusting the Cross Completely

Returning to sin often reveals **a deeper spiritual issue**—a failure to trust fully in what Christ accomplished.

The cross did not only forgive sin; it **broke sin’s authority**. According to **Epistle to the Romans 6:11–12**:

- We must consider ourselves **dead to sin**
- We must refuse to let sin **reign in our bodies**

Faith means believing that the **power of sin has already been defeated**.

When believers continue deliberately in sin, it can indicate:

- Forgetting their new identity
- Ignoring the voice of the Spirit
- Treating grace as permission instead of empowerment

Grace is not a license to sin—it is **the power to overcome sin**.

4. The Warning of Looking Back

The story of **Lot's Wife** in **Book of Genesis 19** illustrates this principle.

God delivered Lot and his family from Sodom. They were instructed:

“Do not look back.”

Yet Lot's wife looked back and became a pillar of salt. Her body left Sodom, but **her heart remained there**.

Spiritual Lesson

Deliverance is not complete until the **heart releases the past**. Many believers leave sinful environments but still **long for what they left behind**.

True repentance means **closing the door permanently**.

5. Why Sin Weakens Faith

Faith thrives in an environment of obedience.

When a believer repeatedly returns to sin:

- The conscience becomes troubled
- Confidence before God decreases
- Prayer becomes difficult
- Spiritual sensitivity fades

This is why **First Epistle of John 3:21** says: “If our hearts do not condemn us, we have confidence before God.”

A clear conscience strengthens faith.

6. Moving Forward Instead of Backward

The Christian journey is meant to be **progressive transformation**. The apostle Paul declared in **Epistle to the Philippians 3:13–14**:

- Forget what lies behind
- Press toward what lies ahead

The believer's focus should always be:

- Growth
- Maturity
- Deeper fellowship with Christ

Looking backward keeps a person trapped in yesterday. Looking forward releases them into **God's future**.

Expanded Chapter Summary

The cross set believers free from the power and penalty of sin. Returning to past sins is not merely a moral failure—it is a spiritual regression that weakens faith and risks renewed bondage.

True faith moves forward, trusting in the finished work of Christ and walking in the new life He provides.

Reflection Questions

1. Is there any area of my life where I am drifting back toward old patterns?
2. Am I guarding my heart against subtle compromises?
3. Do I truly believe that Christ has given me power over sin?

CHAPTER 41

WHY BELIEVERS STILL EXPERIENCE SICKNESS AND PHYSICAL DEATH

Salvation and the Fallen World

Many believers ask a profound question:

“If we are saved, why do we still get sick or face physical death?”

The answer lies in understanding that **salvation is a journey**. It is a gift that secures eternal life, but we still live in a **fallen, broken world** where sin has affected creation, the body, and daily life.

A seed may be planted today, but it must still endure storms before it grows into a tree.

1. Salvation Secures Eternal Life, Not Instant Immortality

When a person believes in **Jesus Christ**, salvation begins in the spirit:

- Our **spirit is made alive** to God (born again)
- Our **soul begins to be transformed** toward holiness
- Our **eternal destiny is secured** in Christ

John 3:16 “Whoever believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life.”

Eternal life is primarily **a spiritual reality**, not always an instant freedom from physical limitations.

The traveler owns the ticket to the city, but must still walk the road to reach it.

2. The World Remains Fallen

Even after salvation, believers remain in a world **under the consequences of sin**:

- Disease and decay are part of the fallen creation (Genesis 3).
- Death entered the human experience through sin (Romans 5:12).
- Natural calamities, accidents, and aging remain until Christ returns.

Romans 8:20–22 “The creation was subjected to frustration... in hope that the creation itself will be liberated from its bondage to decay.”

Salvation begins in the spirit but **physical redemption is still future**.

Even after being freed, a traveler must still cross the river to reach home.

3. Healing and God's Provision

The Bible promises healing, restoration, and provision:

- **James 5:14–15** – Prayer for the sick brings healing
- **Isaiah 53:5** – “By His stripes we are healed”

Yet, healing is not always immediate or physical. Sometimes, God allows sickness or trials to:

- Test faith
- Build perseverance
- Draw the believer closer to Him

Medicine treats symptoms, but the surgeon's hand restores fully.

4. Physical Death Is Not the End

Even though the body dies, the spirit of the believer lives forever:

2 Corinthians 5:1–8 “For we know that if the earthly tent we live in is destroyed, we have a building from God... an eternal house in heaven.”

Death is no longer the final enemy because salvation guarantees eternal life. *The night may be dark, but the dawn is certain.*

5. The Future Completion of Salvation

The ultimate redemption of the body and the end of sickness and death will occur **when Christ returns**:

- Believers will receive **glorified bodies**
- Sin and disease will be **completely removed**
- Death will be **defeated forever**

Romans 8:23

“We eagerly await adoption as children of God, the redemption of our bodies.”

Until then, believers are called to:

- Walk in faith
- Trust God in trials
- Seek healing while remembering ultimate restoration is eternal

The journey may be long, but the destination is glorious.

6. Living with the Hope of Full Salvation

Understanding that salvation is both **finished at the cross** and **still unfolding** gives believers:

1. **Confidence** – Christ has already won the victory over sin and death
2. **Perseverance** – We continue to grow spiritually in the present
3. **Hope** – We eagerly anticipate full restoration at His return

Romans 8:24–25 “For we are saved by hope... we wait for it with patience.”

The traveler has purchased the ticket, but must still complete the journey.

Conclusion: Salvation Is a Journey

Believers experience sickness, decay, and death **not because salvation is incomplete**, but because we are **walking in a world still affected by sin**.

- **Past:** Christ has secured our eternal life.
- **Present:** We experience growth, healing, and transformation in this life.
- **Future:** Full redemption and glorification await when Christ returns.

The race is already won at the starting gun, but the runner still presses on to the finish line.

Salvation is a journey—a **living hope that stretches from the cross to eternity**, preparing us for the glorious day when sickness, suffering, and death will be no more.

CHAPTER 42

DELIVERANCE BEYOND POSSESSIONS — THE TRUE FREEDOM IN CHRIST

Epistle to the Galatians 3:13 (NIV) “Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us...”

Introduction

In many places today, deliverance has been misunderstood. Some people measure freedom by **what someone possesses**.

If a person builds a house, becomes wealthy, gets married, or gains material success, they say, “This person is delivered

But if another believer confesses Jesus Christ and yet lives a simple life, struggles financially, or remains unmarried, some conclude that the person is **still under a curse or bondage** yet there some people who will never build or own cars yet they have been delivered.”

This belief raises an important question:

Does true deliverance mean receiving material things, or does it mean freedom from something deeper?

To answer this, we must return to the **true gospel preached by Christ and His apostles**.

1. The First Bondage of Humanity Was Not Poverty

The greatest problem humanity faced was not poverty, lack of marriage, or lack of possessions. The deepest problem was **sin and separation from God**.

When Adam fell, humanity inherited a sinful nature that separated mankind from God. The Bible teaches that all people were under the power of sin.

Epistle to the Romans 3:23 says: "For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God."

This means the first bondage of humanity was **spiritual**, not material. People were prisoners of sin, fear, death, and condemnation.

That is why Jesus came.

2. Christ Came to Deliver Humanity from Sin

The mission of Christ was to deliver humanity from the power of sin and restore mankind to God.

Gospel of Luke 19:10 "For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost."

The deliverance Jesus brought was first **spiritual liberation**.

Through His death on the cross, Christ broke the power of sin and removed the curse of the law.

As written in **Epistle to the Colossians 1:13**: "For he has rescued us from the dominion of darkness and brought us into the kingdom of the Son he loves."

This means that anyone who truly believes in Christ has already been **delivered from the kingdom of darkness**.

3. The Cross Removed the Curse

Many believers fear that if they are not prosperous or successful, they must still be under a curse.

However, Scripture clearly teaches that Christ already dealt with the curse at the cross.

Epistle to the Galatians 3:13 "Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us."

This means the curse of sin and condemnation was carried by Christ.

Therefore, a believer who has confessed Jesus Christ is **no longer under the curse**, even if their life circumstances are not perfect.

4. Material Wealth Was Never the Proof of Deliverance

If material prosperity were the true evidence of deliverance, many faithful servants of God in Scripture would have been considered cursed.

For example, **Paul the Apostle** experienced hunger, hardship, and persecution.

In **Second Epistle to the Corinthians 11:27**, he wrote: "I have known hunger and thirst... I have often gone without food."

Yet Paul was one of the greatest apostles of Christ.

Similarly, **John the Baptist** lived in the wilderness and owned almost nothing, yet Jesus called him one of the greatest prophets.

Even **Jesus Christ** Himself lived without earthly possessions.

Gospel of Matthew 8:20 records: "Foxes have dens and birds have nests, but the Son of Man has no place to lay his head."

Clearly, lack of possessions is **not proof of bondage**.

5. The Greatest Blessings Are Spiritual

The New Testament teaches that believers have already received the greatest blessings through Christ.

Epistle to the Ephesians 1:3 "He has blessed us in the heavenly realms with every spiritual blessing in Christ."

These blessings include:

- Forgiveness of sins
- Peace with God
- Eternal life
- The Holy Spirit
- Adoption into God's family

These spiritual blessings are far greater than temporary earthly wealth.

6. The True Evidence of Deliverance

Deliverance is seen not in possessions but in **transformation of life**.

A delivered person begins to experience:

- Freedom from sin's control
- A renewed mind
- Love for God
- Growth in holiness
- The fruit of the Spirit

As written in **Epistle to the Romans 8:1**:

“Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.”

This is the true freedom the gospel brings.

Conclusion

Deliverance is not measured by houses, wealth, or marriage. It is measured by **freedom from sin** and reconciliation with God through Jesus Christ.

A believer who has confessed Christ is not under a curse, even if they have not yet received certain material blessings.

True deliverance is the **new life that Christ gives**, a life of righteousness, peace, and fellowship with God.

The greatest freedom is not the possession of things but the **possession of Christ Himself**.

CHAPTER 43

THE OPEN PRISON — WHY MANY CHRISTIANS REMAIN BOUND AFTER THE CROSS

Epistle to the Galatians 5:1 (NIV) “It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not let yourselves be burdened again by a yoke of slavery.”

Introduction

The cross of **Jesus Christ** accomplished a complete victory over sin, Satan, and the curse.

Through His sacrifice, the prison door of humanity was opened. Every believer who trusts in Christ is released from the bondage that came through **Adam**.

Yet a painful reality remains: many Christians still live as if they are prisoners.

They struggle with fear, guilt, condemnation, and spiritual defeat. They pray constantly for deliverance from things that Christ has already defeated.

This situation can be described as **an open prison**. The door has been opened by the cross, but many believers remain inside because they do not understand the freedom they have received.

1. The Cross Completely Defeated the Power of Darkness

When Christ died on the cross, He did not merely make salvation possible; He defeated the powers that held humanity captive.

The Bible declares in **Epistle to the Colossians 2:15**: “Having disarmed the powers and authorities, he made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross.”

Through the cross:

- Sin was defeated
- Satan was disarmed
- The curse was broken
- The power of death was overcome

This means the believer's freedom was already secured through the victory of Christ.

2. Many Believers Do Not Understand What Happened at the Cross

One reason many Christians remain in bondage is **lack of understanding**.

They believe Jesus died for their sins, but they do not fully understand that their **old nature was crucified with Him**.

As written in **Epistle to the Romans 6:6**: "Our old self was crucified with him so that the body ruled by sin might be done away with."

Without this understanding, believers continue to see themselves as weak sinners rather than **new creations in Christ**.

Because of this, they continue living under the mindset of slavery.

3. Fear and Condemnation Keep Many in the Prison

Another reason believers remain bound is the power of **fear and condemnation**.

Even after accepting Christ, many people still feel guilty and unworthy before God. They believe that God is constantly angry with them.

But Scripture teaches something different.

Epistle to the Romans 8:1 says: "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

The enemy often tries to keep believers trapped by reminding them of their past sins. However, the cross has already removed their condemnation.

Freedom begins when believers accept what Christ has already accomplished.

4. False Teachings Can Rebuild the Prison

Sometimes believers remain bound because they have been taught a distorted version of the gospel.

Some teachings focus only on:

- Curses
- Generational bondage
- Endless deliverance rituals
- Fear of demons

While spiritual warfare is real, the New Testament emphasizes the **finished work of Christ**.

The apostles taught believers to live in the victory already won by Christ.

For example, **Paul the Apostle** constantly reminded believers of their new identity in Christ rather than placing them back under fear.

5. Freedom Must Be Accepted by Faith

Christ opened the prison door, but believers must step out by **faith**.

Freedom becomes a living reality when believers:

- Believe the truth of the gospel
- Renew their minds with Scripture
- Reject the lies of condemnation
- Walk daily in their new identity in Christ

As written in **Gospel of John 8:32**: “Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.”

Knowing the truth about what Christ has done is the key to walking in freedom.

6. Living Outside the Prison

When believers understand the power of the cross, they begin to live differently.

Instead of seeing themselves as prisoners, they recognize that they are:

- Children of God
- Citizens of God's kingdom
- New creations in Christ
- Victors through the cross

Their lives begin to reflect the freedom Christ has already provided.

Conclusion

The cross opened the prison door for humanity. Through Jesus Christ, the chains of sin, condemnation, and spiritual slavery were broken.

Yet many believers remain in bondage because they do not fully understand the freedom they have received.

The gospel calls every believer to step out of the open prison and walk boldly in the liberty that Christ has secured.

True deliverance is not something believers must continually search for—it is a freedom already given through the finished work of the cross.

CHAPTER 44

THE THREE ANGELS' MESSAGE — GOD'S FINAL WARNING TO THE WORLD

Book of Revelation **Revelation 14:6–8 NKJV**

"Then I saw another angel flying in the midst of heaven, having the everlasting gospel to preach to those who dwell on the earth—to every nation, tribe, tongue, and people

Saying with a loud voice, 'Fear God and give glory to Him, for the hour of His judgment has come; and worship Him who made heaven and earth, the sea and springs of water.'

And another angel followed, saying, 'Babylon is fallen, is fallen, that great city, because she has made all nations drink of the wine of the wrath of her fornication.'"

1. The Three Angels' Message Is the Final Gospel Warning

The three angels represent **God's last global message before Christ returns**.

It is not merely symbolic language; it is **a prophetic proclamation meant for the entire world**.

The first angel carries **the everlasting gospel**, meaning the gospel preached by the apostles and confirmed by Christ.

The three messages reveal three truths:

1. **True worship of God**
2. **The fall of Babylon**
3. **A warning against false worship and spiritual deception**

These messages prepare humanity for the return of Christ. "Before a storm breaks, the thunder warns the earth." God always warns before judgment.

Amos 3:7 NKJV *"Surely the Lord GOD does nothing, unless He reveals His secret to His servants the prophets."*

2. The First Angel — The Everlasting Gospel

Revelation 14:6–7 NKJV *"Then I saw another angel flying in the midst of heaven, having the everlasting gospel to preach to those who dwell on the earth..."*

The first angel proclaims the **true gospel**.

This gospel includes:

- Repentance
- Salvation through Christ
- Fear of God
- Worship of the Creator

The angel calls humanity back to **the Creator**.

This is significant because the world is drifting away from God and worshipping **creation instead of the Creator**.

Romans 1:25 NKJV *"Who exchanged the truth of God for the lie, and worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator."* The true gospel restores **right worship**.

"When the compass is broken, every direction feels right." Without the true gospel, humanity loses its spiritual direction.

3. The Second Angel — Babylon Is Fallen

Revelation 14:8 NKJV

"Babylon is fallen, is fallen, that great city, because she has made all nations drink of the wine of the wrath of her fornication."

This raises the question many believers ask:

Where is Babylon?

Is it a literal city?

To understand this, we must look at the original **Babylon in the Old Testament**.

4. Babylon in the Old Testament

Babylon was an empire known for:

- Pride
- Idolatry
- Rebellion against God
- Persecution of God's people

Daniel 4:30 NKJV *"Is not this great Babylon, that I have built for a royal dwelling by my mighty power and for the honor of my majesty?"*

Babylon represented **human pride and spiritual corruption**. It was also the kingdom that **destroyed Jerusalem and took Israel into captivity**.

Babylon became a **symbol of spiritual rebellion against God**.

5. Babylon in Revelation — A Spiritual System

In the book of Revelation, Babylon is not merely a geographic city. It represents a global religious and spiritual system that opposes God's truth.

Revelation 17:5 NKJV *"And on her forehead a name was written: Mystery, babylon the great, the mother of harlots and of the abominations of the earth."*

Notice the word "**Mystery.**"

This tells us Babylon is **symbolic and spiritual**, not merely physical.

Babylon represents:

- Corrupted religion
- Mixture of truth and deception
- Systems that lead people away from God

"Poison mixed with honey is still poison." Babylon does not reject God openly; it mixes truth with deception.

6. The Wine of Babylon

Revelation 14:8 NKJV *"...she has made all nations drink of the wine of the wrath of her fornication."*

Wine represents **false teachings and spiritual intoxication**.

Babylon influences nations through:

- False doctrines
- Corrupted worship
- Spiritual compromise

Spiritual intoxication blinds people so they cannot recognize truth.
"A drunk man cannot walk a straight line."

False doctrine distorts spiritual perception.

7. The Third Angel — The Final Warning

Revelation 14:9–10 NKJV *"If anyone worships the beast and his image, and receives his mark on his forehead or on his hand, he himself shall also drink of the wine of the wrath of God."*

The third angel gives the **strongest warning in the Bible**.

It warns humanity not to participate in **false worship systems aligned with Babylon**.

This message is urgent because it concerns **eternal destiny**.

8. The Call to Come Out of Babylon

Later in Revelation, God gives a powerful command.

Revelation 18:4 NKJV *"Come out of her, my people, lest you share in her sins, and lest you receive of her plagues."*

This reveals something profound. God still has **His people inside Babylon**. The call is not condemnation but **deliverance**.

The three angels' message is not about attacking people. It is about **calling God's people back to truth**. "When a house catches fire, the loving voice shouts, 'Come out!'"

9. The Mission of the Church Today

The three angels' message reveals the mission of the end-time church:

- Preach the everlasting gospel
- Warn about spiritual deception
- Call people back to true worship

Matthew 24:14 NKJV

"And this gospel of the kingdom will be preached in all the world as a witness to all the nations, and then the end will come."

Chapter Summary

The three angels' message is **God's final call to humanity before Christ returns**.

The messages proclaim:

1. The everlasting gospel
2. The fall of Babylon
3. A warning against false worship

Babylon represents **a global spiritual system of deception and corrupted religion** that leads people away from God.

The call of God is clear:

Come out of Babylon and return to true worship.

"A lighthouse shines brightest when the sea is darkest."

The three angels' message is that lighthouse, guiding humanity back to the truth of God.

Chapter 45

The Legacy of Redemption — From Adam to the Church Today

Romans 5:19 (NIV) “For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous.”

1. Redemption Is Generational

Adam affected generations negatively. Christ affects generations eternally.

Redemption is not private—it is generational. “One man’s obedience can rewrite a family’s future.”

2. From the Fall to the Church

Through Christ, a new community was born—the Church. In Acts 2, the Spirit was poured out, marking the beginning of a redeemed people walking in power.

The Church is proof that redemption works.

3. Teaching the Next Generation

Salvation must be taught, modeled, and lived.

Biblical Example:

Timothy received faith passed down from his grandmother Lois and mother Eunice (2 Timothy 1:5). Redemption flows through testimony.

Chapter Summary

Redemption moves from Adam’s fall to Christ’s victory and into the Church’s mission. We are carriers of a generational blessing.

Reflection Questions

1. How is my salvation impacting others?
2. What legacy of faith am I building?

Conclusion: The Cross Settled the Matter

Colossians 2:14 (NIV) *“Having canceled the charge of our legal indebtedness... he has taken it away, nailing it to the cross.”*

The cross is not merely a historical event or a symbolic ritual—it is **the decisive act that settled humanity’s eternal problem.**

All our sins, weaknesses, and legal debts before God were nailed to the cross, once and for all.

1. Sin Was Judged

Every transgression of humanity—past, present, or future—fell under the justice of God. On the cross:

- Jesus bore the penalty for all sin (2 Corinthians 5:21)
- The righteous judgment of God was satisfied (Romans 3:25–26)
- Our record of guilt was erased

“The debt collector left the ledger empty; the books were closed.”

Nothing remains in God’s court to accuse the believer. Sin has been **handled legally and relationally.**

2. Debt Was Canceled

Sin left humanity **indebted to God**, spiritually bankrupt, unable to earn righteousness. The cross:

- Paid the full price
- Redeemed humanity from slavery to sin
- Restored access to God’s presence

Biblical Illustration:

Just as a slave could be released by paying a ransom, humanity was released because **Christ became our ransom** (Mark 10:45).

“The check has cleared; you are no longer liable.”

3. Death Was Defeated

Before the cross, death had the final word. Through the cross and resurrection:

- Spiritual death (separation from God) is conquered
- Physical death will ultimately bow at Christ’s return
- Eternal life is secured for all who believe

1 Corinthians 15:55–57 (NIV) – *“Where, O death, is your victory? ...But thanks be to God! He gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ.”*

“The prison gates are open; the key has been thrown away.”

4. Satan Was Disarmed

Colossians 2:15 emphasizes that Christ **disarmed spiritual powers and authorities**. Satan, who held legal ground through sin and death, **has no legal right over believers**.

- Accusation no longer sticks
- Fear and guilt cannot enslave
- Believers can walk boldly in victory

“When the general surrenders, the soldiers can no longer fight.”

5. Standing in Victory

The cross is **not just a past event** to study—it is **our present reality**. Every believer can live:

- Redeemed (freed from sin’s debt)
- Empowered (filled with the Spirit for holiness)
- Assured (confident in God’s promises)

Living in the cross means **you are no longer waiting for victory—you already possess it**.

“The gavel has fallen; the case is closed, and freedom is yours to walk in.”

6. Practical Application

1. **Walk in Freedom Daily:** Recognize that sin's legal power over you is broken. Do not yield to old habits.
2. **Live Redeemed:** Your identity is not in failure, fear, or guilt. It is in Christ's work on the cross.
3. **Stand Assured:** Stand boldly in prayer, ministry, and daily life, knowing the cross has settled the matter.

Chapter Summary

The cross was **final, complete, and victorious**.

- Sin judged
- Debt canceled
- Death defeated
- Satan disarmed

Nothing is left for condemnation. Victory is already yours. Believers are called to **live redeemed, walk free, and stand assured**, not in fear or striving, but in the power of Christ's finished work.

"The judge struck the gavel; the sentence is executed; the prisoner walks free."

CHAPTER 46

THE FINAL CALL — COME TO THE CROSS

Throughout this book we have walked a long journey. We began with **the fall of man in the first Adam**, saw the **bondage of sin over creation**, and then discovered God's answer in **the Last Adam, Jesus Christ**.

We examined the **power of redemption**, the **mystery of remission of sins**, and the **finished work of the cross**.

/We saw the difference between **religion and being truly born again**, and we examined why many people remain bound even after hearing the gospel.

But now we arrive at the most important moment of all.

This is **the moment of decision**.

The gospel is not merely information to understand; it is **an invitation to respond**. Christianity is not simply a philosophy to admire; it is **a call to come to Christ**.

The message of the gospel always ends with a call.

The Cross Is the Center of God's Invitation

The cross stands at the center of human history. It is the place where **justice and mercy met**, where **sin was judged and grace was released**.

Scripture declares: *"For the preaching of the cross is to them that perish foolishness; but unto us which are saved it is the power of God."* — 1 Corinthians 1:18

To the natural mind, the cross appears weak and foolish. How can the death of one man two thousand years ago save the world?

But to those who believe, the cross is **the power of God for salvation**.

At the cross, Jesus carried the sin of the world. *"Who his own self bare our sins in his own body on the tree."* — 1 Peter 2:24

He took our guilt so that we might receive His righteousness. *"For he hath made him to be sin for us, who knew no sin; that we might be made the righteousness of God in him."* — 2 Corinthians 5:21

The cross is therefore not merely a symbol. It is **the doorway through which sinners enter new life.**

The Cross Divides Humanity

The cross divides humanity into two groups.

Not rich and poor.

Not educated and uneducated.

Not religious and irreligious.

The real division is this: **those who accept the cross and those who reject it.**

Jesus Himself said: *"He that believeth on him is not condemned: but he that believeth not is condemned already."* — John 3:18

The cross is like a bridge placed over a deep abyss. Those who walk across it find life. Those who refuse remain on the side of destruction.

An old saying goes: **"You cannot ignore the bridge and still cross the river."**

In the same way, you cannot ignore the cross and still receive salvation.

Religion Cannot Replace the Cross

Many people today are religious. They attend church, sing songs, give offerings, and even preach sermons. But religion alone cannot save a soul.

Religion may polish the outside, but only the cross can **transform the heart.**

The Apostle Paul made this clear: *"For I determined not to know any thing among you, save Jesus Christ, and him crucified."* — 1 Corinthians 2:2

Paul understood that the power of Christianity does not lie in ceremonies, traditions, or philosophies. It lies in **the crucified and risen Christ**.

A man may belong to a church and still be lost.
A man may know theology and still be unsaved.
A man may preach sermons and still lack new birth.

What matters is whether he has **come to the cross**.

The Open Arms of Christ

The beauty of the gospel is that the cross is open to everyone.

No sinner is too dirty.
No past is too dark.
No failure is too great.

Jesus declared: *"Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest."* — Matthew 11:28

Notice that He said **"come."**

The gospel is not forcing people; it is **inviting them**.

At the cross, Jesus stretched out His arms as if to embrace the world. Those nails that pierced His hands became the sign that **the door of mercy is open**.

As long as a person lives, the invitation remains.

Why You Must Come Personally

One of the greatest truths of salvation is that **no one can come to the cross on your behalf**.

Your parents cannot do it for you.
Your pastor cannot do it for you.
Your church cannot do it for you.

Salvation is **a personal response to Christ**.

The jailer in the book of Acts asked the apostles a very direct question: *"Sirs, what must I do to be saved?"* — Acts 16:30

Their answer was simple: *"Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved."* — Acts 16:31

Salvation begins when a person **personally believes and receives Christ**.

The Urgency of the Call

The invitation of the gospel is open, but it will not remain open forever.

Life is uncertain. Time moves quickly. The opportunity to respond must not be delayed.

Scripture warns: *"Behold, now is the accepted time; behold, now is the day of salvation."* — 2 Corinthians 6:2

Many people plan to come to Christ later. But later is a dangerous word.

An old proverb says: **"The road called tomorrow leads to the town called never."**

The wise person does not postpone the call of God.

Come Out of Adam and Enter Christ

Every human being is born in **Adam**, the first man whose disobedience brought sin and death.

But through the gospel, God invites us to enter **Christ, the Last Adam**, who brings righteousness and life.

The Apostle Paul explained this truth clearly: *"For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive."* — 1 Corinthians 15:22

Remaining in Adam leads to spiritual death. Entering Christ brings eternal life.

The cross is the place where this **transfer happens**.

At the cross, sinners leave the old life and receive a new one.

A Personal Invitation

If you have read this book and have not yet come to Christ, this moment is for you.

God is not calling you to religion; He is calling you to **His Son**.

The same Jesus who died on the cross and rose from the grave is inviting you today.

The question is not whether Christ died for sinners. That has already been settled at Calvary.

The question now is this:

Will you come to the cross?

Will you turn from sin?

Will you believe in Christ?

Will you receive the new life He offers?

A Prayer of Surrender

If you desire to respond to the call of the gospel, you can pray sincerely from your heart:

“Lord Jesus Christ,
I believe that You are the Son of God.
I believe You died on the cross for my sins
and rose again for my salvation.

Today I repent of my sins
and I place my faith in You alone.

Wash me with Your precious blood.
Forgive my sins and give me a new heart.

From today I confess You as my Lord and Savior.
Help me to follow You for the rest of my life.

Amen."

The Journey Begins Here

Coming to the cross is not the end; it is **the beginning of a new life**.

From that moment, the believer begins a journey of **growing in Christ**, walking in holiness, and living in the power of the Holy Spirit.

The cross is where the old life ends, but it is also where **eternal life begins**.

As an old Christian saying declares:

"The ground is level at the foot of the cross."

Everyone who comes to Christ stands on the same ground of grace.

And so this book closes with the same call that has echoed through centuries of Christian preaching:

Come to the cross.

Come to Christ.

Come and receive the life that only He can give.

CHAPTER 47

WALKING IN PERMANENT FREEDOM

Living the Life Christ Purchased

Freedom is one of the greatest gifts Christ gave to humanity through His sacrifice.

Yet many believers experience moments of victory followed by seasons of struggle. They receive prayer, feel relief, and then later face similar battles again.

This raises an important question: **Is permanent freedom truly possible for a believer?**

The answer from Scripture is **yes**. Christ did not come to give temporary relief but **complete and lasting freedom**.

Jesus declared this powerful truth:

John 8:36 (NKJV) "Therefore if the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed."

Notice that Jesus did not say **partially free** or **occasionally free**. He said **free indeed**, meaning freedom that is genuine, complete, and enduring.

However, walking in that freedom requires spiritual understanding and daily commitment.

As an idiom says, **"Freedom is a gift, but walking in it is a discipline."**

Abiding in Christ Is the Foundation of Freedom

True and lasting freedom flows from a close relationship with Christ.

Jesus taught that believers must remain connected to Him like branches connected to a vine.

John 15:4 (NKJV) “Abide in Me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, unless it abides in the vine, neither can you, unless you abide in Me.”

Abiding means **remaining, dwelling, and continuing** in Christ.

When believers maintain a living relationship with Jesus through prayer, obedience, and fellowship with God, spiritual strength flows naturally.

An idiom says, “**A branch** separated from the tree cannot remain green for **long**.”

In the same way, distance from Christ weakens spiritual vitality.

The Word of God Strengthens Freedom

The Word of God is one of the most powerful tools for maintaining freedom.

Jesus connected freedom directly to truth.

John 8:31–32 (NKJV) “If you abide in My word, you are My disciples indeed. And you shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.”

Truth exposes deception, renews the mind, and strengthens faith.

Without the Word of God, the believer may easily return to old ways of thinking.

An idiom says, “**A lamp is most valuable in the darkness**.”

The Word of God serves as a lamp that guides the believer away from spiritual traps.

The Role of the Holy Spirit

Freedom is also sustained through the power of the Holy Spirit.

The Spirit empowers believers to overcome the flesh and walk in righteousness.

2 Corinthians 3:17 (NKJV) “Now the Lord is the Spirit; and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty.”

The Holy Spirit provides:

- Conviction when something is wrong
- Strength to resist temptation
- Wisdom to make righteous decisions
- Power to overcome spiritual opposition

Walking in the Spirit keeps the believer aligned with God.

Galatians 5:16 (NKJV) “Walk in the Spirit, and you shall not fulfill the lust of the flesh.”

An idiom says, “**A man who walks in the light rarely stumbles.**”

Guarding the Heart

Permanent freedom requires guarding the heart carefully.

The heart influences thoughts, emotions, and decisions.

Scripture warns believers to protect it.

Proverbs 4:23 (NKJV) “Keep your heart with all diligence, for out of it spring the issues of life.”

What a person allows into the heart—through conversations, entertainment, relationships, and influences—can either strengthen or weaken spiritual life.

An idiom explains this principle well: “**What you feed grows, and what you starve dies.**”

Feeding the spirit with godly influences strengthens freedom.

Fellowship and Spiritual Accountability

Another important element of lasting freedom is **fellowship with other believers**.

Christianity was never meant to be lived in isolation.

Hebrews 10:24–25 (NKJV) “And let us consider one another in order to stir up love and good works, not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together.”

Healthy fellowship encourages growth, accountability, and spiritual strength.

Just as iron sharpens iron, believers strengthen one another through encouragement and prayer.

An idiom says, “**A single** coal cools quickly, but many coals together keep the fire burning.”

Spiritual Authority and Resistance

The believer must also learn to exercise the authority Christ has given.

The enemy must be resisted.

James 4:7 (NKJV) “Therefore submit to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you.”

This verse reveals two important principles:

1. **Submission to God**
2. **Resistance against the enemy**

When believers submit to God’s authority and resist the enemy, spiritual victory becomes consistent.

Another idiom says, “**A** door firmly shut leaves no room for intrusion.”

Growing Into Spiritual Maturity

Finally, lasting freedom is strengthened through **spiritual maturity**.

Growth does not happen overnight. It develops gradually through experience, obedience, and deeper knowledge of God.

Ephesians 4:13 (NKJV) "Till we all come to the unity of the faith and of the knowledge of the Son of God, to a perfect man, to the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ."

Maturity stabilizes the believer and prevents spiritual instability.

An idiom says, "Deep roots keep the tree standing during strong winds."

The deeper the believer's roots in Christ, the stronger their freedom becomes.

Conclusion

Permanent freedom is not maintained by occasional moments of deliverance alone. It is sustained through a life that is rooted in Christ.

Believers walk in lasting freedom when they:

- Abide in Christ
- Fill their lives with the Word of God
- Walk in the Holy Spirit
- Guard their hearts
- Maintain fellowship with other believers
- Exercise spiritual authority
- Grow into maturity

When these principles are practiced, the believer's life becomes stable and victorious.

As Scripture declares:

Romans 8:2 (NKJV) "For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus has made me free from the law of sin and death."

And as the saying goes, "**Freedom** that is nourished daily becomes a fortress that no enemy can easily conquer."

CHAPTER 48

POSSIBLE QUESTIONS FROM THE CLASS AND BIBLICAL ANSWERS

1. If Christ redeemed us from the curse, why do some Christians still suffer from generational problems?

Answer

Christ truly removed the **legal curse**, but believers must walk in that freedom through transformation and obedience.

Galatians 3:13 (NKJV) "Christ has redeemed us from the curse of the law, having become a curse for us."

However, many struggles continue because of:

- Unrenewed minds
- Learned family behaviors
- Open doors to sin

Romans 12:2 (NKJV) "Be transformed by the renewing of your mind."

Short teaching statement

"Christ broke the chains, but the believer must learn how to walk without them."

2. Can a born-again Christian have a demon?

This question almost always comes.

Balanced answer

A believer cannot be **possessed** because the Holy Spirit lives inside them.

1 Corinthians 6:19 (NKJV) "Your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit."

However, believers can experience **oppression or influence** from outside.

1 Peter 5:8 (NKJV) "Your adversary the devil walks about like a roaring lion."

Teaching insight

"The Holy Spirit owns the house, but believers must still guard the doors."

3. What is the difference between temptation and demonic attack?

Answer

Temptation can come from three places:

1. The flesh
2. The world
3. The devil

James 1:14 (NKJV) "Each one is tempted when he is drawn away by his own desires."

Not every temptation is demonic.

Sometimes it is simply the **flesh seeking satisfaction**.

Class explanation

"If the flesh is not disciplined, it will behave like an enemy."

4. Why do some people return to bondage after deliverance?

Answer

Because the life was not filled with **truth and discipleship**.

Jesus explained this clearly.

Matthew 12:43–45 (NKJV) "When an unclean spirit goes out of a man... he finds the house empty... then he returns."

The problem was not that deliverance failed.

The problem was **an empty life without spiritual growth.**

Teaching phrase

“Deliverance removes the enemy, but discipleship fills the house.”

5. How do believers close spiritual doors?

Answer

Closing doors requires several steps:

1. Repentance
2. Forgiveness
3. Renouncing sinful practices
4. Walking in obedience

James 4:7 (NKJV) “Submit to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you.”

Notice the order:

Submission first, resistance second.

6. Are generational curses real today?

Answer

Generational **sin patterns exist**, but Christ has already broken the curse.

Ezekiel 18:20 (NKJV) “The son shall not bear the guilt of the father.”

And through Christ:

2 Corinthians 5:17 (NKJV) “If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation.”

Teaching insight

“The bloodline of Christ is stronger than the bloodline of ancestry.”

7. What is the difference between the flesh and a demon?

Answer

The **flesh** is internal (sinful nature).
A **demon** is external (spiritual influence).

Galatians 5:17 (NKJV) "The flesh lusts against the Spirit."

But about the devil:

James 4:7 (NKJV) "Resist the devil and he will flee from you." You **crucify the flesh**, but you **resist the devil**.

8. Can a Christian lose their freedom again?

Yes, if they return to the old life.

Galatians 5:1 (NKJV) "Do not be entangled again with a yoke of bondage."

Freedom must be **maintained through obedience and spiritual growth**.

Teaching phrase

"Freedom is a gift, but walking in it is a discipline."

9. Why do some churches focus only on deliverance?

Because deliverance produces **visible results**, while discipleship requires **time and patience**.

But Jesus commanded the church not only to deliver people but also to make disciples.

Matthew 28:19–20 (NKJV) "Go therefore and make disciples... teaching them to observe all things that I have commanded."

Deliverance without discipleship creates **spiritual instability**.

10. How can a believer maintain permanent freedom?

Five key things:

1. Abide in Christ
2. Study the Word
3. Walk in the Spirit
4. Guard the heart
5. Resist the enemy

John 8:36 (NKJV) “If the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed.”

One Powerful Question that May be Asked

“If the prison door is open, why do many Christians still sit inside?”

Then explain:

- Ignorance
- Fear
- Unrenewed minds
- Undisciplined flesh

This question will make the class **engage deeply with the teaching.**

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BEHIND EVERY PAGE LIES A CALLING—NOT A CAREER

In ever set out to become a writer or a pastor. I was a businessman, an IT specialist, and a passionate golfer.

But during a prayer meeting at Mutundwe Christian Fellowship, God interrupted my life with one word: “Relax”

Isaiah 61:1-4.

That divinemoment changed everything.

Seven years later, I’m still pastoring. And in the middle of deep personal challenges, God spoke again: “You will help many of children.” That night, I dreamt of books falling from heaven— chapters pouring out with purpose.

The next morning, I knew I had to write. Not for fame, but out of obedience.

Inspired by Isaiah 61, Ezekiel 3, and Isaiah 45, my writing is a calling, not a career. These books are not just ink on paper—they are divine instructions, healing words, and torches for the weary.

If you’re holding this book, you’re not here by accident. God is calling you. What seems like a detour may be His direction.

Obedience is your passport to destiny.

May every page stir your faith, heal your heart, and lead you closer to the One who calls.

**–Pastor Denis Kalungi
Kireka Christian Fellowship Prayer Altar**



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“Freely you have received; freely give.” — Matthew 10:8



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